

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Transparency, Accountability, RTI, Grievance Redress and Social Audit - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Transparency, Accountability, RTI, Grievance Redress and Social Audit	
REFRESHED TEACHING NAVIGATION — BASIC/CORE FIRST	
01 FOUNDATION — TRANSPARENCY, ANSWERABILITY AND ENFORCEABILITY Evidence chain: The three-part accountability chain Qualified use:	02 FOUNDATION — THE INFORMATION-REQUEST ROUTE Under the Right to Information Act, 2005 a citizen seeks existing
03 FOUNDATION — PROACTIVE DISCLOSURE AND ITS LIMITS Evidence chain: Proactive disclosure and its limits Qualified use: Show	04 CORE — EXEMPTIONS, SEVERABILITY AND THE OVERRIDE Evidence chain: Exemptions, severability and the public-interest
05 CORE — THE SUBSTITUTED PERSONAL-INFORMATION EXEMPTION Evidence chain: The substituted personal-information exemption	06 CORE — WHAT AN INFORMATION COMMISSION CANNOT DO Evidence chain: What an Information Commission can and cannot do
07 CORE — SOCIAL AUDIT DEFINED AGAINST OTHER AUDITS Evidence chain: Social audit defined against other audits Qualified	08 CORE — THE STATUTORY BASIS AND ITS DUAL DESIGN Section 17 of the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment
09 CORE — THE GENERALISED STATE STATUTE Evidence chain: The generalised State statute Qualified use: Cite the	10 CORE — THE PUBLIC HEARING AND ITS ENFORCEMENT GAP Evidence chain: The public hearing as face-to-face answerability - The
11 CORE — WHERE THE VISIBILITY-TO-CORRECTION CHAIN BREAKS The chain runs from disclosure through comprehension, verification,	12 CORE — THE TYPOLOGY AND ITS COUPLING RULE Accountability operates in three directions - horizontal, where one
13 CORE SYNTHESIS — THE INSTITUTIONAL DIVISION OF LABOUR The Controller and Auditor-General is the constitutional public;	14 CORE SYNTHESIS — ROUTING THE REMEDY AND FOUR DISTINCT FUNCTIONS The remedy sought determines the forum - information denied or
15 CORE SYNTHESIS — THE UNCOMMENCED PROTECTION AND HONEST QUESTION Evidence chain: Whistle-blower protection as an unfilled gap -	

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies The three-part accountability chain?

A. Accountability is not transparency plus good intentions but a three-part chain - transparency, meaning visibility of records, spending and decisions; answerability, meaning an identifiable authority obliged to explain; and enforceability, meaning correction, remedy or consequence - and India has built the first extensively, the second unevenly and the third rarely, which is why an answer that opens by separating the three immediately outperforms one that treats them as synonyms. B. Under the Right to Information Act, 2005 a citizen seeks existing information from a public authority within ordinarily 30 days, or 48 hours where the information concerns the life or liberty of a person, with a first appeal ordinarily within 30 days and a second appeal to the Central or State Information Commission within 90 days, and a Public Information Officer penalty of two hundred and fifty rupees per day subject to a maximum of twenty-five thousand rupees after the statutory process; the route obtains information that already exists and does not create information, order a service or punish the underlying wrong. C. Section 8 of the Right to Information Act, 2005 contains the exemptions and they operate subject to severability, so a document is not withheld in full because part of it is exempt, and subject to the section 8(2) public-interest override, which permits disclosure where the public interest in disclosure outweighs the harm to the protected interest; section 24 excludes listed intelligence and security organisations from the Act while preserving the provisos relating to allegations of corruption and human-rights violations. D. Section 4 of the Right to Information Act, 2005 requires public authorities to maintain records and publish specified organisational, function, decision, budget, subsidy, concession and Public Information Officer information on their own initiative so that routine facts need not await an application, and it reduces the volume of grievances that arise purely from information asymmetry; compliance is not independently audited, however, and publication is not the same as usability, so a disclosure that is aggregated, technical or stale satisfies the form without serving the purpose.

Answer: A. Explanation: Accountability is not transparency plus good intentions but a three-part chain - transparency, meaning visibility of records, spending and decisions; answerability, meaning an identifiable authority obliged to explain; and enforceability, meaning correction, remedy or consequence - and India has built the first extensively, the second unevenly and the third rarely, which is why an answer that opens by separating the three immediately outperforms one that treats them as synonyms. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under The three-part accountability chain?

A. Section 4 of the Right to Information Act, 2005 requires public authorities to maintain records and publish specified organisational, function, decision, budget, subsidy, concession and Public Information Officer information on their own initiative so that routine facts need not await an application, and it reduces the volume of grievances that arise purely from information asymmetry; compliance is not independently audited, however, and publication is not the same as usability, so a disclosure that is aggregated, technical or stale satisfies the form without serving the purpose. B. Accountability is not transparency plus good intentions but a three-part chain - transparency, meaning visibility of records, spending and decisions; answerability, meaning an identifiable authority obliged to explain; and enforceability, meaning correction, remedy or consequence - and India has built the first extensively, the second unevenly and the third rarely, which is why an answer that opens by separating the three immediately outperforms one that treats them as synonyms. C. Section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005 stands substituted by section 44(3) of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, which sits in the already-commenced immediate tranche of that Act, so the substituted personal-information exemption has been operative since 13 and 14 November 2025 and the pre-substitution three-part test must not be described as the current text; the general public-interest override in section 8(2) is unaffected and remains the route by which disclosure can still be directed, and constitutional challenges to the amendment have been filed with no final judgment located as of 13 August 2026, so the challenge is stated as pending and no outcome is asserted. D. Section 8 of the Right to Information Act, 2005 contains the exemptions and they operate subject to severability, so a document is not withheld in full because part of it is exempt, and subject to the section 8(2) public-interest override, which permits disclosure where the public interest in disclosure outweighs the harm to the protected interest; section 24 excludes listed intelligence and security organisations from

the Act while preserving the provisos relating to allegations of corruption and human-rights violations.

Answer: B. Explanation: Accountability is not transparency plus good intentions but a three-part chain - transparency, meaning visibility of records, spending and decisions; answerability, meaning an identifiable authority obliged to explain; and enforceability, meaning correction, remedy or consequence - and India has built the first extensively, the second unevenly and the third rarely, which is why an answer that opens by separating the three immediately outperforms one that treats them as synonyms. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The three-part accountability chain?

A. The Central and State Information Commissions are statutory bodies under the Right to Information Act, 2005 that decide complaints and second appeals concerning access to information and can secure the record, compensation and statutory compliance or penalty, but they cannot adjudicate the merits of the underlying pension, licence or service, so a citizen who wants the entitlement rather than the file is in the wrong forum; the composition, appointment and removal of these bodies are owned by the Polity material and are cross-linked rather than restated. B. Section 8 of the Right to Information Act, 2005 contains the exemptions and they operate subject to severability, so a document is not withheld in full because part of it is exempt, and subject to the section 8(2) public-interest override, which permits disclosure where the public interest in disclosure outweighs the harm to the protected interest; section 24 excludes listed intelligence and security organisations from the Act while preserving the provisos relating to allegations of corruption and human-rights violations. C. Accountability is not transparency plus good intentions but a three-part chain - transparency, meaning visibility of records, spending and decisions; answerability, meaning an identifiable authority obliged to explain; and enforceability, meaning correction, remedy or consequence - and India has built the first extensively, the second unevenly and the third rarely, which is why an answer that opens by separating the three immediately outperforms one that treats them as synonyms. D. Section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005 stands substituted by section 44(3) of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, which sits in the already-commenced immediate tranche of that Act, so the substituted personal-information exemption has been operative since 13 and 14 November 2025 and the pre-substitution three-part test must not be described as the current text; the general public-interest override in section 8(2) is unaffected and remains the route by which disclosure can still be directed, and constitutional challenges to the amendment have been filed with no final judgment located as of 13 August 2026, so the challenge is stated as pending and no outcome is asserted.

Answer: C. Explanation: Accountability is not transparency plus good intentions but a three-part chain - transparency, meaning visibility of records, spending and decisions; answerability, meaning an identifiable authority obliged to explain; and enforceability, meaning correction, remedy or consequence - and India has built the first extensively, the second unevenly and the third rarely, which is why an answer that opens by separating the three immediately outperforms one that treats them as synonyms. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The three-part accountability chain?

A. The Central and State Information Commissions are statutory bodies under the Right to Information Act, 2005 that decide complaints and second appeals concerning access to information and can secure the record, compensation and statutory compliance or penalty, but they cannot adjudicate the merits of the underlying pension, licence or service, so a citizen who wants the entitlement rather than the file is in the wrong forum; the composition, appointment and removal of these bodies are owned by the Polity material and are cross-linked rather than restated. B. Section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005 stands substituted by section 44(3) of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, which sits in the already-commenced immediate tranche of that Act, so the substituted personal-information exemption has been operative since 13 and 14 November 2025 and the pre-substitution three-part test must not be described as the current text; the general public-interest override in section 8(2) is unaffected and remains the route by which disclosure can still be directed, and constitutional challenges to the amendment have been filed with no final judgment located as of 13 August 2026, so the challenge is stated as pending and no outcome is asserted. C. Social audit is the participatory verification of records, expenditure and delivery, facilitated independently of the implementing agency and culminating in a public hearing and a follow-up process, and it is distinct from financial audit which tests expenditure regularity, from compliance audit which tests conformity with rules, from performance audit which tests economy, efficiency and effectiveness, and from individual grievance redress which resolves one person's complaint; it surfaces systemic patterns that no single complaint would reveal. D. Accountability is not transparency plus good

intentions but a three-part chain - transparency, meaning visibility of records, spending and decisions; answerability, meaning an identifiable authority obliged to explain; and enforceability, meaning correction, remedy or consequence - and India has built the first extensively, the second unevenly and the third rarely, which is why an answer that opens by separating the three immediately outperforms one that treats them as synonyms.

Answer: D. Explanation: Accountability is not transparency plus good intentions but a three-part chain - transparency, meaning visibility of records, spending and decisions; answerability, meaning an identifiable authority obliged to explain; and enforceability, meaning correction, remedy or consequence - and India has built the first extensively, the second unevenly and the third rarely, which is why an answer that opens by separating the three immediately outperforms one that treats them as synonyms. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies The information-request route and its timelines?

A. Under the Right to Information Act, 2005 a citizen seeks existing information from a public authority within ordinarily 30 days, or 48 hours where the information concerns the life or liberty of a person, with a first appeal ordinarily within 30 days and a second appeal to the Central or State Information Commission within 90 days, and a Public Information Officer penalty of two hundred and fifty rupees per day subject to a maximum of twenty-five thousand rupees after the statutory process; the route obtains information that already exists and does not create information, order a service or punish the underlying wrong. B. Section 4 of the Right to Information Act, 2005 requires public authorities to maintain records and publish specified organisational, function, decision, budget, subsidy, concession and Public Information Officer information on their own initiative so that routine facts need not await an application, and it reduces the volume of grievances that arise purely from information asymmetry; compliance is not independently audited, however, and publication is not the same as usability, so a disclosure that is aggregated, technical or stale satisfies the form without serving the purpose. C. Section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005 stands substituted by section 44(3) of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, which sits in the already-commenced immediate tranche of that Act, so the substituted personal-information exemption has been operative since 13 and 14 November 2025 and the pre-substitution three-part test must not be described as the current text; the general public-interest override in section 8(2) is unaffected and remains the route by which disclosure can still be directed, and constitutional challenges to the amendment have been filed with no final judgment located as of 13 August 2026, so the challenge is stated as pending and no outcome is asserted. D. Section 8 of the Right to Information Act, 2005 contains the exemptions and they operate subject to severability, so a document is not withheld in full because part of it is exempt, and subject to the section 8(2) public-interest override, which permits disclosure where the public interest in disclosure outweighs the harm to the protected interest; section 24 excludes listed intelligence and security organisations from the Act while preserving the provisos relating to allegations of corruption and human-rights violations.

Answer: A. Explanation: Under the Right to Information Act, 2005 a citizen seeks existing information from a public authority within ordinarily 30 days, or 48 hours where the information concerns the life or liberty of a person, with a first appeal ordinarily within 30 days and a second appeal to the Central or State Information Commission within 90 days, and a Public Information Officer penalty of two hundred and fifty rupees per day subject to a maximum of twenty-five thousand rupees after the statutory process; the route obtains information that already exists and does not create information, order a service or punish the underlying wrong. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q6. Which chronology card should be filed under The information-request route and its timelines?

A. Section 8 of the Right to Information Act, 2005 contains the exemptions and they operate subject to severability, so a document is not withheld in full because part of it is exempt, and subject to the section 8(2) public-interest override, which permits disclosure where the public interest in disclosure outweighs the harm to the protected interest; section 24 excludes listed intelligence and security organisations from the Act while preserving the provisos relating to allegations of corruption and human-rights violations. B. Under the Right to Information Act, 2005 a citizen seeks existing information from a public authority within ordinarily 30 days, or 48 hours where the information concerns the life or liberty of a person, with a first appeal ordinarily within 30 days and a second appeal to the Central or State Information Commission within 90 days, and a Public Information Officer penalty of two hundred and fifty rupees per day subject to a maximum of twenty-five thousand rupees after the statutory process; the route obtains information that already exists and does not create information, order a service or punish the underlying wrong. C. The Central

and State Information Commissions are statutory bodies under the Right to Information Act, 2005 that decide complaints and second appeals concerning access to information and can secure the record, compensation and statutory compliance or penalty, but they cannot adjudicate the merits of the underlying pension, licence or service, so a citizen who wants the entitlement rather than the file is in the wrong forum; the composition, appointment and removal of these bodies are owned by the Polity material and are cross-linked rather than restated. D. Section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005 stands substituted by section 44(3) of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, which sits in the already-commenced immediate tranche of that Act, so the substituted personal-information exemption has been operative since 13 and 14 November 2025 and the pre-substitution three-part test must not be described as the current text; the general public-interest override in section 8(2) is unaffected and remains the route by which disclosure can still be directed, and constitutional challenges to the amendment have been filed with no final judgment located as of 13 August 2026, so the challenge is stated as pending and no outcome is asserted.

Answer: B. Explanation: Under the Right to Information Act, 2005 a citizen seeks existing information from a public authority within ordinarily 30 days, or 48 hours where the information concerns the life or liberty of a person, with a first appeal ordinarily within 30 days and a second appeal to the Central or State Information Commission within 90 days, and a Public Information Officer penalty of two hundred and fifty rupees per day subject to a maximum of twenty-five thousand rupees after the statutory process; the route obtains information that already exists and does not create information, order a service or punish the underlying wrong. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q7. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The information-request route and its timelines?

A. Social audit is the participatory verification of records, expenditure and delivery, facilitated independently of the implementing agency and culminating in a public hearing and a follow-up process, and it is distinct from financial audit which tests expenditure regularity, from compliance audit which tests conformity with rules, from performance audit which tests economy, efficiency and effectiveness, and from individual grievance redress which resolves one person's complaint; it surfaces systemic patterns that no single complaint would reveal. B. Section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005 stands substituted by section 44(3) of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, which sits in the already-commenced immediate tranche of that Act, so the substituted personal-information exemption has been operative since 13 and 14 November 2025 and the pre-substitution three-part test must not be described as the current text; the general public-interest override in section 8(2) is unaffected and remains the route by which disclosure can still be directed, and constitutional challenges to the amendment have been filed with no final judgment located as of 13 August 2026, so the challenge is stated as pending and no outcome is asserted. C. Under the Right to Information Act, 2005 a citizen seeks existing information from a public authority within ordinarily 30 days, or 48 hours where the information concerns the life or liberty of a person, with a first appeal ordinarily within 30 days and a second appeal to the Central or State Information Commission within 90 days, and a Public Information Officer penalty of two hundred and fifty rupees per day subject to a maximum of twenty-five thousand rupees after the statutory process; the route obtains information that already exists and does not create information, order a service or punish the underlying wrong. D. The Central and State Information Commissions are statutory bodies under the Right to Information Act, 2005 that decide complaints and second appeals concerning access to information and can secure the record, compensation and statutory compliance or penalty, but they cannot adjudicate the merits of the underlying pension, licence or service, so a citizen who wants the entitlement rather than the file is in the wrong forum; the composition, appointment and removal of these bodies are owned by the Polity material and are cross-linked rather than restated.

Answer: C. Explanation: Under the Right to Information Act, 2005 a citizen seeks existing information from a public authority within ordinarily 30 days, or 48 hours where the information concerns the life or liberty of a person, with a first appeal ordinarily within 30 days and a second appeal to the Central or State Information Commission within 90 days, and a Public Information Officer penalty of two hundred and fifty rupees per day subject to a maximum of twenty-five thousand rupees after the statutory process; the route obtains information that already exists and does not create information, order a service or punish the underlying wrong. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q8. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The information-request route and its timelines?

A. Section 17 of the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, 2005 gives the Gram Sabha the monitoring and social-audit function for works in its area, and the Audit of Schemes Rules, 2011 require an independent State Social Audit Unit to facilitate the audit in every Gram Panchayat at least once every six months, so social audit here is a recurring statutory obligation on the implementing agency rather than an optional civil-society initiative. B. Social audit is the participatory verification of records, expenditure and delivery, facilitated independently of the implementing agency and culminating in a public hearing and a follow-up process, and it is distinct from financial audit which tests expenditure regularity, from compliance audit which tests conformity with rules, from performance audit which tests economy, efficiency and effectiveness, and from individual grievance redress which resolves one person's complaint; it surfaces systemic patterns that no single complaint would reveal. C. The Central and State Information Commissions are statutory bodies under the Right to Information Act, 2005 that decide complaints and second appeals concerning access to information and can secure the record, compensation and statutory compliance or penalty, but they cannot adjudicate the merits of the underlying pension, licence or service, so a citizen who wants the entitlement rather than the file is in the wrong forum; the composition, appointment and removal of these bodies are owned by the Polity material and are cross-linked rather than restated. D. Under the Right to Information Act, 2005 a citizen seeks existing information from a public authority within ordinarily 30 days, or 48 hours where the information concerns the life or liberty of a person, with a first appeal ordinarily within 30 days and a second appeal to the Central or State Information Commission within 90 days, and a Public Information Officer penalty of two hundred and fifty rupees per day subject to a maximum of twenty-five thousand rupees after the statutory process; the route obtains information that already exists and does not create information, order a service or punish the underlying wrong.

Answer: D. Explanation: Under the Right to Information Act, 2005 a citizen seeks existing information from a public authority within ordinarily 30 days, or 48 hours where the information concerns the life or liberty of a person, with a first appeal ordinarily within 30 days and a second appeal to the Central or State Information Commission within 90 days, and a Public Information Officer penalty of two hundred and fifty rupees per day subject to a maximum of twenty-five thousand rupees after the statutory process; the route obtains information that already exists and does not create information, order a service or punish the underlying wrong. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Proactive disclosure and its limits?

A. Section 4 of the Right to Information Act, 2005 requires public authorities to maintain records and publish specified organisational, function, decision, budget, subsidy, concession and Public Information Officer information on their own initiative so that routine facts need not await an application, and it reduces the volume of grievances that arise purely from information asymmetry; compliance is not independently audited, however, and publication is not the same as usability, so a disclosure that is aggregated, technical or stale satisfies the form without serving the purpose. B. The Central and State Information Commissions are statutory bodies under the Right to Information Act, 2005 that decide complaints and second appeals concerning access to information and can secure the record, compensation and statutory compliance or penalty, but they cannot adjudicate the merits of the underlying pension, licence or service, so a citizen who wants the entitlement rather than the file is in the wrong forum; the composition, appointment and removal of these bodies are owned by the Polity material and are cross-linked rather than restated. C. Section 8 of the Right to Information Act, 2005 contains the exemptions and they operate subject to severability, so a document is not withheld in full because part of it is exempt, and subject to the section 8(2) public-interest override, which permits disclosure where the public interest in disclosure outweighs the harm to the protected interest; section 24 excludes listed intelligence and security organisations from the Act while preserving the provisos relating to allegations of corruption and human-rights violations. D. Section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005 stands substituted by section 44(3) of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, which sits in the already-commenced immediate tranche of that Act, so the substituted personal-information exemption has been operative since 13 and 14 November 2025 and the pre-substitution three-part test must not be described as the current text; the general public-interest override in section 8(2) is unaffected and remains the route by which disclosure can still be directed, and constitutional challenges to the amendment have been filed with no final judgment located as of 13 August 2026, so the challenge is stated as pending and no outcome is asserted.

Answer: A. Explanation: Section 4 of the Right to Information Act, 2005 requires public authorities to maintain records and publish specified organisational, function, decision, budget, subsidy, concession and Public Information Officer information on their own initiative so that routine facts need not await an application, and it reduces the volume of grievances that arise purely from information asymmetry; compliance is not independently audited, however, and publication is not the same as usability, so a disclosure that is aggregated, technical or stale satisfies the form without serving the purpose. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q10. Which chronology card should be filed under Proactive disclosure and its limits?

A. Section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005 stands substituted by section 44(3) of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, which sits in the already-commenced immediate tranche of that Act, so the substituted personal-information exemption has been operative since 13 and 14 November 2025 and the pre-substitution three-part test must not be described as the current text; the general public-interest override in section 8(2) is unaffected and remains the route by which disclosure can still be directed, and constitutional challenges to the amendment have been filed with no final judgment located as of 13 August 2026, so the challenge is stated as pending and no outcome is asserted. B. Section 4 of the Right to Information Act, 2005 requires public authorities to maintain records and publish specified organisational, function, decision, budget, subsidy, concession and Public Information Officer information on their own initiative so that routine facts need not await an application, and it reduces the volume of grievances that arise purely from information asymmetry; compliance is not independently audited, however, and publication is not the same as usability, so a disclosure that is aggregated, technical or stale satisfies the form without serving the purpose. C. Social audit is the participatory verification of records, expenditure and delivery, facilitated independently of the implementing agency and culminating in a public hearing and a follow-up process, and it is distinct from financial audit which tests expenditure regularity, from compliance audit which tests conformity with rules, from performance audit which tests economy, efficiency and effectiveness, and from individual grievance redress which resolves one person's complaint; it surfaces systemic patterns that no single complaint would reveal. D. The Central and State Information Commissions are statutory bodies under the Right to Information Act, 2005 that decide complaints and second appeals concerning access to information and can secure the record, compensation and statutory compliance or penalty, but they cannot adjudicate the merits of the underlying pension, licence or service, so a citizen who wants the entitlement rather than the file is in the wrong forum; the composition, appointment and removal of these bodies are owned by the Polity material and are cross-linked rather than restated.

Answer: B. Explanation: Section 4 of the Right to Information Act, 2005 requires public authorities to maintain records and publish specified organisational, function, decision, budget, subsidy, concession and Public Information Officer information on their own initiative so that routine facts need not await an application, and it reduces the volume of grievances that arise purely from information asymmetry; compliance is not independently audited, however, and publication is not the same as usability, so a disclosure that is aggregated, technical or stale satisfies the form without serving the purpose. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q11. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Proactive disclosure and its limits?

A. Section 17 of the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, 2005 gives the Gram Sabha the monitoring and social-audit function for works in its area, and the Audit of Schemes Rules, 2011 require an independent State Social Audit Unit to facilitate the audit in every Gram Panchayat at least once every six months, so social audit here is a recurring statutory obligation on the implementing agency rather than an optional civil-society initiative. B. Social audit is the participatory verification of records, expenditure and delivery, facilitated independently of the implementing agency and culminating in a public hearing and a follow-up process, and it is distinct from financial audit which tests expenditure regularity, from compliance audit which tests conformity with rules, from performance audit which tests economy, efficiency and effectiveness, and from individual grievance redress which resolves one person's complaint; it surfaces systemic patterns that no single complaint would reveal. C. Section 4 of the Right to Information Act, 2005 requires public authorities to maintain records and publish specified organisational, function, decision, budget, subsidy, concession and Public Information Officer information on their own initiative so that routine facts need not await an application, and it reduces the volume of grievances that arise purely from information asymmetry; compliance is not independently audited, however, and publication is not the same as usability, so a disclosure that is aggregated, technical or stale satisfies the form without serving the purpose. D. The Central and

State Information Commissions are statutory bodies under the Right to Information Act, 2005 that decide complaints and second appeals concerning access to information and can secure the record, compensation and statutory compliance or penalty, but they cannot adjudicate the merits of the underlying pension, licence or service, so a citizen who wants the entitlement rather than the file is in the wrong forum; the composition, appointment and removal of these bodies are owned by the Polity material and are cross-linked rather than restated.

Answer: C. Explanation: Section 4 of the Right to Information Act, 2005 requires public authorities to maintain records and publish specified organisational, function, decision, budget, subsidy, concession and Public Information Officer information on their own initiative so that routine facts need not await an application, and it reduces the volume of grievances that arise purely from information asymmetry; compliance is not independently audited, however, and publication is not the same as usability, so a disclosure that is aggregated, technical or stale satisfies the form without serving the purpose. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q12. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Proactive disclosure and its limits?

A. Social audit is the participatory verification of records, expenditure and delivery, facilitated independently of the implementing agency and culminating in a public hearing and a follow-up process, and it is distinct from financial audit which tests expenditure regularity, from compliance audit which tests conformity with rules, from performance audit which tests economy, efficiency and effectiveness, and from individual grievance redress which resolves one person's complaint; it surfaces systemic patterns that no single complaint would reveal. B. The community layer supplies local knowledge and public legitimacy while the independent unit supplies facilitation, record access, resource-person training and separation from the implementing machinery, so it is incorrect to contrast a community-only model with a separate-unit model; capture can arise at either layer, because the same village that verifies the records also contains the hierarchy that may have benefited from the irregularity, and greater auditor independence reduces capture risk while reducing the hyper-local knowledge advantage. C. Section 17 of the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, 2005 gives the Gram Sabha the monitoring and social-audit function for works in its area, and the Audit of Schemes Rules, 2011 require an independent State Social Audit Unit to facilitate the audit in every Gram Panchayat at least once every six months, so social audit here is a recurring statutory obligation on the implementing agency rather than an optional civil-society initiative. D. Section 4 of the Right to Information Act, 2005 requires public authorities to maintain records and publish specified organisational, function, decision, budget, subsidy, concession and Public Information Officer information on their own initiative so that routine facts need not await an application, and it reduces the volume of grievances that arise purely from information asymmetry; compliance is not independently audited, however, and publication is not the same as usability, so a disclosure that is aggregated, technical or stale satisfies the form without serving the purpose.

Answer: D. Explanation: Section 4 of the Right to Information Act, 2005 requires public authorities to maintain records and publish specified organisational, function, decision, budget, subsidy, concession and Public Information Officer information on their own initiative so that routine facts need not await an application, and it reduces the volume of grievances that arise purely from information asymmetry; compliance is not independently audited, however, and publication is not the same as usability, so a disclosure that is aggregated, technical or stale satisfies the form without serving the purpose. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Exemptions, severability and the public-interest override?

A. Section 8 of the Right to Information Act, 2005 contains the exemptions and they operate subject to severability, so a document is not withheld in full because part of it is exempt, and subject to the section 8(2) public-interest override, which permits disclosure where the public interest in disclosure outweighs the harm to the protected interest; section 24 excludes listed intelligence and security organisations from the Act while preserving the provisos relating to allegations of corruption and human-rights violations. B. The Central and State Information Commissions are statutory bodies under the Right to Information Act, 2005 that decide complaints and second appeals concerning access to information and can secure the record, compensation and statutory compliance or penalty, but they cannot adjudicate the merits of the underlying pension, licence or service, so a citizen who wants the entitlement rather than the file is in the wrong forum; the composition, appointment and removal of these bodies are owned by the Polity material and are cross-linked rather than restated. C. Section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005 stands substituted by section

44(3) of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, which sits in the already-commenced immediate tranche of that Act, so the substituted personal-information exemption has been operative since 13 and 14 November 2025 and the pre-substitution three-part test must not be described as the current text; the general public-interest override in section 8(2) is unaffected and remains the route by which disclosure can still be directed, and constitutional challenges to the amendment have been filed with no final judgment located as of 13 August 2026, so the challenge is stated as pending and no outcome is asserted. D. Social audit is the participatory verification of records, expenditure and delivery, facilitated independently of the implementing agency and culminating in a public hearing and a follow-up process, and it is distinct from financial audit which tests expenditure regularity, from compliance audit which tests conformity with rules, from performance audit which tests economy, efficiency and effectiveness, and from individual grievance redress which resolves one person's complaint; it surfaces systemic patterns that no single complaint would reveal.

Answer: A. Explanation: Section 8 of the Right to Information Act, 2005 contains the exemptions and they operate subject to severability, so a document is not withheld in full because part of it is exempt, and subject to the section 8(2) public-interest override, which permits disclosure where the public interest in disclosure outweighs the harm to the protected interest; section 24 excludes listed intelligence and security organisations from the Act while preserving the provisos relating to allegations of corruption and human-rights violations. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q14. Which chronology card should be filed under Exemptions, severability and the public-interest override?

A. The Central and State Information Commissions are statutory bodies under the Right to Information Act, 2005 that decide complaints and second appeals concerning access to information and can secure the record, compensation and statutory compliance or penalty, but they cannot adjudicate the merits of the underlying pension, licence or service, so a citizen who wants the entitlement rather than the file is in the wrong forum; the composition, appointment and removal of these bodies are owned by the Polity material and are cross-linked rather than restated. B. Section 8 of the Right to Information Act, 2005 contains the exemptions and they operate subject to severability, so a document is not withheld in full because part of it is exempt, and subject to the section 8(2) public-interest override, which permits disclosure where the public interest in disclosure outweighs the harm to the protected interest; section 24 excludes listed intelligence and security organisations from the Act while preserving the provisos relating to allegations of corruption and human-rights violations. C. Section 17 of the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, 2005 gives the Gram Sabha the monitoring and social-audit function for works in its area, and the Audit of Schemes Rules, 2011 require an independent State Social Audit Unit to facilitate the audit in every Gram Panchayat at least once every six months, so social audit here is a recurring statutory obligation on the implementing agency rather than an optional civil-society initiative. D. Social audit is the participatory verification of records, expenditure and delivery, facilitated independently of the implementing agency and culminating in a public hearing and a follow-up process, and it is distinct from financial audit which tests expenditure regularity, from compliance audit which tests conformity with rules, from performance audit which tests economy, efficiency and effectiveness, and from individual grievance redress which resolves one person's complaint; it surfaces systemic patterns that no single complaint would reveal.

Answer: B. Explanation: Section 8 of the Right to Information Act, 2005 contains the exemptions and they operate subject to severability, so a document is not withheld in full because part of it is exempt, and subject to the section 8(2) public-interest override, which permits disclosure where the public interest in disclosure outweighs the harm to the protected interest; section 24 excludes listed intelligence and security organisations from the Act while preserving the provisos relating to allegations of corruption and human-rights violations. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q15. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Exemptions, severability and the public-interest override?

A. Section 17 of the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, 2005 gives the Gram Sabha the monitoring and social-audit function for works in its area, and the Audit of Schemes Rules, 2011 require an independent State Social Audit Unit to facilitate the audit in every Gram Panchayat at least once every six months, so social audit here is a recurring statutory obligation on the implementing agency rather than an optional civil-society initiative. B. Social audit is the participatory verification of records, expenditure and delivery, facilitated independently of the implementing agency and culminating in a public hearing and a follow-up process, and it is distinct from financial audit which tests expenditure regularity, from compliance audit which tests conformity with rules, from performance audit which tests economy, efficiency and effectiveness, and from individual grievance redress which resolves one person's complaint; it surfaces systemic patterns that no single complaint would reveal. C. Section 8 of the Right to Information Act, 2005 contains the exemptions and they operate subject to severability, so a document is not withheld in full because part of it is exempt, and subject to the section 8(2) public-interest override, which permits disclosure where the public interest in disclosure outweighs the harm to the protected interest; section 24 excludes listed intelligence and security organisations from the Act while preserving the provisos relating to allegations of corruption and human-rights violations. D. The community layer supplies local knowledge and public legitimacy while the independent unit supplies facilitation, record access, resource-person training and separation from the implementing machinery, so it is incorrect to contrast a community-only model with a separate-unit model; capture can arise at either layer, because the same village that verifies the records also contains the hierarchy that may have benefited from the irregularity, and greater auditor independence reduces capture risk while reducing the hyper-local knowledge advantage.

Answer: C. Explanation: Section 8 of the Right to Information Act, 2005 contains the exemptions and they operate subject to severability, so a document is not withheld in full because part of it is exempt, and subject to the section 8(2) public-interest override, which permits disclosure where the public interest in disclosure outweighs the harm to the protected interest; section 24 excludes listed intelligence and security organisations from the Act while preserving the provisos relating to allegations of corruption and human-rights violations. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q16. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Exemptions, severability and the public-interest override?

A. The community layer supplies local knowledge and public legitimacy while the independent unit supplies facilitation, record access, resource-person training and separation from the implementing machinery, so it is incorrect to contrast a community-only model with a separate-unit model; capture can arise at either layer, because the same village that verifies the records also contains the hierarchy that may have benefited from the irregularity, and greater auditor independence reduces capture risk while reducing the hyper-local knowledge advantage. B. Section 17 of the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, 2005 gives the Gram Sabha the monitoring and social-audit function for works in its area, and the Audit of Schemes Rules, 2011 require an independent State Social Audit Unit to facilitate the audit in every Gram Panchayat at least once every six months, so social audit here is a recurring statutory obligation on the implementing agency rather than an optional civil-society initiative. C. The Meghalaya Community Participation and Public Services Social Audit Act, 2017 gives statutory backing to social audits of public programmes and services more broadly rather than for a single scheme, establishing Social Audit Units, providing for independent social auditors, securing community participation including access to relevant records, and mandating consideration of and follow-up action on audit findings; it is one of very few such State laws and must not be presented as a national model in force. D. Section 8 of the Right to Information Act, 2005 contains the exemptions and they operate subject to severability, so a document is not withheld in full because part of it is exempt, and subject to the section 8(2) public-interest override, which permits disclosure where the public interest in disclosure outweighs the harm to the protected interest; section 24 excludes listed intelligence and security organisations from the Act while preserving the provisos relating to allegations of corruption and human-rights violations.

Answer: D. Explanation: Section 8 of the Right to Information Act, 2005 contains the exemptions and they operate subject to severability, so a document is not withheld in full because part of it is exempt, and subject to the section 8(2) public-interest override, which permits disclosure where the public interest in disclosure outweighs the harm to the protected interest; section 24 excludes listed intelligence and security

organisations from the Act while preserving the provisos relating to allegations of corruption and human-rights violations. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies The substituted personal-information exemption?

A. Section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005 stands substituted by section 44(3) of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, which sits in the already-commenced immediate tranche of that Act, so the substituted personal-information exemption has been operative since 13 and 14 November 2025 and the pre-substitution three-part test must not be described as the current text; the general public-interest override in section 8(2) is unaffected and remains the route by which disclosure can still be directed, and constitutional challenges to the amendment have been filed with no final judgment located as of 13 August 2026, so the challenge is stated as pending and no outcome is asserted. B. Section 17 of the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, 2005 gives the Gram Sabha the monitoring and social-audit function for works in its area, and the Audit of Schemes Rules, 2011 require an independent State Social Audit Unit to facilitate the audit in every Gram Panchayat at least once every six months, so social audit here is a recurring statutory obligation on the implementing agency rather than an optional civil-society initiative. C. The Central and State Information Commissions are statutory bodies under the Right to Information Act, 2005 that decide complaints and second appeals concerning access to information and can secure the record, compensation and statutory compliance or penalty, but they cannot adjudicate the merits of the underlying pension, licence or service, so a citizen who wants the entitlement rather than the file is in the wrong forum; the composition, appointment and removal of these bodies are owned by the Polity material and are cross-linked rather than restated. D. Social audit is the participatory verification of records, expenditure and delivery, facilitated independently of the implementing agency and culminating in a public hearing and a follow-up process, and it is distinct from financial audit which tests expenditure regularity, from compliance audit which tests conformity with rules, from performance audit which tests economy, efficiency and effectiveness, and from individual grievance redress which resolves one person's complaint; it surfaces systemic patterns that no single complaint would reveal.

Answer: A. Explanation: Section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005 stands substituted by section 44(3) of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, which sits in the already-commenced immediate tranche of that Act, so the substituted personal-information exemption has been operative since 13 and 14 November 2025 and the pre-substitution three-part test must not be described as the current text; the general public-interest override in section 8(2) is unaffected and remains the route by which disclosure can still be directed, and constitutional challenges to the amendment have been filed with no final judgment located as of 13 August 2026, so the challenge is stated as pending and no outcome is asserted. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q18. Which chronology card should be filed under The substituted personal-information exemption?

A. Social audit is the participatory verification of records, expenditure and delivery, facilitated independently of the implementing agency and culminating in a public hearing and a follow-up process, and it is distinct from financial audit which tests expenditure regularity, from compliance audit which tests conformity with rules, from performance audit which tests economy, efficiency and effectiveness, and from individual grievance redress which resolves one person's complaint; it surfaces systemic patterns that no single complaint would reveal. B. Section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005 stands substituted by section 44(3) of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, which sits in the already-commenced immediate tranche of that Act, so the substituted personal-information exemption has been operative since 13 and 14 November 2025 and the pre-substitution three-part test must not be described as the current text; the general public-interest override in section 8(2) is unaffected and remains the route by which disclosure can still be directed, and constitutional challenges to the amendment have been filed with no final judgment located as of 13 August 2026, so the challenge is stated as pending and no outcome is asserted. C. Section 17 of the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, 2005 gives the Gram Sabha the monitoring and social-audit function for works in its area, and the Audit of Schemes Rules, 2011 require an independent State Social Audit Unit to facilitate the audit in every Gram Panchayat at least once every six months, so social audit here is a recurring statutory obligation on the implementing agency rather than an optional civil-society initiative. D. The community layer supplies local knowledge and public legitimacy while the independent unit supplies facilitation, record access, resource-person training and separation from the implementing machinery, so it is incorrect to contrast a community-only model with a separate-unit model; capture can arise at either layer, because the same village that

verifies the records also contains the hierarchy that may have benefited from the irregularity, and greater auditor independence reduces capture risk while reducing the hyper-local knowledge advantage.

Answer: B. Explanation: Section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005 stands substituted by section 44(3) of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, which sits in the already-commenced immediate tranche of that Act, so the substituted personal-information exemption has been operative since 13 and 14 November 2025 and the pre-substitution three-part test must not be described as the current text; the general public-interest override in section 8(2) is unaffected and remains the route by which disclosure can still be directed, and constitutional challenges to the amendment have been filed with no final judgment located as of 13 August 2026, so the challenge is stated as pending and no outcome is asserted. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q19. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The substituted personal-information exemption?

A. Section 17 of the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, 2005 gives the Gram Sabha the monitoring and social-audit function for works in its area, and the Audit of Schemes Rules, 2011 require an independent State Social Audit Unit to facilitate the audit in every Gram Panchayat at least once every six months, so social audit here is a recurring statutory obligation on the implementing agency rather than an optional civil-society initiative. B. The community layer supplies local knowledge and public legitimacy while the independent unit supplies facilitation, record access, resource-person training and separation from the implementing machinery, so it is incorrect to contrast a community-only model with a separate-unit model; capture can arise at either layer, because the same village that verifies the records also contains the hierarchy that may have benefited from the irregularity, and greater auditor independence reduces capture risk while reducing the hyper-local knowledge advantage. C. Section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005 stands substituted by section 44(3) of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, which sits in the already-commenced immediate tranche of that Act, so the substituted personal-information exemption has been operative since 13 and 14 November 2025 and the pre-substitution three-part test must not be described as the current text; the general public-interest override in section 8(2) is unaffected and remains the route by which disclosure can still be directed, and constitutional challenges to the amendment have been filed with no final judgment located as of 13 August 2026, so the challenge is stated as pending and no outcome is asserted. D. The Meghalaya Community Participation and Public Services Social Audit Act, 2017 gives statutory backing to social audits of public programmes and services more broadly rather than for a single scheme, establishing Social Audit Units, providing for independent social auditors, securing community participation including access to relevant records, and mandating consideration of and follow-up action on audit findings; it is one of very few such State laws and must not be presented as a national model in force.

Answer: C. Explanation: Section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005 stands substituted by section 44(3) of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, which sits in the already-commenced immediate tranche of that Act, so the substituted personal-information exemption has been operative since 13 and 14 November 2025 and the pre-substitution three-part test must not be described as the current text; the general public-interest override in section 8(2) is unaffected and remains the route by which disclosure can still be directed, and constitutional challenges to the amendment have been filed with no final judgment located as of 13 August 2026, so the challenge is stated as pending and no outcome is asserted. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q20. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The substituted personal-information exemption?

A. The Meghalaya Community Participation and Public Services Social Audit Act, 2017 gives statutory backing to social audits of public programmes and services more broadly rather than for a single scheme, establishing Social Audit Units, providing for independent social auditors, securing community participation including access to relevant records, and mandating consideration of and follow-up action on audit findings; it is one of very few such State laws and must not be presented as a national model in force. B. At a public hearing the audit findings are presented in an open forum in which officials must respond in front of the affected community, which creates a direct, on-the-record answerability event that a written information reply cannot produce; a hearing that surfaces a discrepancy without a mandated corrective timeline nevertheless achieves answerability without enforceability, which is the distinction that decides whether social audit produces deterrence or symbolic transparency. C. The community layer supplies local

knowledge and public legitimacy while the independent unit supplies facilitation, record access, resource-person training and separation from the implementing machinery, so it is incorrect to contrast a community-only model with a separate-unit model; capture can arise at either layer, because the same village that verifies the records also contains the hierarchy that may have benefited from the irregularity, and greater auditor independence reduces capture risk while reducing the hyper-local knowledge advantage. D. Section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005 stands substituted by section 44(3) of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, which sits in the already-commenced immediate tranche of that Act, so the substituted personal-information exemption has been operative since 13 and 14 November 2025 and the pre-substitution three-part test must not be described as the current text; the general public-interest override in section 8(2) is unaffected and remains the route by which disclosure can still be directed, and constitutional challenges to the amendment have been filed with no final judgment located as of 13 August 2026, so the challenge is stated as pending and no outcome is asserted.

Answer: D. Explanation: Section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005 stands substituted by section 44(3) of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, which sits in the already-commenced immediate tranche of that Act, so the substituted personal-information exemption has been operative since 13 and 14 November 2025 and the pre-substitution three-part test must not be described as the current text; the general public-interest override in section 8(2) is unaffected and remains the route by which disclosure can still be directed, and constitutional challenges to the amendment have been filed with no final judgment located as of 13 August 2026, so the challenge is stated as pending and no outcome is asserted. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies What an Information Commission can and cannot do?

A. The Central and State Information Commissions are statutory bodies under the Right to Information Act, 2005 that decide complaints and second appeals concerning access to information and can secure the record, compensation and statutory compliance or penalty, but they cannot adjudicate the merits of the underlying pension, licence or service, so a citizen who wants the entitlement rather than the file is in the wrong forum; the composition, appointment and removal of these bodies are owned by the Polity material and are cross-linked rather than restated. B. The community layer supplies local knowledge and public legitimacy while the independent unit supplies facilitation, record access, resource-person training and separation from the implementing machinery, so it is incorrect to contrast a community-only model with a separate-unit model; capture can arise at either layer, because the same village that verifies the records also contains the hierarchy that may have benefited from the irregularity, and greater auditor independence reduces capture risk while reducing the hyper-local knowledge advantage. C. Social audit is the participatory verification of records, expenditure and delivery, facilitated independently of the implementing agency and culminating in a public hearing and a follow-up process, and it is distinct from financial audit which tests expenditure regularity, from compliance audit which tests conformity with rules, from performance audit which tests economy, efficiency and effectiveness, and from individual grievance redress which resolves one person's complaint; it surfaces systemic patterns that no single complaint would reveal. D. Section 17 of the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, 2005 gives the Gram Sabha the monitoring and social-audit function for works in its area, and the Audit of Schemes Rules, 2011 require an independent State Social Audit Unit to facilitate the audit in every Gram Panchayat at least once every six months, so social audit here is a recurring statutory obligation on the implementing agency rather than an optional civil-society initiative.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Central and State Information Commissions are statutory bodies under the Right to Information Act, 2005 that decide complaints and second appeals concerning access to information and can secure the record, compensation and statutory compliance or penalty, but they cannot adjudicate the merits of the underlying pension, licence or service, so a citizen who wants the entitlement rather than the file is in the wrong forum; the composition, appointment and removal of these bodies are owned by the Polity material and are cross-linked rather than restated. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q22. Which chronology card should be filed under What an Information Commission can and cannot do?

A. The community layer supplies local knowledge and public legitimacy while the independent unit supplies facilitation, record access, resource-person training and separation from the implementing machinery, so it is incorrect to contrast a community-only model with a separate-unit model; capture can arise at either layer, because the same village that verifies the records also contains the hierarchy that may have benefited from the irregularity, and greater auditor independence reduces capture risk while reducing the hyper-local knowledge advantage. B. The Central and State Information Commissions are statutory bodies under the Right to Information Act, 2005 that decide complaints and second appeals concerning access to information and can secure the record, compensation and statutory compliance or penalty, but they cannot adjudicate the merits of the underlying pension, licence or service, so a citizen who wants the entitlement rather than the file is in the wrong forum; the composition, appointment and removal of these bodies are owned by the Polity material and are cross-linked rather than restated. C. The Meghalaya Community Participation and Public Services Social Audit Act, 2017 gives statutory backing to social audits of public programmes and services more broadly rather than for a single scheme, establishing Social Audit Units, providing for independent social auditors, securing community participation including access to relevant records, and mandating consideration of and follow-up action on audit findings; it is one of very few such State laws and must not be presented as a national model in force. D. Section 17 of the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, 2005 gives the Gram Sabha the monitoring and social-audit function for works in its area, and the Audit of Schemes Rules, 2011 require an independent State Social Audit Unit to facilitate the audit in every Gram Panchayat at least once every six months, so social audit here is a recurring statutory obligation on the implementing agency rather than an optional civil-society initiative.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Central and State Information Commissions are statutory bodies under the Right to Information Act, 2005 that decide complaints and second appeals concerning access to information and can secure the record, compensation and statutory compliance or penalty, but they cannot adjudicate the merits of the underlying pension, licence or service, so a citizen who wants the entitlement rather than the file is in the wrong forum; the composition, appointment and removal of these bodies are owned by the Polity material and are cross-linked rather than restated. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q23. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of What an Information Commission can and cannot do?

A. The Meghalaya Community Participation and Public Services Social Audit Act, 2017 gives statutory backing to social audits of public programmes and services more broadly rather than for a single scheme, establishing Social Audit Units, providing for independent social auditors, securing community participation including access to relevant records, and mandating consideration of and follow-up action on audit findings; it is one of very few such State laws and must not be presented as a national model in force. B. At a public hearing the audit findings are presented in an open forum in which officials must respond in front of the affected community, which creates a direct, on-the-record answerability event that a written information reply cannot produce; a hearing that surfaces a discrepancy without a mandated corrective timeline nevertheless achieves answerability without enforceability, which is the distinction that decides whether social audit produces deterrence or symbolic transparency. C. The Central and State Information Commissions are statutory bodies under the Right to Information Act, 2005 that decide complaints and second appeals concerning access to information and can secure the record, compensation and statutory compliance or penalty, but they cannot adjudicate the merits of the underlying pension, licence or service, so a citizen who wants the entitlement rather than the file is in the wrong forum; the composition, appointment and removal of these bodies are owned by the Polity material and are cross-linked rather than restated. D. The community layer supplies local knowledge and public legitimacy while the independent unit supplies facilitation, record access, resource-person training and separation from the implementing machinery, so it is incorrect to contrast a community-only model with a separate-unit model; capture can arise at either layer, because the same village that verifies the records also contains the hierarchy that may have benefited from the irregularity, and greater auditor independence reduces capture risk while reducing the hyper-local knowledge advantage.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Central and State Information Commissions are statutory bodies under the Right to Information Act, 2005 that decide complaints and second appeals concerning access to information and

can secure the record, compensation and statutory compliance or penalty, but they cannot adjudicate the merits of the underlying pension, licence or service, so a citizen who wants the entitlement rather than the file is in the wrong forum; the composition, appointment and removal of these bodies are owned by the Polity material and are cross-linked rather than restated. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q24. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about What an Information Commission can and cannot do?

A. At a public hearing the audit findings are presented in an open forum in which officials must respond in front of the affected community, which creates a direct, on-the-record answerability event that a written information reply cannot produce; a hearing that surfaces a discrepancy without a mandated corrective timeline nevertheless achieves answerability without enforceability, which is the distinction that decides whether social audit produces deterrence or symbolic transparency. B. Two questions decide social-audit quality - whether the facilitating unit is structurally separate from the department whose work is audited, and whether a finding triggers timed recovery, disciplinary, criminal or process-correction action - and applying these two tests converts a generic call for more transparency into a precise diagnosis; mandating follow-up strengthens deterrence and can also produce defensive behaviour such as under-reporting and resistance to audit access unless honest officials are protected. C. The Meghalaya Community Participation and Public Services Social Audit Act, 2017 gives statutory backing to social audits of public programmes and services more broadly rather than for a single scheme, establishing Social Audit Units, providing for independent social auditors, securing community participation including access to relevant records, and mandating consideration of and follow-up action on audit findings; it is one of very few such State laws and must not be presented as a national model in force. D. The Central and State Information Commissions are statutory bodies under the Right to Information Act, 2005 that decide complaints and second appeals concerning access to information and can secure the record, compensation and statutory compliance or penalty, but they cannot adjudicate the merits of the underlying pension, licence or service, so a citizen who wants the entitlement rather than the file is in the wrong forum; the composition, appointment and removal of these bodies are owned by the Polity material and are cross-linked rather than restated.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Central and State Information Commissions are statutory bodies under the Right to Information Act, 2005 that decide complaints and second appeals concerning access to information and can secure the record, compensation and statutory compliance or penalty, but they cannot adjudicate the merits of the underlying pension, licence or service, so a citizen who wants the entitlement rather than the file is in the wrong forum; the composition, appointment and removal of these bodies are owned by the Polity material and are cross-linked rather than restated. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Social audit defined against other audits?

A. Social audit is the participatory verification of records, expenditure and delivery, facilitated independently of the implementing agency and culminating in a public hearing and a follow-up process, and it is distinct from financial audit which tests expenditure regularity, from compliance audit which tests conformity with rules, from performance audit which tests economy, efficiency and effectiveness, and from individual grievance redress which resolves one person's complaint; it surfaces systemic patterns that no single complaint would reveal. B. The Meghalaya Community Participation and Public Services Social Audit Act, 2017 gives statutory backing to social audits of public programmes and services more broadly rather than for a single scheme, establishing Social Audit Units, providing for independent social auditors, securing community participation including access to relevant records, and mandating consideration of and follow-up action on audit findings; it is one of very few such State laws and must not be presented as a national model in force. C. Section 17 of the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, 2005 gives the Gram Sabha the monitoring and social-audit function for works in its area, and the Audit of Schemes Rules, 2011 require an independent State Social Audit Unit to facilitate the audit in every Gram Panchayat at least once every six months, so social audit here is a recurring statutory obligation on the implementing agency rather than an optional civil-society initiative. D. The community layer supplies local knowledge and public legitimacy while the independent unit supplies facilitation, record access, resource-person training and separation from the implementing machinery, so it is incorrect to contrast a community-only model with a separate-unit model; capture can arise at either layer, because the same village that verifies the records also contains the hierarchy that may have benefited from the irregularity, and greater auditor independence reduces capture risk while reducing the hyper-local knowledge

advantage.

Answer: A. Explanation: Social audit is the participatory verification of records, expenditure and delivery, facilitated independently of the implementing agency and culminating in a public hearing and a follow-up process, and it is distinct from financial audit which tests expenditure regularity, from compliance audit which tests conformity with rules, from performance audit which tests economy, efficiency and effectiveness, and from individual grievance redress which resolves one person's complaint; it surfaces systemic patterns that no single complaint would reveal. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q26. Which chronology card should be filed under Social audit defined against other audits?

A. At a public hearing the audit findings are presented in an open forum in which officials must respond in front of the affected community, which creates a direct, on-the-record answerability event that a written information reply cannot produce; a hearing that surfaces a discrepancy without a mandated corrective timeline nevertheless achieves answerability without enforceability, which is the distinction that decides whether social audit produces deterrence or symbolic transparency. B. Social audit is the participatory verification of records, expenditure and delivery, facilitated independently of the implementing agency and culminating in a public hearing and a follow-up process, and it is distinct from financial audit which tests expenditure regularity, from compliance audit which tests conformity with rules, from performance audit which tests economy, efficiency and effectiveness, and from individual grievance redress which resolves one person's complaint; it surfaces systemic patterns that no single complaint would reveal. C. The community layer supplies local knowledge and public legitimacy while the independent unit supplies facilitation, record access, resource-person training and separation from the implementing machinery, so it is incorrect to contrast a community-only model with a separate-unit model; capture can arise at either layer, because the same village that verifies the records also contains the hierarchy that may have benefited from the irregularity, and greater auditor independence reduces capture risk while reducing the hyper-local knowledge advantage. D. The Meghalaya Community Participation and Public Services Social Audit Act, 2017 gives statutory backing to social audits of public programmes and services more broadly rather than for a single scheme, establishing Social Audit Units, providing for independent social auditors, securing community participation including access to relevant records, and mandating consideration of and follow-up action on audit findings; it is one of very few such State laws and must not be presented as a national model in force.

Answer: B. Explanation: Social audit is the participatory verification of records, expenditure and delivery, facilitated independently of the implementing agency and culminating in a public hearing and a follow-up process, and it is distinct from financial audit which tests expenditure regularity, from compliance audit which tests conformity with rules, from performance audit which tests economy, efficiency and effectiveness, and from individual grievance redress which resolves one person's complaint; it surfaces systemic patterns that no single complaint would reveal. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q27. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Social audit defined against other audits?

A. The Meghalaya Community Participation and Public Services Social Audit Act, 2017 gives statutory backing to social audits of public programmes and services more broadly rather than for a single scheme, establishing Social Audit Units, providing for independent social auditors, securing community participation including access to relevant records, and mandating consideration of and follow-up action on audit findings; it is one of very few such State laws and must not be presented as a national model in force. B. At a public hearing the audit findings are presented in an open forum in which officials must respond in front of the affected community, which creates a direct, on-the-record answerability event that a written information reply cannot produce; a hearing that surfaces a discrepancy without a mandated corrective timeline nevertheless achieves answerability without enforceability, which is the distinction that decides whether social audit produces deterrence or symbolic transparency. C. Social audit is the participatory verification of records, expenditure and delivery, facilitated independently of the implementing agency and culminating in a public hearing and a follow-up process, and it is distinct from financial audit which tests expenditure regularity, from compliance audit which tests conformity with rules, from performance audit which tests economy, efficiency and effectiveness, and from individual grievance redress which resolves one person's complaint; it surfaces systemic patterns that no single complaint would reveal. D. Two questions decide social-audit quality - whether the facilitating

unit is structurally separate from the department whose work is audited, and whether a finding triggers timed recovery, disciplinary, criminal or process-correction action - and applying these two tests converts a generic call for more transparency into a precise diagnosis; mandating follow-up strengthens deterrence and can also produce defensive behaviour such as under-reporting and resistance to audit access unless honest officials are protected.

Answer: C. Explanation: Social audit is the participatory verification of records, expenditure and delivery, facilitated independently of the implementing agency and culminating in a public hearing and a follow-up process, and it is distinct from financial audit which tests expenditure regularity, from compliance audit which tests conformity with rules, from performance audit which tests economy, efficiency and effectiveness, and from individual grievance redress which resolves one person's complaint; it surfaces systemic patterns that no single complaint would reveal. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q28. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Social audit defined against other audits?

A. At a public hearing the audit findings are presented in an open forum in which officials must respond in front of the affected community, which creates a direct, on-the-record answerability event that a written information reply cannot produce; a hearing that surfaces a discrepancy without a mandated corrective timeline nevertheless achieves answerability without enforceability, which is the distinction that decides whether social audit produces deterrence or symbolic transparency. B. The chain runs from disclosure through comprehension, verification, answerability, follow-up and consequence to design feedback, and each stage has its own failure mode - published but unusable, unintelligible to the affected person, an auditor who is not independent of the implementer, officials absent from the hearing, findings recorded with no action-taken process, and the same finding recurring next cycle - and in India the chain typically breaks between verification and follow-up, so any strengthen-accountability answer that ignores the action-taken stage has missed the binding constraint. C. Two questions decide social-audit quality - whether the facilitating unit is structurally separate from the department whose work is audited, and whether a finding triggers timed recovery, disciplinary, criminal or process-correction action - and applying these two tests converts a generic call for more transparency into a precise diagnosis; mandating follow-up strengthens deterrence and can also produce defensive behaviour such as under-reporting and resistance to audit access unless honest officials are protected. D. Social audit is the participatory verification of records, expenditure and delivery, facilitated independently of the implementing agency and culminating in a public hearing and a follow-up process, and it is distinct from financial audit which tests expenditure regularity, from compliance audit which tests conformity with rules, from performance audit which tests economy, efficiency and effectiveness, and from individual grievance redress which resolves one person's complaint; it surfaces systemic patterns that no single complaint would reveal.

Answer: D. Explanation: Social audit is the participatory verification of records, expenditure and delivery, facilitated independently of the implementing agency and culminating in a public hearing and a follow-up process, and it is distinct from financial audit which tests expenditure regularity, from compliance audit which tests conformity with rules, from performance audit which tests economy, efficiency and effectiveness, and from individual grievance redress which resolves one person's complaint; it surfaces systemic patterns that no single complaint would reveal. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies The statutory basis in the rural employment guarantee?

A. Section 17 of the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, 2005 gives the Gram Sabha the monitoring and social-audit function for works in its area, and the Audit of Schemes Rules, 2011 require an independent State Social Audit Unit to facilitate the audit in every Gram Panchayat at least once every six months, so social audit here is a recurring statutory obligation on the implementing agency rather than an optional civil-society initiative. B. The community layer supplies local knowledge and public legitimacy while the independent unit supplies facilitation, record access, resource-person training and separation from the implementing machinery, so it is incorrect to contrast a community-only model with a separate-unit model; capture can arise at either layer, because the same village that verifies the records also contains the hierarchy that may have benefited from the irregularity, and greater auditor independence reduces capture risk while reducing the hyper-local knowledge advantage. C. At a public hearing the audit findings are presented in an open forum in which officials must respond in front of the affected community, which creates a direct, on-the-record answerability event that a written information reply cannot produce; a hearing that surfaces a discrepancy without a mandated corrective timeline nevertheless achieves answerability

without enforceability, which is the distinction that decides whether social audit produces deterrence or symbolic transparency. D. The Meghalaya Community Participation and Public Services Social Audit Act, 2017 gives statutory backing to social audits of public programmes and services more broadly rather than for a single scheme, establishing Social Audit Units, providing for independent social auditors, securing community participation including access to relevant records, and mandating consideration of and follow-up action on audit findings; it is one of very few such State laws and must not be presented as a national model in force.

Answer: A. Explanation: Section 17 of the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, 2005 gives the Gram Sabha the monitoring and social-audit function for works in its area, and the Audit of Schemes Rules, 2011 require an independent State Social Audit Unit to facilitate the audit in every Gram Panchayat at least once every six months, so social audit here is a recurring statutory obligation on the implementing agency rather than an optional civil-society initiative. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q30. Which chronology card should be filed under The statutory basis in the rural employment guarantee?

A. At a public hearing the audit findings are presented in an open forum in which officials must respond in front of the affected community, which creates a direct, on-the-record answerability event that a written information reply cannot produce; a hearing that surfaces a discrepancy without a mandated corrective timeline nevertheless achieves answerability without enforceability, which is the distinction that decides whether social audit produces deterrence or symbolic transparency. B. Section 17 of the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, 2005 gives the Gram Sabha the monitoring and social-audit function for works in its area, and the Audit of Schemes Rules, 2011 require an independent State Social Audit Unit to facilitate the audit in every Gram Panchayat at least once every six months, so social audit here is a recurring statutory obligation on the implementing agency rather than an optional civil-society initiative. C. Two questions decide social-audit quality - whether the facilitating unit is structurally separate from the department whose work is audited, and whether a finding triggers timed recovery, disciplinary, criminal or process-correction action - and applying these two tests converts a generic call for more transparency into a precise diagnosis; mandating follow-up strengthens deterrence and can also produce defensive behaviour such as under-reporting and resistance to audit access unless honest officials are protected. D. The Meghalaya Community Participation and Public Services Social Audit Act, 2017 gives statutory backing to social audits of public programmes and services more broadly rather than for a single scheme, establishing Social Audit Units, providing for independent social auditors, securing community participation including access to relevant records, and mandating consideration of and follow-up action on audit findings; it is one of very few such State laws and must not be presented as a national model in force.

Answer: B. Explanation: Section 17 of the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, 2005 gives the Gram Sabha the monitoring and social-audit function for works in its area, and the Audit of Schemes Rules, 2011 require an independent State Social Audit Unit to facilitate the audit in every Gram Panchayat at least once every six months, so social audit here is a recurring statutory obligation on the implementing agency rather than an optional civil-society initiative. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q31. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The statutory basis in the rural employment guarantee?

A. The chain runs from disclosure through comprehension, verification, answerability, follow-up and consequence to design feedback, and each stage has its own failure mode - published but unusable, unintelligible to the affected person, an auditor who is not independent of the implementer, officials absent from the hearing, findings recorded with no action-taken process, and the same finding recurring next cycle - and in India the chain typically breaks between verification and follow-up, so any strengthen-accountability answer that ignores the action-taken stage has missed the binding constraint. B. Two questions decide social-audit quality - whether the facilitating unit is structurally separate from the department whose work is audited, and whether a finding triggers timed recovery, disciplinary, criminal or process-correction action - and applying these two tests converts a generic call for more transparency into a precise diagnosis; mandating follow-up strengthens deterrence and can also produce defensive behaviour such as under-reporting and resistance to audit access unless honest officials are protected. C. Section 17 of the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, 2005 gives the Gram Sabha the monitoring and social-audit

function for works in its area, and the Audit of Schemes Rules, 2011 require an independent State Social Audit Unit to facilitate the audit in every Gram Panchayat at least once every six months, so social audit here is a recurring statutory obligation on the implementing agency rather than an optional civil-society initiative. D. At a public hearing the audit findings are presented in an open forum in which officials must respond in front of the affected community, which creates a direct, on-the-record answerability event that a written information reply cannot produce; a hearing that surfaces a discrepancy without a mandated corrective timeline nevertheless achieves answerability without enforceability, which is the distinction that decides whether social audit produces deterrence or symbolic transparency.

Answer: C. Explanation: Section 17 of the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, 2005 gives the Gram Sabha the monitoring and social-audit function for works in its area, and the Audit of Schemes Rules, 2011 require an independent State Social Audit Unit to facilitate the audit in every Gram Panchayat at least once every six months, so social audit here is a recurring statutory obligation on the implementing agency rather than an optional civil-society initiative. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q32. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The statutory basis in the rural employment guarantee?

A. Two questions decide social-audit quality - whether the facilitating unit is structurally separate from the department whose work is audited, and whether a finding triggers timed recovery, disciplinary, criminal or process-correction action - and applying these two tests converts a generic call for more transparency into a precise diagnosis; mandating follow-up strengthens deterrence and can also produce defensive behaviour such as under-reporting and resistance to audit access unless honest officials are protected. B. Accountability operates in three directions - horizontal, where one state institution checks another through public audit, legislative committees, vigilance, the corruption ombudsman, courts and regulators; vertical, where citizens check the state through elections, legislative questioning and political competition; and social, where citizens check the state directly between elections through information requests, social audit, public hearings, citizen report cards, community monitoring and the media - and the social layer is the one this subject owns and the one in which India innovated. C. The chain runs from disclosure through comprehension, verification, answerability, follow-up and consequence to design feedback, and each stage has its own failure mode - published but unusable, unintelligible to the affected person, an auditor who is not independent of the implementer, officials absent from the hearing, findings recorded with no action-taken process, and the same finding recurring next cycle - and in India the chain typically breaks between verification and follow-up, so any strengthen-accountability answer that ignores the action-taken stage has missed the binding constraint. D. Section 17 of the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, 2005 gives the Gram Sabha the monitoring and social-audit function for works in its area, and the Audit of Schemes Rules, 2011 require an independent State Social Audit Unit to facilitate the audit in every Gram Panchayat at least once every six months, so social audit here is a recurring statutory obligation on the implementing agency rather than an optional civil-society initiative.

Answer: D. Explanation: Section 17 of the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, 2005 gives the Gram Sabha the monitoring and social-audit function for works in its area, and the Audit of Schemes Rules, 2011 require an independent State Social Audit Unit to facilitate the audit in every Gram Panchayat at least once every six months, so social audit here is a recurring statutory obligation on the implementing agency rather than an optional civil-society initiative. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Community verification and independent facilitation are complementary?

A. The community layer supplies local knowledge and public legitimacy while the independent unit supplies facilitation, record access, resource-person training and separation from the implementing machinery, so it is incorrect to contrast a community-only model with a separate-unit model; capture can arise at either layer, because the same village that verifies the records also contains the hierarchy that may have benefited from the irregularity, and greater auditor independence reduces capture risk while reducing the hyper-local knowledge advantage. B. The Meghalaya Community Participation and Public Services Social Audit Act, 2017 gives statutory backing to social audits of public programmes and services more broadly rather than for a single scheme, establishing Social Audit Units, providing for independent social auditors, securing community participation including access to relevant records, and mandating consideration of and follow-up action on audit findings; it is one of very few such State laws and must not be presented as a national model in force. C. Two questions decide social-audit quality - whether the facilitating unit is structurally separate from the department whose work is audited, and whether a finding triggers timed recovery, disciplinary, criminal or process-correction action - and applying these two tests converts a generic call for more transparency into a precise diagnosis; mandating follow-up strengthens deterrence and can also produce defensive behaviour such as under-reporting and resistance to audit access unless honest officials are protected. D. At a public hearing the audit findings are presented in an open forum in which officials must respond in front of the affected community, which creates a direct, on-the-record answerability event that a written information reply cannot produce; a hearing that surfaces a discrepancy without a mandated corrective timeline nevertheless achieves answerability without enforceability, which is the distinction that decides whether social audit produces deterrence or symbolic transparency.

Answer: A. Explanation: The community layer supplies local knowledge and public legitimacy while the independent unit supplies facilitation, record access, resource-person training and separation from the implementing machinery, so it is incorrect to contrast a community-only model with a separate-unit model; capture can arise at either layer, because the same village that verifies the records also contains the hierarchy that may have benefited from the irregularity, and greater auditor independence reduces capture risk while reducing the hyper-local knowledge advantage. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q34. Which chronology card should be filed under Community verification and independent facilitation are complementary?

A. At a public hearing the audit findings are presented in an open forum in which officials must respond in front of the affected community, which creates a direct, on-the-record answerability event that a written information reply cannot produce; a hearing that surfaces a discrepancy without a mandated corrective timeline nevertheless achieves answerability without enforceability, which is the distinction that decides whether social audit produces deterrence or symbolic transparency. B. The community layer supplies local knowledge and public legitimacy while the independent unit supplies facilitation, record access, resource-person training and separation from the implementing machinery, so it is incorrect to contrast a community-only model with a separate-unit model; capture can arise at either layer, because the same village that verifies the records also contains the hierarchy that may have benefited from the irregularity, and greater auditor independence reduces capture risk while reducing the hyper-local knowledge advantage. C. Two questions decide social-audit quality - whether the facilitating unit is structurally separate from the department whose work is audited, and whether a finding triggers timed recovery, disciplinary, criminal or process-correction action - and applying these two tests converts a generic call for more transparency into a precise diagnosis; mandating follow-up strengthens deterrence and can also produce defensive behaviour such as under-reporting and resistance to audit access unless honest officials are protected. D. The chain runs from disclosure through comprehension, verification, answerability, follow-up and consequence to design feedback, and each stage has its own failure mode - published but unusable, unintelligible to the affected person, an auditor who is not independent of the implementer, officials absent from the hearing, findings recorded with no action-taken process, and the same finding recurring next cycle - and in India the chain typically breaks between verification and follow-up, so any strengthen-accountability answer that ignores the action-taken stage has missed the binding constraint.

Answer: B. Explanation: The community layer supplies local knowledge and public legitimacy while the independent unit supplies facilitation, record access, resource-person training and separation from the

implementing machinery, so it is incorrect to contrast a community-only model with a separate-unit model; capture can arise at either layer, because the same village that verifies the records also contains the hierarchy that may have benefited from the irregularity, and greater auditor independence reduces capture risk while reducing the hyper-local knowledge advantage. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q35. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Community verification and independent facilitation are complementary?

A. The chain runs from disclosure through comprehension, verification, answerability, follow-up and consequence to design feedback, and each stage has its own failure mode - published but unusable, unintelligible to the affected person, an auditor who is not independent of the implementer, officials absent from the hearing, findings recorded with no action-taken process, and the same finding recurring next cycle - and in India the chain typically breaks between verification and follow-up, so any strengthen-accountability answer that ignores the action-taken stage has missed the binding constraint. B. Accountability operates in three directions - horizontal, where one state institution checks another through public audit, legislative committees, vigilance, the corruption ombudsman, courts and regulators; vertical, where citizens check the state through elections, legislative questioning and political competition; and social, where citizens check the state directly between elections through information requests, social audit, public hearings, citizen report cards, community monitoring and the media - and the social layer is the one this subject owns and the one in which India innovated. C. The community layer supplies local knowledge and public legitimacy while the independent unit supplies facilitation, record access, resource-person training and separation from the implementing machinery, so it is incorrect to contrast a community-only model with a separate-unit model; capture can arise at either layer, because the same village that verifies the records also contains the hierarchy that may have benefited from the irregularity, and greater auditor independence reduces capture risk while reducing the hyper-local knowledge advantage. D. Two questions decide social-audit quality - whether the facilitating unit is structurally separate from the department whose work is audited, and whether a finding triggers timed recovery, disciplinary, criminal or process-correction action - and applying these two tests converts a generic call for more transparency into a precise diagnosis; mandating follow-up strengthens deterrence and can also produce defensive behaviour such as under-reporting and resistance to audit access unless honest officials are protected.

Answer: C. Explanation: The community layer supplies local knowledge and public legitimacy while the independent unit supplies facilitation, record access, resource-person training and separation from the implementing machinery, so it is incorrect to contrast a community-only model with a separate-unit model; capture can arise at either layer, because the same village that verifies the records also contains the hierarchy that may have benefited from the irregularity, and greater auditor independence reduces capture risk while reducing the hyper-local knowledge advantage. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q36. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Community verification and independent facilitation are complementary?

A. The chain runs from disclosure through comprehension, verification, answerability, follow-up and consequence to design feedback, and each stage has its own failure mode - published but unusable, unintelligible to the affected person, an auditor who is not independent of the implementer, officials absent from the hearing, findings recorded with no action-taken process, and the same finding recurring next cycle - and in India the chain typically breaks between verification and follow-up, so any strengthen-accountability answer that ignores the action-taken stage has missed the binding constraint. B. Social instruments generate answerability powerfully and enforceability weakly because they usually carry no sanction, so they work best when coupled to a horizontal instrument that can impose a consequence, as when audit findings feed an action-taken report and, where warranted, a vigilance or public-audit follow-up; a dashboard that shows failure without naming who must correct it produces informed helplessness rather than accountability. C. Accountability operates in three directions - horizontal, where one state institution checks another through public audit, legislative committees, vigilance, the corruption ombudsman, courts and regulators; vertical, where citizens check the state through elections, legislative questioning and political competition; and social, where citizens check the state directly between elections through information requests, social audit, public hearings, citizen report cards, community monitoring and the media - and the social layer is the one this subject owns and the one in which India innovated. D. The community layer supplies local knowledge and public legitimacy while the independent

unit supplies facilitation, record access, resource-person training and separation from the implementing machinery, so it is incorrect to contrast a community-only model with a separate-unit model; capture can arise at either layer, because the same village that verifies the records also contains the hierarchy that may have benefited from the irregularity, and greater auditor independence reduces capture risk while reducing the hyper-local knowledge advantage.

Answer: D. Explanation: The community layer supplies local knowledge and public legitimacy while the independent unit supplies facilitation, record access, resource-person training and separation from the implementing machinery, so it is incorrect to contrast a community-only model with a separate-unit model; capture can arise at either layer, because the same village that verifies the records also contains the hierarchy that may have benefited from the irregularity, and greater auditor independence reduces capture risk while reducing the hyper-local knowledge advantage. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies The generalised State statute?

A. The Meghalaya Community Participation and Public Services Social Audit Act, 2017 gives statutory backing to social audits of public programmes and services more broadly rather than for a single scheme, establishing Social Audit Units, providing for independent social auditors, securing community participation including access to relevant records, and mandating consideration of and follow-up action on audit findings; it is one of very few such State laws and must not be presented as a national model in force. B. The chain runs from disclosure through comprehension, verification, answerability, follow-up and consequence to design feedback, and each stage has its own failure mode - published but unusable, unintelligible to the affected person, an auditor who is not independent of the implementer, officials absent from the hearing, findings recorded with no action-taken process, and the same finding recurring next cycle - and in India the chain typically breaks between verification and follow-up, so any strengthen-accountability answer that ignores the action-taken stage has missed the binding constraint. C. Two questions decide social-audit quality - whether the facilitating unit is structurally separate from the department whose work is audited, and whether a finding triggers timed recovery, disciplinary, criminal or process-correction action - and applying these two tests converts a generic call for more transparency into a precise diagnosis; mandating follow-up strengthens deterrence and can also produce defensive behaviour such as under-reporting and resistance to audit access unless honest officials are protected. D. At a public hearing the audit findings are presented in an open forum in which officials must respond in front of the affected community, which creates a direct, on-the-record answerability event that a written information reply cannot produce; a hearing that surfaces a discrepancy without a mandated corrective timeline nevertheless achieves answerability without enforceability, which is the distinction that decides whether social audit produces deterrence or symbolic transparency.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Meghalaya Community Participation and Public Services Social Audit Act, 2017 gives statutory backing to social audits of public programmes and services more broadly rather than for a single scheme, establishing Social Audit Units, providing for independent social auditors, securing community participation including access to relevant records, and mandating consideration of and follow-up action on audit findings; it is one of very few such State laws and must not be presented as a national model in force. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q38. Which chronology card should be filed under The generalised State statute?

A. Two questions decide social-audit quality - whether the facilitating unit is structurally separate from the department whose work is audited, and whether a finding triggers timed recovery, disciplinary, criminal or process-correction action - and applying these two tests converts a generic call for more transparency into a precise diagnosis; mandating follow-up strengthens deterrence and can also produce defensive behaviour such as under-reporting and resistance to audit access unless honest officials are protected. B. The Meghalaya Community Participation and Public Services Social Audit Act, 2017 gives statutory backing to social audits of public programmes and services more broadly rather than for a single scheme, establishing Social Audit Units, providing for independent social auditors, securing community participation including access to relevant records, and mandating consideration of and follow-up action on audit findings; it is one of very few such State laws and must not be presented as a national model in force. C. Accountability operates in three directions - horizontal, where one state institution checks another through public audit, legislative committees, vigilance, the corruption ombudsman, courts and regulators; vertical, where citizens check the state through elections, legislative questioning and political competition; and social, where citizens

check the state directly between elections through information requests, social audit, public hearings, citizen report cards, community monitoring and the media - and the social layer is the one this subject owns and the one in which India innovated. D. The chain runs from disclosure through comprehension, verification, answerability, follow-up and consequence to design feedback, and each stage has its own failure mode - published but unusable, unintelligible to the affected person, an auditor who is not independent of the implementer, officials absent from the hearing, findings recorded with no action-taken process, and the same finding recurring next cycle - and in India the chain typically breaks between verification and follow-up, so any strengthen-accountability answer that ignores the action-taken stage has missed the binding constraint.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Meghalaya Community Participation and Public Services Social Audit Act, 2017 gives statutory backing to social audits of public programmes and services more broadly rather than for a single scheme, establishing Social Audit Units, providing for independent social auditors, securing community participation including access to relevant records, and mandating consideration of and follow-up action on audit findings; it is one of very few such State laws and must not be presented as a national model in force. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q39. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The generalised State statute?

A. Social instruments generate answerability powerfully and enforceability weakly because they usually carry no sanction, so they work best when coupled to a horizontal instrument that can impose a consequence, as when audit findings feed an action-taken report and, where warranted, a vigilance or public-audit follow-up; a dashboard that shows failure without naming who must correct it produces informed helplessness rather than accountability. B. The chain runs from disclosure through comprehension, verification, answerability, follow-up and consequence to design feedback, and each stage has its own failure mode - published but unusable, unintelligible to the affected person, an auditor who is not independent of the implementer, officials absent from the hearing, findings recorded with no action-taken process, and the same finding recurring next cycle - and in India the chain typically breaks between verification and follow-up, so any strengthen-accountability answer that ignores the action-taken stage has missed the binding constraint. C. The Meghalaya Community Participation and Public Services Social Audit Act, 2017 gives statutory backing to social audits of public programmes and services more broadly rather than for a single scheme, establishing Social Audit Units, providing for independent social auditors, securing community participation including access to relevant records, and mandating consideration of and follow-up action on audit findings; it is one of very few such State laws and must not be presented as a national model in force. D. Accountability operates in three directions - horizontal, where one state institution checks another through public audit, legislative committees, vigilance, the corruption ombudsman, courts and regulators; vertical, where citizens check the state through elections, legislative questioning and political competition; and social, where citizens check the state directly between elections through information requests, social audit, public hearings, citizen report cards, community monitoring and the media - and the social layer is the one this subject owns and the one in which India innovated.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Meghalaya Community Participation and Public Services Social Audit Act, 2017 gives statutory backing to social audits of public programmes and services more broadly rather than for a single scheme, establishing Social Audit Units, providing for independent social auditors, securing community participation including access to relevant records, and mandating consideration of and follow-up action on audit findings; it is one of very few such State laws and must not be presented as a national model in force. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q40. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The generalised State statute?

A. Accountability operates in three directions - horizontal, where one state institution checks another through public audit, legislative committees, vigilance, the corruption ombudsman, courts and regulators; vertical, where citizens check the state through elections, legislative questioning and political competition; and social, where citizens check the state directly between elections through information requests, social audit, public hearings, citizen report cards, community monitoring and the media - and the social layer is the one this subject owns and the one in which India innovated. B. The Comptroller and Auditor-General is the constitutional public auditor under Articles 148 to 151 conducting financial, compliance and performance audit that feeds legislative scrutiny and is not an investigator, prosecutor or grievance forum; the Central Vigilance Commission under the Central Vigilance Commission Act, 2003 exercises superintendence and advice on vigilance in central organisations and does not convict; the Lokpal under the Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013 inquires into corruption complaints against covered public servants and is not a

general grievance portal; and the Union grievance platform registers, routes, tracks and escalates administrative grievances against a 21-day benchmark with 30 days for appeals under the August 2024 comprehensive guidelines without being adjudicatory. C. Social instruments generate answerability powerfully and enforceability weakly because they usually carry no sanction, so they work best when coupled to a horizontal instrument that can impose a consequence, as when audit findings feed an action-taken report and, where warranted, a vigilance or public-audit follow-up; a dashboard that shows failure without naming who must correct it produces informed helplessness rather than accountability. D. The Meghalaya Community Participation and Public Services Social Audit Act, 2017 gives statutory backing to social audits of public programmes and services more broadly rather than for a single scheme, establishing Social Audit Units, providing for independent social auditors, securing community participation including access to relevant records, and mandating consideration of and follow-up action on audit findings; it is one of very few such State laws and must not be presented as a national model in force.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Meghalaya Community Participation and Public Services Social Audit Act, 2017 gives statutory backing to social audits of public programmes and services more broadly rather than for a single scheme, establishing Social Audit Units, providing for independent social auditors, securing community participation including access to relevant records, and mandating consideration of and follow-up action on audit findings; it is one of very few such State laws and must not be presented as a national model in force. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies The public hearing as face-to-face answerability?

A. At a public hearing the audit findings are presented in an open forum in which officials must respond in front of the affected community, which creates a direct, on-the-record answerability event that a written information reply cannot produce; a hearing that surfaces a discrepancy without a mandated corrective timeline nevertheless achieves answerability without enforceability, which is the distinction that decides whether social audit produces deterrence or symbolic transparency. B. The chain runs from disclosure through comprehension, verification, answerability, follow-up and consequence to design feedback, and each stage has its own failure mode - published but unusable, unintelligible to the affected person, an auditor who is not independent of the implementer, officials absent from the hearing, findings recorded with no action-taken process, and the same finding recurring next cycle - and in India the chain typically breaks between verification and follow-up, so any strengthen-accountability answer that ignores the action-taken stage has missed the binding constraint. C. Two questions decide social-audit quality - whether the facilitating unit is structurally separate from the department whose work is audited, and whether a finding triggers timed recovery, disciplinary, criminal or process-correction action - and applying these two tests converts a generic call for more transparency into a precise diagnosis; mandating follow-up strengthens deterrence and can also produce defensive behaviour such as under-reporting and resistance to audit access unless honest officials are protected. D. Accountability operates in three directions - horizontal, where one state institution checks another through public audit, legislative committees, vigilance, the corruption ombudsman, courts and regulators; vertical, where citizens check the state through elections, legislative questioning and political competition; and social, where citizens check the state directly between elections through information requests, social audit, public hearings, citizen report cards, community monitoring and the media - and the social layer is the one this subject owns and the one in which India innovated.

Answer: A. Explanation: At a public hearing the audit findings are presented in an open forum in which officials must respond in front of the affected community, which creates a direct, on-the-record answerability event that a written information reply cannot produce; a hearing that surfaces a discrepancy without a mandated corrective timeline nevertheless achieves answerability without enforceability, which is the distinction that decides whether social audit produces deterrence or symbolic transparency. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q42. Which chronology card should be filed under The public hearing as face-to-face answerability?

A. Accountability operates in three directions - horizontal, where one state institution checks another through public audit, legislative committees, vigilance, the corruption ombudsman, courts and regulators; vertical, where citizens check the state through elections, legislative questioning and political competition; and social, where citizens check the state directly between elections through information requests, social audit, public hearings, citizen report cards, community monitoring and the media - and the social layer is the one this subject owns and the one in which India innovated. B. At a public hearing the audit findings are presented in an open forum in which officials must respond in front of the affected community, which creates a direct, on-the-record answerability event that a written information reply cannot produce; a hearing that surfaces a discrepancy without a mandated corrective timeline nevertheless achieves answerability without enforceability, which is the distinction that decides whether social audit produces deterrence or symbolic transparency. C. The chain runs from disclosure through comprehension, verification, answerability, follow-up and consequence to design feedback, and each stage has its own failure mode - published but unusable, unintelligible to the affected person, an auditor who is not independent of the implementer, officials absent from the hearing, findings recorded with no action-taken process, and the same finding recurring next cycle - and in India the chain typically breaks between verification and follow-up, so any strengthen-accountability answer that ignores the action-taken stage has missed the binding constraint. D. Social instruments generate answerability powerfully and enforceability weakly because they usually carry no sanction, so they work best when coupled to a horizontal instrument that can impose a consequence, as when audit findings feed an action-taken report and, where warranted, a vigilance or public-audit follow-up; a dashboard that shows failure without naming who must correct it produces informed helplessness rather than accountability.

Answer: B. Explanation: At a public hearing the audit findings are presented in an open forum in which officials must respond in front of the affected community, which creates a direct, on-the-record answerability event that a written information reply cannot produce; a hearing that surfaces a discrepancy without a mandated corrective timeline nevertheless achieves answerability without enforceability, which is the distinction that decides whether social audit produces deterrence or symbolic transparency. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q43. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The public hearing as face-to-face answerability?

A. Social instruments generate answerability powerfully and enforceability weakly because they usually carry no sanction, so they work best when coupled to a horizontal instrument that can impose a consequence, as when audit findings feed an action-taken report and, where warranted, a vigilance or public-audit follow-up; a dashboard that shows failure without naming who must correct it produces informed helplessness rather than accountability. B. The Comptroller and Auditor-General is the constitutional public auditor under Articles 148 to 151 conducting financial, compliance and performance audit that feeds legislative scrutiny and is not an investigator, prosecutor or grievance forum; the Central Vigilance Commission under the Central Vigilance Commission Act, 2003 exercises superintendence and advice on vigilance in central organisations and does not convict; the Lokpal under the Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013 inquires into corruption complaints against covered public servants and is not a general grievance portal; and the Union grievance platform registers, routes, tracks and escalates administrative grievances against a 21-day benchmark with 30 days for appeals under the August 2024 comprehensive guidelines without being adjudicatory. C. At a public hearing the audit findings are presented in an open forum in which officials must respond in front of the affected community, which creates a direct, on-the-record answerability event that a written information reply cannot produce; a hearing that surfaces a discrepancy without a mandated corrective timeline nevertheless achieves answerability without enforceability, which is the distinction that decides whether social audit produces deterrence or symbolic transparency. D. Accountability operates in three directions - horizontal, where one state institution checks another through public audit, legislative committees, vigilance, the corruption ombudsman, courts and regulators; vertical, where citizens check the state through elections, legislative questioning and political competition; and social, where citizens check the state directly between elections through information requests, social audit, public hearings, citizen report cards, community monitoring and the media - and the social layer is the one this subject owns and the one in which India innovated.

Answer: C. Explanation: At a public hearing the audit findings are presented in an open forum in which officials must respond in front of the affected community, which creates a direct, on-the-record answerability event that a written information reply cannot produce; a hearing that surfaces a discrepancy without a mandated corrective timeline nevertheless achieves answerability without enforceability, which is the distinction that decides whether social audit produces deterrence or symbolic transparency. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q44. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The public hearing as face-to-face answerability?

A. The remedy sought determines the forum - information denied or delayed goes to the Public Information Officer, then a first appeal, then the Information Commission; a service delayed or refused goes to the department, then a notified service-guarantee route where one exists, then the grievance platform; money misused in a scheme goes to social audit, performance audit and legislative scrutiny; corruption by a public servant goes to vigilance, the corruption ombudsman and investigative agencies; community-level record falsification goes to social audit with a public hearing; a regulatory or sectoral dispute goes to the sector regulator and its appellate tribunal; and a personal-data breach has no operative route until the data-protection Board's members are appointed and the relevant duties commence. B. The Comptroller and Auditor-General is the constitutional public auditor under Articles 148 to 151 conducting financial, compliance and performance audit that feeds legislative scrutiny and is not an investigator, prosecutor or grievance forum; the Central Vigilance Commission under the Central Vigilance Commission Act, 2003 exercises superintendence and advice on vigilance in central organisations and does not convict; the Lokpal under the Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013 inquires into corruption complaints against covered public servants and is not a general grievance portal; and the Union grievance platform registers, routes, tracks and escalates administrative grievances against a 21-day benchmark with 30 days for appeals under the August 2024 comprehensive guidelines without being adjudicatory. C. Social instruments generate answerability powerfully and enforceability weakly because they usually carry no sanction, so they work best when coupled to a horizontal instrument that can impose a consequence, as when audit findings feed an action-taken report and, where warranted, a vigilance or public-audit follow-up; a dashboard that shows failure without naming who must correct it produces informed helplessness rather than accountability. D. At a public hearing the audit findings are presented in an open forum in which officials must respond in front of the affected community, which creates a direct, on-the-record answerability event that a written information reply cannot produce; a hearing that surfaces a discrepancy without a mandated corrective timeline nevertheless achieves answerability without enforceability, which is the distinction that decides whether social audit produces deterrence or symbolic transparency.

Answer: D. Explanation: At a public hearing the audit findings are presented in an open forum in which officials must respond in front of the affected community, which creates a direct, on-the-record answerability event that a written information reply cannot produce; a hearing that surfaces a discrepancy without a mandated corrective timeline nevertheless achieves answerability without enforceability, which is the distinction that decides whether social audit produces deterrence or symbolic transparency. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies The independence test and the follow-up test?

A. Two questions decide social-audit quality - whether the facilitating unit is structurally separate from the department whose work is audited, and whether a finding triggers timed recovery, disciplinary, criminal or process-correction action - and applying these two tests converts a generic call for more transparency into a precise diagnosis; mandating follow-up strengthens deterrence and can also produce defensive behaviour such as under-reporting and resistance to audit access unless honest officials are protected. B. Accountability operates in three directions - horizontal, where one state institution checks another through public audit, legislative committees, vigilance, the corruption ombudsman, courts and regulators; vertical, where citizens check the state through elections, legislative questioning and political competition; and social, where citizens check the state directly between elections through information requests, social audit, public hearings, citizen report cards, community monitoring and the media - and the social layer is the one this subject owns and the one in which India innovated. C. Social instruments generate answerability powerfully and enforceability weakly because they usually carry no sanction, so they work best when coupled to a horizontal instrument that can impose a consequence, as when audit findings feed an action-taken report and, where warranted, a vigilance or public-audit follow-up; a dashboard that shows failure without naming who must

correct it produces informed helplessness rather than accountability. D. The chain runs from disclosure through comprehension, verification, answerability, follow-up and consequence to design feedback, and each stage has its own failure mode - published but unusable, unintelligible to the affected person, an auditor who is not independent of the implementer, officials absent from the hearing, findings recorded with no action-taken process, and the same finding recurring next cycle - and in India the chain typically breaks between verification and follow-up, so any strengthen-accountability answer that ignores the action-taken stage has missed the binding constraint.

Answer: A. Explanation: Two questions decide social-audit quality - whether the facilitating unit is structurally separate from the department whose work is audited, and whether a finding triggers timed recovery, disciplinary, criminal or process-correction action - and applying these two tests converts a generic call for more transparency into a precise diagnosis; mandating follow-up strengthens deterrence and can also produce defensive behaviour such as under-reporting and resistance to audit access unless honest officials are protected. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q46. Which chronology card should be filed under The independence test and the follow-up test?

A. The Comptroller and Auditor-General is the constitutional public auditor under Articles 148 to 151 conducting financial, compliance and performance audit that feeds legislative scrutiny and is not an investigator, prosecutor or grievance forum; the Central Vigilance Commission under the Central Vigilance Commission Act, 2003 exercises superintendence and advice on vigilance in central organisations and does not convict; the Lokpal under the Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013 inquires into corruption complaints against covered public servants and is not a general grievance portal; and the Union grievance platform registers, routes, tracks and escalates administrative grievances against a 21-day benchmark with 30 days for appeals under the August 2024 comprehensive guidelines without being adjudicatory. B. Two questions decide social-audit quality - whether the facilitating unit is structurally separate from the department whose work is audited, and whether a finding triggers timed recovery, disciplinary, criminal or process-correction action - and applying these two tests converts a generic call for more transparency into a precise diagnosis; mandating follow-up strengthens deterrence and can also produce defensive behaviour such as under-reporting and resistance to audit access unless honest officials are protected. C. Social instruments generate answerability powerfully and enforceability weakly because they usually carry no sanction, so they work best when coupled to a horizontal instrument that can impose a consequence, as when audit findings feed an action-taken report and, where warranted, a vigilance or public-audit follow-up; a dashboard that shows failure without naming who must correct it produces informed helplessness rather than accountability. D. Accountability operates in three directions - horizontal, where one state institution checks another through public audit, legislative committees, vigilance, the corruption ombudsman, courts and regulators; vertical, where citizens check the state through elections, legislative questioning and political competition; and social, where citizens check the state directly between elections through information requests, social audit, public hearings, citizen report cards, community monitoring and the media - and the social layer is the one this subject owns and the one in which India innovated.

Answer: B. Explanation: Two questions decide social-audit quality - whether the facilitating unit is structurally separate from the department whose work is audited, and whether a finding triggers timed recovery, disciplinary, criminal or process-correction action - and applying these two tests converts a generic call for more transparency into a precise diagnosis; mandating follow-up strengthens deterrence and can also produce defensive behaviour such as under-reporting and resistance to audit access unless honest officials are protected. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q47. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The independence test and the follow-up test?

A. The Comptroller and Auditor-General is the constitutional public auditor under Articles 148 to 151 conducting financial, compliance and performance audit that feeds legislative scrutiny and is not an investigator, prosecutor or grievance forum; the Central Vigilance Commission under the Central Vigilance Commission Act, 2003 exercises superintendence and advice on vigilance in central organisations and does not convict; the Lokpal under the Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013 inquires into corruption complaints against covered public servants and is not a general grievance portal; and the Union grievance platform registers, routes, tracks and escalates administrative grievances against a 21-day benchmark with 30 days for appeals under the August 2024 comprehensive guidelines without being adjudicatory. B. Social instruments generate answerability powerfully and enforceability weakly because they usually carry no sanction, so they work best when coupled to a horizontal instrument that can impose a consequence, as

when audit findings feed an action-taken report and, where warranted, a vigilance or public-audit follow-up; a dashboard that shows failure without naming who must correct it produces informed helplessness rather than accountability. C. Two questions decide social-audit quality - whether the facilitating unit is structurally separate from the department whose work is audited, and whether a finding triggers timed recovery, disciplinary, criminal or process-correction action - and applying these two tests converts a generic call for more transparency into a precise diagnosis; mandating follow-up strengthens deterrence and can also produce defensive behaviour such as under-reporting and resistance to audit access unless honest officials are protected. D. The remedy sought determines the forum - information denied or delayed goes to the Public Information Officer, then a first appeal, then the Information Commission; a service delayed or refused goes to the department, then a notified service-guarantee route where one exists, then the grievance platform; money misused in a scheme goes to social audit, performance audit and legislative scrutiny; corruption by a public servant goes to vigilance, the corruption ombudsman and investigative agencies; community-level record falsification goes to social audit with a public hearing; a regulatory or sectoral dispute goes to the sector regulator and its appellate tribunal; and a personal-data breach has no operative route until the data-protection Board's members are appointed and the relevant duties commence.

Answer: C. Explanation: Two questions decide social-audit quality - whether the facilitating unit is structurally separate from the department whose work is audited, and whether a finding triggers timed recovery, disciplinary, criminal or process-correction action - and applying these two tests converts a generic call for more transparency into a precise diagnosis; mandating follow-up strengthens deterrence and can also produce defensive behaviour such as under-reporting and resistance to audit access unless honest officials are protected. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q48. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The independence test and the follow-up test?

A. The remedy sought determines the forum - information denied or delayed goes to the Public Information Officer, then a first appeal, then the Information Commission; a service delayed or refused goes to the department, then a notified service-guarantee route where one exists, then the grievance platform; money misused in a scheme goes to social audit, performance audit and legislative scrutiny; corruption by a public servant goes to vigilance, the corruption ombudsman and investigative agencies; community-level record falsification goes to social audit with a public hearing; a regulatory or sectoral dispute goes to the sector regulator and its appellate tribunal; and a personal-data breach has no operative route until the data-protection Board's members are appointed and the relevant duties commence. B. Audit examines records and systems after the fact, investigation gathers evidence of a specific wrong, adjudication decides rights between parties with due process, and grievance redress resolves an individual's service complaint administratively, and naming which of the four a question needs is worth more than describing any of them; the same discipline resolves applied problems, since an official who learns of a quality failure owes a duty to report through a channel that creates a record, and confidentiality of a source or of commercially sensitive material does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the authority competent to act. C. The Comptroller and Auditor-General is the constitutional public auditor under Articles 148 to 151 conducting financial, compliance and performance audit that feeds legislative scrutiny and is not an investigator, prosecutor or grievance forum; the Central Vigilance Commission under the Central Vigilance Commission Act, 2003 exercises superintendence and advice on vigilance in central organisations and does not convict; the Lokpal under the Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013 inquires into corruption complaints against covered public servants and is not a general grievance portal; and the Union grievance platform registers, routes, tracks and escalates administrative grievances against a 21-day benchmark with 30 days for appeals under the August 2024 comprehensive guidelines without being adjudicatory. D. Two questions decide social-audit quality - whether the facilitating unit is structurally separate from the department whose work is audited, and whether a finding triggers timed recovery, disciplinary, criminal or process-correction action - and applying these two tests converts a generic call for more transparency into a precise diagnosis; mandating follow-up strengthens deterrence and can also produce defensive behaviour such as under-reporting and resistance to audit access unless honest officials are protected.

Answer: D. Explanation: Two questions decide social-audit quality - whether the facilitating unit is structurally separate from the department whose work is audited, and whether a finding triggers timed recovery, disciplinary, criminal or process-correction action - and applying these two tests converts a generic call for more transparency into a precise diagnosis; mandating follow-up strengthens deterrence and can also produce defensive behaviour such as under-reporting and resistance to audit access unless honest officials

are protected. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Where the visibility-to-correction chain breaks?

A. The chain runs from disclosure through comprehension, verification, answerability, follow-up and consequence to design feedback, and each stage has its own failure mode - published but unusable, unintelligible to the affected person, an auditor who is not independent of the implementer, officials absent from the hearing, findings recorded with no action-taken process, and the same finding recurring next cycle - and in India the chain typically breaks between verification and follow-up, so any strengthen-accountability answer that ignores the action-taken stage has missed the binding constraint. B. The Comptroller and Auditor-General is the constitutional public auditor under Articles 148 to 151 conducting financial, compliance and performance audit that feeds legislative scrutiny and is not an investigator, prosecutor or grievance forum; the Central Vigilance Commission under the Central Vigilance Commission Act, 2003 exercises superintendence and advice on vigilance in central organisations and does not convict; the Lokpal under the Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013 inquires into corruption complaints against covered public servants and is not a general grievance portal; and the Union grievance platform registers, routes, tracks and escalates administrative grievances against a 21-day benchmark with 30 days for appeals under the August 2024 comprehensive guidelines without being adjudicatory. C. Social instruments generate answerability powerfully and enforceability weakly because they usually carry no sanction, so they work best when coupled to a horizontal instrument that can impose a consequence, as when audit findings feed an action-taken report and, where warranted, a vigilance or public-audit follow-up; a dashboard that shows failure without naming who must correct it produces informed helplessness rather than accountability. D. Accountability operates in three directions - horizontal, where one state institution checks another through public audit, legislative committees, vigilance, the corruption ombudsman, courts and regulators; vertical, where citizens check the state through elections, legislative questioning and political competition; and social, where citizens check the state directly between elections through information requests, social audit, public hearings, citizen report cards, community monitoring and the media - and the social layer is the one this subject owns and the one in which India innovated.

Answer: A. Explanation: The chain runs from disclosure through comprehension, verification, answerability, follow-up and consequence to design feedback, and each stage has its own failure mode - published but unusable, unintelligible to the affected person, an auditor who is not independent of the implementer, officials absent from the hearing, findings recorded with no action-taken process, and the same finding recurring next cycle - and in India the chain typically breaks between verification and follow-up, so any strengthen-accountability answer that ignores the action-taken stage has missed the binding constraint. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q50. Which chronology card should be filed under Where the visibility-to-correction chain breaks?

A. The remedy sought determines the forum - information denied or delayed goes to the Public Information Officer, then a first appeal, then the Information Commission; a service delayed or refused goes to the department, then a notified service-guarantee route where one exists, then the grievance platform; money misused in a scheme goes to social audit, performance audit and legislative scrutiny; corruption by a public servant goes to vigilance, the corruption ombudsman and investigative agencies; community-level record falsification goes to social audit with a public hearing; a regulatory or sectoral dispute goes to the sector regulator and its appellate tribunal; and a personal-data breach has no operative route until the data-protection Board's members are appointed and the relevant duties commence. B. The chain runs from disclosure through comprehension, verification, answerability, follow-up and consequence to design feedback, and each stage has its own failure mode - published but unusable, unintelligible to the affected person, an auditor who is not independent of the implementer, officials absent from the hearing, findings recorded with no action-taken process, and the same finding recurring next cycle - and in India the chain typically breaks between verification and follow-up, so any strengthen-accountability answer that ignores the action-taken stage has missed the binding constraint. C. The Comptroller and Auditor-General is the constitutional public auditor under Articles 148 to 151 conducting financial, compliance and performance audit that feeds legislative scrutiny and is not an investigator, prosecutor or grievance forum; the Central Vigilance Commission under the Central Vigilance Commission Act, 2003 exercises superintendence and advice on vigilance in central organisations and does not convict; the Lokpal under the Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013 inquires into corruption complaints against covered public servants and is not a general grievance portal; and the Union grievance platform registers, routes, tracks and escalates administrative

grievances against a 21-day benchmark with 30 days for appeals under the August 2024 comprehensive guidelines without being adjudicatory. D. Social instruments generate answerability powerfully and enforceability weakly because they usually carry no sanction, so they work best when coupled to a horizontal instrument that can impose a consequence, as when audit findings feed an action-taken report and, where warranted, a vigilance or public-audit follow-up; a dashboard that shows failure without naming who must correct it produces informed helplessness rather than accountability.

Answer: B. Explanation: The chain runs from disclosure through comprehension, verification, answerability, follow-up and consequence to design feedback, and each stage has its own failure mode - published but unusable, unintelligible to the affected person, an auditor who is not independent of the implementer, officials absent from the hearing, findings recorded with no action-taken process, and the same finding recurring next cycle - and in India the chain typically breaks between verification and follow-up, so any strengthen-accountability answer that ignores the action-taken stage has missed the binding constraint. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q51. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Where the visibility-to-correction chain breaks?

A. The remedy sought determines the forum - information denied or delayed goes to the Public Information Officer, then a first appeal, then the Information Commission; a service delayed or refused goes to the department, then a notified service-guarantee route where one exists, then the grievance platform; money misused in a scheme goes to social audit, performance audit and legislative scrutiny; corruption by a public servant goes to vigilance, the corruption ombudsman and investigative agencies; community-level record falsification goes to social audit with a public hearing; a regulatory or sectoral dispute goes to the sector regulator and its appellate tribunal; and a personal-data breach has no operative route until the data-protection Board's members are appointed and the relevant duties commence. B. Audit examines records and systems after the fact, investigation gathers evidence of a specific wrong, adjudication decides rights between parties with due process, and grievance redress resolves an individual's service complaint administratively, and naming which of the four a question needs is worth more than describing any of them; the same discipline resolves applied problems, since an official who learns of a quality failure owes a duty to report through a channel that creates a record, and confidentiality of a source or of commercially sensitive material does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the authority competent to act. C. The chain runs from disclosure through comprehension, verification, answerability, follow-up and consequence to design feedback, and each stage has its own failure mode - published but unusable, unintelligible to the affected person, an auditor who is not independent of the implementer, officials absent from the hearing, findings recorded with no action-taken process, and the same finding recurring next cycle - and in India the chain typically breaks between verification and follow-up, so any strengthen-accountability answer that ignores the action-taken stage has missed the binding constraint. D. The Comptroller and Auditor-General is the constitutional public auditor under Articles 148 to 151 conducting financial, compliance and performance audit that feeds legislative scrutiny and is not an investigator, prosecutor or grievance forum; the Central Vigilance Commission under the Central Vigilance Commission Act, 2003 exercises superintendence and advice on vigilance in central organisations and does not convict; the Lokpal under the Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013 inquires into corruption complaints against covered public servants and is not a general grievance portal; and the Union grievance platform registers, routes, tracks and escalates administrative grievances against a 21-day benchmark with 30 days for appeals under the August 2024 comprehensive guidelines without being adjudicatory.

Answer: C. Explanation: The chain runs from disclosure through comprehension, verification, answerability, follow-up and consequence to design feedback, and each stage has its own failure mode - published but unusable, unintelligible to the affected person, an auditor who is not independent of the implementer, officials absent from the hearing, findings recorded with no action-taken process, and the same finding recurring next cycle - and in India the chain typically breaks between verification and follow-up, so any strengthen-accountability answer that ignores the action-taken stage has missed the binding constraint. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q52. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Where the visibility-to-correction chain breaks?

A. The Whistle Blowers Protection Act, 2014 received assent on 9 May 2014 and has still not been brought into force by notification, and the Whistle Blowers Protection (Amendment) Bill, 2015 was passed by the Lok Sabha and lapsed, so India's statutory whistle-blower protection remains enacted but not commenced and current protection rests on scattered administrative and sectoral arrangements; this matters precisely because the appellant, the social auditor and the reporting official bear cost, delay and retaliation risk at the point where the accountability chain most needs them. B. Audit examines records and systems after the fact, investigation gathers evidence of a specific wrong, adjudication decides rights between parties with due process, and grievance redress resolves an individual's service complaint administratively, and naming which of the four a question needs is worth more than describing any of them; the same discipline resolves applied problems, since an official who learns of a quality failure owes a duty to report through a channel that creates a record, and confidentiality of a source or of commercially sensitive material does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the authority competent to act. C. The remedy sought determines the forum - information denied or delayed goes to the Public Information Officer, then a first appeal, then the Information Commission; a service delayed or refused goes to the department, then a notified service-guarantee route where one exists, then the grievance platform; money misused in a scheme goes to social audit, performance audit and legislative scrutiny; corruption by a public servant goes to vigilance, the corruption ombudsman and investigative agencies; community-level record falsification goes to social audit with a public hearing; a regulatory or sectoral dispute goes to the sector regulator and its appellate tribunal; and a personal-data breach has no operative route until the data-protection Board's members are appointed and the relevant duties commence. D. The chain runs from disclosure through comprehension, verification, answerability, follow-up and consequence to design feedback, and each stage has its own failure mode - published but unusable, unintelligible to the affected person, an auditor who is not independent of the implementer, officials absent from the hearing, findings recorded with no action-taken process, and the same finding recurring next cycle - and in India the chain typically breaks between verification and follow-up, so any strengthen-accountability answer that ignores the action-taken stage has missed the binding constraint.

Answer: D. Explanation: The chain runs from disclosure through comprehension, verification, answerability, follow-up and consequence to design feedback, and each stage has its own failure mode - published but unusable, unintelligible to the affected person, an auditor who is not independent of the implementer, officials absent from the hearing, findings recorded with no action-taken process, and the same finding recurring next cycle - and in India the chain typically breaks between verification and follow-up, so any strengthen-accountability answer that ignores the action-taken stage has missed the binding constraint. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies The accountability typology?

A. Accountability operates in three directions - horizontal, where one state institution checks another through public audit, legislative committees, vigilance, the corruption ombudsman, courts and regulators; vertical, where citizens check the state through elections, legislative questioning and political competition; and social, where citizens check the state directly between elections through information requests, social audit, public hearings, citizen report cards, community monitoring and the media - and the social layer is the one this subject owns and the one in which India innovated. B. The Comptroller and Auditor-General is the constitutional public auditor under Articles 148 to 151 conducting financial, compliance and performance audit that feeds legislative scrutiny and is not an investigator, prosecutor or grievance forum; the Central Vigilance Commission under the Central Vigilance Commission Act, 2003 exercises superintendence and advice on vigilance in central organisations and does not convict; the Lokpal under the Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013 inquires into corruption complaints against covered public servants and is not a general grievance portal; and the Union grievance platform registers, routes, tracks and escalates administrative grievances against a 21-day benchmark with 30 days for appeals under the August 2024 comprehensive guidelines without being adjudicatory. C. The remedy sought determines the forum - information denied or delayed goes to the Public Information Officer, then a first appeal, then the Information Commission; a service delayed or refused goes to the department, then a notified service-guarantee route where one exists, then the grievance platform; money misused in a scheme goes to social audit, performance audit and legislative scrutiny; corruption by a public servant goes to vigilance, the corruption ombudsman and investigative agencies; community-level record falsification goes to social audit with a public hearing; a regulatory or sectoral dispute goes to the sector regulator and its appellate tribunal; and a personal-data breach has no operative route until the data-protection Board's members are appointed

and the relevant duties commence. D. Social instruments generate answerability powerfully and enforceability weakly because they usually carry no sanction, so they work best when coupled to a horizontal instrument that can impose a consequence, as when audit findings feed an action-taken report and, where warranted, a vigilance or public-audit follow-up; a dashboard that shows failure without naming who must correct it produces informed helplessness rather than accountability.

Answer: A. Explanation: Accountability operates in three directions - horizontal, where one state institution checks another through public audit, legislative committees, vigilance, the corruption ombudsman, courts and regulators; vertical, where citizens check the state through elections, legislative questioning and political competition; and social, where citizens check the state directly between elections through information requests, social audit, public hearings, citizen report cards, community monitoring and the media - and the social layer is the one this subject owns and the one in which India innovated. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q54. Which chronology card should be filed under The accountability typology?

A. Audit examines records and systems after the fact, investigation gathers evidence of a specific wrong, adjudication decides rights between parties with due process, and grievance redress resolves an individual's service complaint administratively, and naming which of the four a question needs is worth more than describing any of them; the same discipline resolves applied problems, since an official who learns of a quality failure owes a duty to report through a channel that creates a record, and confidentiality of a source or of commercially sensitive material does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the authority competent to act. B. Accountability operates in three directions - horizontal, where one state institution checks another through public audit, legislative committees, vigilance, the corruption ombudsman, courts and regulators; vertical, where citizens check the state through elections, legislative questioning and political competition; and social, where citizens check the state directly between elections through information requests, social audit, public hearings, citizen report cards, community monitoring and the media - and the social layer is the one this subject owns and the one in which India innovated. C. The remedy sought determines the forum - information denied or delayed goes to the Public Information Officer, then a first appeal, then the Information Commission; a service delayed or refused goes to the department, then a notified service-guarantee route where one exists, then the grievance platform; money misused in a scheme goes to social audit, performance audit and legislative scrutiny; corruption by a public servant goes to vigilance, the corruption ombudsman and investigative agencies; community-level record falsification goes to social audit with a public hearing; a regulatory or sectoral dispute goes to the sector regulator and its appellate tribunal; and a personal-data breach has no operative route until the data-protection Board's members are appointed and the relevant duties commence. D. The Comptroller and Auditor-General is the constitutional public auditor under Articles 148 to 151 conducting financial, compliance and performance audit that feeds legislative scrutiny and is not an investigator, prosecutor or grievance forum; the Central Vigilance Commission under the Central Vigilance Commission Act, 2003 exercises superintendence and advice on vigilance in central organisations and does not convict; the Lokpal under the Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013 inquires into corruption complaints against covered public servants and is not a general grievance portal; and the Union grievance platform registers, routes, tracks and escalates administrative grievances against a 21-day benchmark with 30 days for appeals under the August 2024 comprehensive guidelines without being adjudicatory.

Answer: B. Explanation: Accountability operates in three directions - horizontal, where one state institution checks another through public audit, legislative committees, vigilance, the corruption ombudsman, courts and regulators; vertical, where citizens check the state through elections, legislative questioning and political competition; and social, where citizens check the state directly between elections through information requests, social audit, public hearings, citizen report cards, community monitoring and the media - and the social layer is the one this subject owns and the one in which India innovated. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q55. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The accountability typology?

A. The Whistle Blowers Protection Act, 2014 received assent on 9 May 2014 and has still not been brought into force by notification, and the Whistle Blowers Protection (Amendment) Bill, 2015 was passed by the Lok Sabha and lapsed, so India's statutory whistle-blower protection remains enacted but not commenced and current protection rests on scattered administrative and sectoral arrangements; this matters precisely because the appellant, the social auditor and the reporting official bear cost, delay and retaliation risk at the point where the accountability chain most needs them. B. Audit examines records and systems after the fact, investigation gathers evidence of a specific wrong, adjudication decides rights between parties with due process, and grievance redress resolves an individual's service complaint administratively, and naming which of the four a question needs is worth more than describing any of them; the same discipline resolves applied problems, since an official who learns of a quality failure owes a duty to report through a channel that creates a record, and confidentiality of a source or of commercially sensitive material does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the authority competent to act. C. Accountability operates in three directions - horizontal, where one state institution checks another through public audit, legislative committees, vigilance, the corruption ombudsman, courts and regulators; vertical, where citizens check the state through elections, legislative questioning and political competition; and social, where citizens check the state directly between elections through information requests, social audit, public hearings, citizen report cards, community monitoring and the media - and the social layer is the one this subject owns and the one in which India innovated. D. The remedy sought determines the forum - information denied or delayed goes to the Public Information Officer, then a first appeal, then the Information Commission; a service delayed or refused goes to the department, then a notified service-guarantee route where one exists, then the grievance platform; money misused in a scheme goes to social audit, performance audit and legislative scrutiny; corruption by a public servant goes to vigilance, the corruption ombudsman and investigative agencies; community-level record falsification goes to social audit with a public hearing; a regulatory or sectoral dispute goes to the sector regulator and its appellate tribunal; and a personal-data breach has no operative route until the data-protection Board's members are appointed and the relevant duties commence.

Answer: C. Explanation: Accountability operates in three directions - horizontal, where one state institution checks another through public audit, legislative committees, vigilance, the corruption ombudsman, courts and regulators; vertical, where citizens check the state through elections, legislative questioning and political competition; and social, where citizens check the state directly between elections through information requests, social audit, public hearings, citizen report cards, community monitoring and the media - and the social layer is the one this subject owns and the one in which India innovated. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q56. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The accountability typology?

A. The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the 2020 General Studies Paper-II demand on recent amendments to the Right to Information Act and the autonomy of the Information Commission to this owner as a cross-cutting demand shared with the Polity commission and statutory-body owners, and its stem was confirmed word for word in the locally held official paper; the audited 2024-2025 ledger routes the 2024 Citizens' Charter demand to this owner while the charter architecture itself is held by the citizen-centric-administration file, so the two are answered together with the ecosystem context supplied here; and the audited 2026 Prelims ledger routes two applied accountability-routing demands here, on public-service accountability where vaccine distribution quality is compromised and on transparency and integrity in public procurement where adverse information is confidential, for which the locally held 2026 Set-A key is provisional and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred. B. The Whistle Blowers Protection Act, 2014 received assent on 9 May 2014 and has still not been brought into force by notification, and the Whistle Blowers Protection (Amendment) Bill, 2015 was passed by the Lok Sabha and lapsed, so India's statutory whistle-blower protection remains enacted but not commenced and current protection rests on scattered administrative and sectoral arrangements; this matters precisely because the appellant, the social auditor and the reporting official bear cost, delay and retaliation risk at the point where the accountability chain most needs them. C. Audit examines records and systems after the fact, investigation gathers evidence of a specific wrong, adjudication decides rights between parties with due process, and grievance redress resolves an individual's service complaint administratively, and naming which of the four a question needs is worth more than describing any of them; the same discipline resolves applied problems, since an official who learns of a quality failure owes a duty to report through a channel that creates a record, and confidentiality of a source or of commercially sensitive material does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the authority competent to act. D. Accountability operates in three directions -

horizontal, where one state institution checks another through public audit, legislative committees, vigilance, the corruption ombudsman, courts and regulators; vertical, where citizens check the state through elections, legislative questioning and political competition; and social, where citizens check the state directly between elections through information requests, social audit, public hearings, citizen report cards, community monitoring and the media - and the social layer is the one this subject owns and the one in which India innovated.

Answer: D. Explanation: Accountability operates in three directions - horizontal, where one state institution checks another through public audit, legislative committees, vigilance, the corruption ombudsman, courts and regulators; vertical, where citizens check the state through elections, legislative questioning and political competition; and social, where citizens check the state directly between elections through information requests, social audit, public hearings, citizen report cards, community monitoring and the media - and the social layer is the one this subject owns and the one in which India innovated. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Why social accountability must be coupled?

A. Social instruments generate answerability powerfully and enforceability weakly because they usually carry no sanction, so they work best when coupled to a horizontal instrument that can impose a consequence, as when audit findings feed an action-taken report and, where warranted, a vigilance or public-audit follow-up; a dashboard that shows failure without naming who must correct it produces informed helplessness rather than accountability. B. The Comptroller and Auditor-General is the constitutional public auditor under Articles 148 to 151 conducting financial, compliance and performance audit that feeds legislative scrutiny and is not an investigator, prosecutor or grievance forum; the Central Vigilance Commission under the Central Vigilance Commission Act, 2003 exercises superintendence and advice on vigilance in central organisations and does not convict; the Lokpal under the Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013 inquires into corruption complaints against covered public servants and is not a general grievance portal; and the Union grievance platform registers, routes, tracks and escalates administrative grievances against a 21-day benchmark with 30 days for appeals under the August 2024 comprehensive guidelines without being adjudicatory. C. The remedy sought determines the forum - information denied or delayed goes to the Public Information Officer, then a first appeal, then the Information Commission; a service delayed or refused goes to the department, then a notified service-guarantee route where one exists, then the grievance platform; money misused in a scheme goes to social audit, performance audit and legislative scrutiny; corruption by a public servant goes to vigilance, the corruption ombudsman and investigative agencies; community-level record falsification goes to social audit with a public hearing; a regulatory or sectoral dispute goes to the sector regulator and its appellate tribunal; and a personal-data breach has no operative route until the data-protection Board's members are appointed and the relevant duties commence. D. Audit examines records and systems after the fact, investigation gathers evidence of a specific wrong, adjudication decides rights between parties with due process, and grievance redress resolves an individual's service complaint administratively, and naming which of the four a question needs is worth more than describing any of them; the same discipline resolves applied problems, since an official who learns of a quality failure owes a duty to report through a channel that creates a record, and confidentiality of a source or of commercially sensitive material does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the authority competent to act.

Answer: A. Explanation: Social instruments generate answerability powerfully and enforceability weakly because they usually carry no sanction, so they work best when coupled to a horizontal instrument that can impose a consequence, as when audit findings feed an action-taken report and, where warranted, a vigilance or public-audit follow-up; a dashboard that shows failure without naming who must correct it produces informed helplessness rather than accountability. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q58. Which chronology card should be filed under Why social accountability must be coupled?

A. The remedy sought determines the forum - information denied or delayed goes to the Public Information Officer, then a first appeal, then the Information Commission; a service delayed or refused goes to the department, then a notified service-guarantee route where one exists, then the grievance platform; money misused in a scheme goes to social audit, performance audit and legislative scrutiny; corruption by a public servant goes to vigilance, the corruption ombudsman and investigative agencies; community-level record falsification goes to social audit with a public hearing; a regulatory or sectoral dispute goes to the sector regulator and its appellate tribunal; and a personal-data breach has no operative route until the data-protection Board's members are appointed and the relevant duties commence. B. Social instruments generate answerability powerfully and enforceability weakly because they usually carry no sanction, so they work best when coupled to a horizontal instrument that can impose a consequence, as when audit findings feed an action-taken report and, where warranted, a vigilance or public-audit follow-up; a dashboard that shows failure without naming who must correct it produces informed helplessness rather than accountability. C. The Whistle Blowers Protection Act, 2014 received assent on 9 May 2014 and has still not been brought into force by notification, and the Whistle Blowers Protection (Amendment) Bill, 2015 was passed by the Lok Sabha and lapsed, so India's statutory whistle-blower protection remains enacted but not commenced and current protection rests on scattered administrative and sectoral arrangements; this matters precisely because the appellant, the social auditor and the reporting official bear cost, delay and retaliation risk at the point where the accountability chain most needs them. D. Audit examines records and systems after the fact, investigation gathers evidence of a specific wrong, adjudication decides rights between parties with due process, and grievance redress resolves an individual's service complaint administratively, and naming which of the four a question needs is worth more than describing any of them; the same discipline resolves applied problems, since an official who learns of a quality failure owes a duty to report through a channel that creates a record, and confidentiality of a source or of commercially sensitive material does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the authority competent to act.

Answer: B. Explanation: Social instruments generate answerability powerfully and enforceability weakly because they usually carry no sanction, so they work best when coupled to a horizontal instrument that can impose a consequence, as when audit findings feed an action-taken report and, where warranted, a vigilance or public-audit follow-up; a dashboard that shows failure without naming who must correct it produces informed helplessness rather than accountability. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q59. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Why social accountability must be coupled?

A. Audit examines records and systems after the fact, investigation gathers evidence of a specific wrong, adjudication decides rights between parties with due process, and grievance redress resolves an individual's service complaint administratively, and naming which of the four a question needs is worth more than describing any of them; the same discipline resolves applied problems, since an official who learns of a quality failure owes a duty to report through a channel that creates a record, and confidentiality of a source or of commercially sensitive material does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the authority competent to act. B. The Whistle Blowers Protection Act, 2014 received assent on 9 May 2014 and has still not been brought into force by notification, and the Whistle Blowers Protection (Amendment) Bill, 2015 was passed by the Lok Sabha and lapsed, so India's statutory whistle-blower protection remains enacted but not commenced and current protection rests on scattered administrative and sectoral arrangements; this matters precisely because the appellant, the social auditor and the reporting official bear cost, delay and retaliation risk at the point where the accountability chain most needs them. C. Social instruments generate answerability powerfully and enforceability weakly because they usually carry no sanction, so they work best when coupled to a horizontal instrument that can impose a consequence, as when audit findings feed an action-taken report and, where warranted, a vigilance or public-audit follow-up; a dashboard that shows failure without naming who must correct it produces informed helplessness rather than accountability. D. The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the 2020 General Studies Paper-II demand on recent amendments to the Right to Information Act and the autonomy of the Information Commission to this owner as a cross-cutting demand shared with the Polity commission and statutory-body owners, and its stem was confirmed word for word in the locally held official paper; the audited 2024-2025 ledger routes the 2024 Citizens' Charter demand to this owner while the charter architecture itself is held by the citizen-centric-administration file, so the two are answered together with the ecosystem context supplied here; and the audited 2026 Prelims ledger routes two applied accountability-routing demands here, on public-service

accountability where vaccine distribution quality is compromised and on transparency and integrity in public procurement where adverse information is confidential, for which the locally held 2026 Set-A key is provisional and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred.

Answer: C. Explanation: Social instruments generate answerability powerfully and enforceability weakly because they usually carry no sanction, so they work best when coupled to a horizontal instrument that can impose a consequence, as when audit findings feed an action-taken report and, where warranted, a vigilance or public-audit follow-up; a dashboard that shows failure without naming who must correct it produces informed helplessness rather than accountability. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q60. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Why social accountability must be coupled?

A. The Whistle Blowers Protection Act, 2014 received assent on 9 May 2014 and has still not been brought into force by notification, and the Whistle Blowers Protection (Amendment) Bill, 2015 was passed by the Lok Sabha and lapsed, so India's statutory whistle-blower protection remains enacted but not commenced and current protection rests on scattered administrative and sectoral arrangements; this matters precisely because the appellant, the social auditor and the reporting official bear cost, delay and retaliation risk at the point where the accountability chain most needs them. B. The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the 2020 General Studies Paper-II demand on recent amendments to the Right to Information Act and the autonomy of the Information Commission to this owner as a cross-cutting demand shared with the Polity commission and statutory-body owners, and its stem was confirmed word for word in the locally held official paper; the audited 2024-2025 ledger routes the 2024 Citizens' Charter demand to this owner while the charter architecture itself is held by the citizen-centric-administration file, so the two are answered together with the ecosystem context supplied here; and the audited 2026 Prelims ledger routes two applied accountability-routing demands here, on public-service accountability where vaccine distribution quality is compromised and on transparency and integrity in public procurement where adverse information is confidential, for which the locally held 2026 Set-A key is provisional and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred. C. Accountability is not transparency plus good intentions but a three-part chain - transparency, meaning visibility of records, spending and decisions; answerability, meaning an identifiable authority obliged to explain; and enforceability, meaning correction, remedy or consequence - and India has built the first extensively, the second unevenly and the third rarely, which is why an answer that opens by separating the three immediately outperforms one that treats them as synonyms. D. Social instruments generate answerability powerfully and enforceability weakly because they usually carry no sanction, so they work best when coupled to a horizontal instrument that can impose a consequence, as when audit findings feed an action-taken report and, where warranted, a vigilance or public-audit follow-up; a dashboard that shows failure without naming who must correct it produces informed helplessness rather than accountability.

Answer: D. Explanation: Social instruments generate answerability powerfully and enforceability weakly because they usually carry no sanction, so they work best when coupled to a horizontal instrument that can impose a consequence, as when audit findings feed an action-taken report and, where warranted, a vigilance or public-audit follow-up; a dashboard that shows failure without naming who must correct it produces informed helplessness rather than accountability. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies The institutional division of labour?

A. The Comptroller and Auditor-General is the constitutional public auditor under Articles 148 to 151 conducting financial, compliance and performance audit that feeds legislative scrutiny and is not an investigator, prosecutor or grievance forum; the Central Vigilance Commission under the Central Vigilance Commission Act, 2003 exercises superintendence and advice on vigilance in central organisations and does not convict; the Lokpal under the Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013 inquires into corruption complaints against covered public servants and is not a general grievance portal; and the Union grievance platform registers, routes, tracks and escalates administrative grievances against a 21-day benchmark with 30 days for appeals under the August 2024 comprehensive guidelines without being adjudicatory. B. The remedy sought determines the forum - information denied or delayed goes to the Public Information Officer, then a first appeal, then the Information Commission; a service delayed or refused goes to the department, then a notified service-guarantee route where one exists, then the grievance platform; money misused in

a scheme goes to social audit, performance audit and legislative scrutiny; corruption by a public servant goes to vigilance, the corruption ombudsman and investigative agencies; community-level record falsification goes to social audit with a public hearing; a regulatory or sectoral dispute goes to the sector regulator and its appellate tribunal; and a personal-data breach has no operative route until the data-protection Board's members are appointed and the relevant duties commence. C. Audit examines records and systems after the fact, investigation gathers evidence of a specific wrong, adjudication decides rights between parties with due process, and grievance redress resolves an individual's service complaint administratively, and naming which of the four a question needs is worth more than describing any of them; the same discipline resolves applied problems, since an official who learns of a quality failure owes a duty to report through a channel that creates a record, and confidentiality of a source or of commercially sensitive material does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the authority competent to act. D. The Whistle Blowers Protection Act, 2014 received assent on 9 May 2014 and has still not been brought into force by notification, and the Whistle Blowers Protection (Amendment) Bill, 2015 was passed by the Lok Sabha and lapsed, so India's statutory whistle-blower protection remains enacted but not commenced and current protection rests on scattered administrative and sectoral arrangements; this matters precisely because the appellant, the social auditor and the reporting official bear cost, delay and retaliation risk at the point where the accountability chain most needs them.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Comptroller and Auditor-General is the constitutional public auditor under Articles 148 to 151 conducting financial, compliance and performance audit that feeds legislative scrutiny and is not an investigator, prosecutor or grievance forum; the Central Vigilance Commission under the Central Vigilance Commission Act, 2003 exercises superintendence and advice on vigilance in central organisations and does not convict; the Lokpal under the Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013 inquires into corruption complaints against covered public servants and is not a general grievance portal; and the Union grievance platform registers, routes, tracks and escalates administrative grievances against a 21-day benchmark with 30 days for appeals under the August 2024 comprehensive guidelines without being adjudicatory. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q62. Which chronology card should be filed under The institutional division of labour?

A. Audit examines records and systems after the fact, investigation gathers evidence of a specific wrong, adjudication decides rights between parties with due process, and grievance redress resolves an individual's service complaint administratively, and naming which of the four a question needs is worth more than describing any of them; the same discipline resolves applied problems, since an official who learns of a quality failure owes a duty to report through a channel that creates a record, and confidentiality of a source or of commercially sensitive material does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the authority competent to act. B. The Comptroller and Auditor-General is the constitutional public auditor under Articles 148 to 151 conducting financial, compliance and performance audit that feeds legislative scrutiny and is not an investigator, prosecutor or grievance forum; the Central Vigilance Commission under the Central Vigilance Commission Act, 2003 exercises superintendence and advice on vigilance in central organisations and does not convict; the Lokpal under the Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013 inquires into corruption complaints against covered public servants and is not a general grievance portal; and the Union grievance platform registers, routes, tracks and escalates administrative grievances against a 21-day benchmark with 30 days for appeals under the August 2024 comprehensive guidelines without being adjudicatory. C. The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the 2020 General Studies Paper-II demand on recent amendments to the Right to Information Act and the autonomy of the Information Commission to this owner as a cross-cutting demand shared with the Polity commission and statutory-body owners, and its stem was confirmed word for word in the locally held official paper; the audited 2024-2025 ledger routes the 2024 Citizens' Charter demand to this owner while the charter architecture itself is held by the citizen-centric-administration file, so the two are answered together with the ecosystem context supplied here; and the audited 2026 Prelims ledger routes two applied accountability-routing demands here, on public-service accountability where vaccine distribution quality is compromised and on transparency and integrity in public procurement where adverse information is confidential, for which the locally held 2026 Set-A key is provisional and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred. D. The Whistle Blowers Protection Act, 2014 received assent on 9 May 2014 and has still not been brought into force by notification, and the Whistle Blowers Protection (Amendment) Bill, 2015 was passed by the Lok Sabha and lapsed, so India's statutory whistle-blower protection remains enacted but not commenced and current protection rests on scattered administrative and sectoral arrangements; this matters precisely because the appellant, the social auditor and the reporting official bear cost, delay and retaliation risk at the point where the accountability chain most needs them.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Comptroller and Auditor-General is the constitutional public auditor under Articles 148 to 151 conducting financial, compliance and performance audit that feeds legislative scrutiny and is not an investigator, prosecutor or grievance forum; the Central Vigilance Commission under the Central Vigilance Commission Act, 2003 exercises superintendence and advice on vigilance in central organisations and does not convict; the Lokpal under the Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013 inquires into corruption complaints against covered public servants and is not a general grievance portal; and the Union grievance platform registers, routes, tracks and escalates administrative grievances against a 21-day benchmark with 30 days for appeals under the August 2024 comprehensive guidelines without being adjudicatory. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q63. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The institutional division of labour?

A. The Whistle Blowers Protection Act, 2014 received assent on 9 May 2014 and has still not been brought into force by notification, and the Whistle Blowers Protection (Amendment) Bill, 2015 was passed by the Lok Sabha and lapsed, so India's statutory whistle-blower protection remains enacted but not commenced and current protection rests on scattered administrative and sectoral arrangements; this matters precisely because the appellant, the social auditor and the reporting official bear cost, delay and retaliation risk at the point where the accountability chain most needs them. B. The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the 2020 General Studies Paper-II demand on recent amendments to the Right to Information Act and the autonomy of the Information Commission to this owner as a cross-cutting demand shared with the Polity commission and statutory-body owners, and its stem was confirmed word for word in the locally held official paper; the audited 2024-2025 ledger routes the 2024 Citizens' Charter demand to this owner while the charter architecture itself is held by the citizen-centric-administration file, so the two are answered together with the ecosystem context supplied here; and the audited 2026 Prelims ledger routes two applied accountability-routing demands here, on public-service accountability where vaccine distribution quality is compromised and on transparency and integrity in public procurement where adverse information is confidential, for which the locally held 2026 Set-A key is provisional and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred. C. The Comptroller and Auditor-General is the constitutional public auditor under Articles 148 to 151 conducting financial, compliance and performance audit that feeds legislative scrutiny and is not an investigator, prosecutor or grievance forum; the Central Vigilance Commission under the Central Vigilance Commission Act, 2003 exercises superintendence and advice on vigilance in central organisations and does not convict; the Lokpal under the Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013 inquires into corruption complaints against covered public servants and is not a general grievance portal; and the Union grievance platform registers, routes, tracks and escalates administrative grievances against a 21-day benchmark with 30 days for appeals under the August 2024 comprehensive guidelines without being adjudicatory. D. Accountability is not transparency plus good intentions but a three-part chain - transparency, meaning visibility of records, spending and decisions; answerability, meaning an identifiable authority obliged to explain; and enforceability, meaning correction, remedy or consequence - and India has built the first extensively, the second unevenly and the third rarely, which is why an answer that opens by separating the three immediately outperforms one that treats them as synonyms.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Comptroller and Auditor-General is the constitutional public auditor under Articles 148 to 151 conducting financial, compliance and performance audit that feeds legislative scrutiny and is not an investigator, prosecutor or grievance forum; the Central Vigilance Commission under the Central Vigilance Commission Act, 2003 exercises superintendence and advice on vigilance in central organisations and does not convict; the Lokpal under the Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013 inquires into corruption complaints against covered public servants and is not a general grievance portal; and the Union grievance platform registers, routes, tracks and escalates administrative grievances against a 21-day benchmark with 30 days for appeals under the August 2024 comprehensive guidelines without being adjudicatory. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q64. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The institutional division of labour?

A. Under the Right to Information Act, 2005 a citizen seeks existing information from a public authority within ordinarily 30 days, or 48 hours where the information concerns the life or liberty of a person, with a first appeal ordinarily within 30 days and a second appeal to the Central or State Information Commission within 90 days, and a Public Information Officer penalty of two hundred and fifty rupees per day subject to a maximum of twenty-five thousand rupees after the statutory process; the route obtains information that already exists and does not create information, order a service or punish the underlying wrong. B. The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the 2020 General Studies Paper-II demand on recent amendments to the Right to Information Act and the autonomy of the Information Commission to this owner as a cross-cutting demand shared with the Polity commission and statutory-body owners, and its stem was confirmed word for word in the locally held official paper; the audited 2024-2025 ledger routes the 2024 Citizens' Charter demand to this owner while the charter architecture itself is held by the citizen-centric-administration file, so the two are answered together with the ecosystem context supplied here; and the audited 2026 Prelims ledger routes two applied accountability-routing demands here, on public-service accountability where vaccine distribution quality is compromised and on transparency and integrity in public procurement where adverse information is confidential, for which the locally held 2026 Set-A key is provisional and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred. C. Accountability is not transparency plus good intentions but a three-part chain - transparency, meaning visibility of records, spending and decisions; answerability, meaning an identifiable authority obliged to explain; and enforceability, meaning correction, remedy or consequence - and India has built the first extensively, the second unevenly and the third rarely, which is why an answer that opens by separating the three immediately outperforms one that treats them as synonyms. D. The Comptroller and Auditor-General is the constitutional public auditor under Articles 148 to 151 conducting financial, compliance and performance audit that feeds legislative scrutiny and is not an investigator, prosecutor or grievance forum; the Central Vigilance Commission under the Central Vigilance Commission Act, 2003 exercises superintendence and advice on vigilance in central organisations and does not convict; the Lokpal under the Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013 inquires into corruption complaints against covered public servants and is not a general grievance portal; and the Union grievance platform registers, routes, tracks and escalates administrative grievances against a 21-day benchmark with 30 days for appeals under the August 2024 comprehensive guidelines without being adjudicatory.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Comptroller and Auditor-General is the constitutional public auditor under Articles 148 to 151 conducting financial, compliance and performance audit that feeds legislative scrutiny and is not an investigator, prosecutor or grievance forum; the Central Vigilance Commission under the Central Vigilance Commission Act, 2003 exercises superintendence and advice on vigilance in central organisations and does not convict; the Lokpal under the Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013 inquires into corruption complaints against covered public servants and is not a general grievance portal; and the Union grievance platform registers, routes, tracks and escalates administrative grievances against a 21-day benchmark with 30 days for appeals under the August 2024 comprehensive guidelines without being adjudicatory. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies The routing table?

A. The remedy sought determines the forum - information denied or delayed goes to the Public Information Officer, then a first appeal, then the Information Commission; a service delayed or refused goes to the department, then a notified service-guarantee route where one exists, then the grievance platform; money misused in a scheme goes to social audit, performance audit and legislative scrutiny; corruption by a public servant goes to vigilance, the corruption ombudsman and investigative agencies; community-level record falsification goes to social audit with a public hearing; a regulatory or sectoral dispute goes to the sector regulator and its appellate tribunal; and a personal-data breach has no operative route until the data-protection Board's members are appointed and the relevant duties commence. B. The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the 2020 General Studies Paper-II demand on recent amendments to the Right to Information Act and the autonomy of the Information Commission to this owner as a cross-cutting demand shared with the Polity commission and statutory-body owners, and its stem was confirmed word for word in the locally held official paper; the audited 2024-2025 ledger routes the 2024 Citizens' Charter demand to this owner while the charter architecture itself is held by the citizen-centric-administration file, so the two are answered together with the ecosystem context supplied here; and the audited 2026 Prelims ledger routes two applied accountability-routing demands here, on public-service accountability where vaccine distribution quality is compromised and on transparency and integrity in public procurement where adverse information is confidential, for which the locally held

2026 Set-A key is provisional and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred. C. The Whistle Blowers Protection Act, 2014 received assent on 9 May 2014 and has still not been brought into force by notification, and the Whistle Blowers Protection (Amendment) Bill, 2015 was passed by the Lok Sabha and lapsed, so India's statutory whistle-blower protection remains enacted but not commenced and current protection rests on scattered administrative and sectoral arrangements; this matters precisely because the appellant, the social auditor and the reporting official bear cost, delay and retaliation risk at the point where the accountability chain most needs them. D. Audit examines records and systems after the fact, investigation gathers evidence of a specific wrong, adjudication decides rights between parties with due process, and grievance redress resolves an individual's service complaint administratively, and naming which of the four a question needs is worth more than describing any of them; the same discipline resolves applied problems, since an official who learns of a quality failure owes a duty to report through a channel that creates a record, and confidentiality of a source or of commercially sensitive material does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the authority competent to act.

Answer: A. Explanation: The remedy sought determines the forum - information denied or delayed goes to the Public Information Officer, then a first appeal, then the Information Commission; a service delayed or refused goes to the department, then a notified service-guarantee route where one exists, then the grievance platform; money misused in a scheme goes to social audit, performance audit and legislative scrutiny; corruption by a public servant goes to vigilance, the corruption ombudsman and investigative agencies; community-level record falsification goes to social audit with a public hearing; a regulatory or sectoral dispute goes to the sector regulator and its appellate tribunal; and a personal-data breach has no operative route until the data-protection Board's members are appointed and the relevant duties commence. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q66. Which chronology card should be filed under The routing table?

A. Accountability is not transparency plus good intentions but a three-part chain - transparency, meaning visibility of records, spending and decisions; answerability, meaning an identifiable authority obliged to explain; and enforceability, meaning correction, remedy or consequence - and India has built the first extensively, the second unevenly and the third rarely, which is why an answer that opens by separating the three immediately outperforms one that treats them as synonyms. B. The remedy sought determines the forum - information denied or delayed goes to the Public Information Officer, then a first appeal, then the Information Commission; a service delayed or refused goes to the department, then a notified service-guarantee route where one exists, then the grievance platform; money misused in a scheme goes to social audit, performance audit and legislative scrutiny; corruption by a public servant goes to vigilance, the corruption ombudsman and investigative agencies; community-level record falsification goes to social audit with a public hearing; a regulatory or sectoral dispute goes to the sector regulator and its appellate tribunal; and a personal-data breach has no operative route until the data-protection Board's members are appointed and the relevant duties commence. C. The Whistle Blowers Protection Act, 2014 received assent on 9 May 2014 and has still not been brought into force by notification, and the Whistle Blowers Protection (Amendment) Bill, 2015 was passed by the Lok Sabha and lapsed, so India's statutory whistle-blower protection remains enacted but not commenced and current protection rests on scattered administrative and sectoral arrangements; this matters precisely because the appellant, the social auditor and the reporting official bear cost, delay and retaliation risk at the point where the accountability chain most needs them. D. The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the 2020 General Studies Paper-II demand on recent amendments to the Right to Information Act and the autonomy of the Information Commission to this owner as a cross-cutting demand shared with the Polity commission and statutory-body owners, and its stem was confirmed word for word in the locally held official paper; the audited 2024-2025 ledger routes the 2024 Citizens' Charter demand to this owner while the charter architecture itself is held by the citizen-centric-administration file, so the two are answered together with the ecosystem context supplied here; and the audited 2026 Prelims ledger routes two applied accountability-routing demands here, on public-service accountability where vaccine distribution quality is compromised and on transparency and integrity in public procurement where adverse information is confidential, for which the locally held 2026 Set-A key is provisional and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred.

Answer: B. Explanation: The remedy sought determines the forum - information denied or delayed goes to the Public Information Officer, then a first appeal, then the Information Commission; a service delayed or refused goes to the department, then a notified service-guarantee route where one exists, then the grievance platform; money misused in a scheme goes to social audit, performance audit and legislative scrutiny;

corruption by a public servant goes to vigilance, the corruption ombudsman and investigative agencies; community-level record falsification goes to social audit with a public hearing; a regulatory or sectoral dispute goes to the sector regulator and its appellate tribunal; and a personal-data breach has no operative route until the data-protection Board's members are appointed and the relevant duties commence. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q67. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The routing table?

A. Under the Right to Information Act, 2005 a citizen seeks existing information from a public authority within ordinarily 30 days, or 48 hours where the information concerns the life or liberty of a person, with a first appeal ordinarily within 30 days and a second appeal to the Central or State Information Commission within 90 days, and a Public Information Officer penalty of two hundred and fifty rupees per day subject to a maximum of twenty-five thousand rupees after the statutory process; the route obtains information that already exists and does not create information, order a service or punish the underlying wrong. B. Accountability is not transparency plus good intentions but a three-part chain - transparency, meaning visibility of records, spending and decisions; answerability, meaning an identifiable authority obliged to explain; and enforceability, meaning correction, remedy or consequence - and India has built the first extensively, the second unevenly and the third rarely, which is why an answer that opens by separating the three immediately outperforms one that treats them as synonyms. C. The remedy sought determines the forum - information denied or delayed goes to the Public Information Officer, then a first appeal, then the Information Commission; a service delayed or refused goes to the department, then a notified service-guarantee route where one exists, then the grievance platform; money misused in a scheme goes to social audit, performance audit and legislative scrutiny; corruption by a public servant goes to vigilance, the corruption ombudsman and investigative agencies; community-level record falsification goes to social audit with a public hearing; a regulatory or sectoral dispute goes to the sector regulator and its appellate tribunal; and a personal-data breach has no operative route until the data-protection Board's members are appointed and the relevant duties commence. D. The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the 2020 General Studies Paper-II demand on recent amendments to the Right to Information Act and the autonomy of the Information Commission to this owner as a cross-cutting demand shared with the Polity commission and statutory-body owners, and its stem was confirmed word for word in the locally held official paper; the audited 2024-2025 ledger routes the 2024 Citizens' Charter demand to this owner while the charter architecture itself is held by the citizen-centric-administration file, so the two are answered together with the ecosystem context supplied here; and the audited 2026 Prelims ledger routes two applied accountability-routing demands here, on public-service accountability where vaccine distribution quality is compromised and on transparency and integrity in public procurement where adverse information is confidential, for which the locally held 2026 Set-A key is provisional and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred.

Answer: C. Explanation: The remedy sought determines the forum - information denied or delayed goes to the Public Information Officer, then a first appeal, then the Information Commission; a service delayed or refused goes to the department, then a notified service-guarantee route where one exists, then the grievance platform; money misused in a scheme goes to social audit, performance audit and legislative scrutiny; corruption by a public servant goes to vigilance, the corruption ombudsman and investigative agencies; community-level record falsification goes to social audit with a public hearing; a regulatory or sectoral dispute goes to the sector regulator and its appellate tribunal; and a personal-data breach has no operative route until the data-protection Board's members are appointed and the relevant duties commence. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q68. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The routing table?

A. Under the Right to Information Act, 2005 a citizen seeks existing information from a public authority within ordinarily 30 days, or 48 hours where the information concerns the life or liberty of a person, with a first appeal ordinarily within 30 days and a second appeal to the Central or State Information Commission within 90 days, and a Public Information Officer penalty of two hundred and fifty rupees per day subject to a maximum of twenty-five thousand rupees after the statutory process; the route obtains information that already exists and does not create information, order a service or punish the underlying wrong. B. Section 4 of the Right to Information Act, 2005 requires public authorities to maintain records and publish specified organisational, function, decision, budget, subsidy, concession and Public Information Officer information on their own initiative so that routine facts need not await an application, and it reduces the volume of grievances that arise purely from information asymmetry; compliance is not independently audited, however, and

publication is not the same as usability, so a disclosure that is aggregated, technical or stale satisfies the form without serving the purpose. C. Accountability is not transparency plus good intentions but a three-part chain - transparency, meaning visibility of records, spending and decisions; answerability, meaning an identifiable authority obliged to explain; and enforceability, meaning correction, remedy or consequence - and India has built the first extensively, the second unevenly and the third rarely, which is why an answer that opens by separating the three immediately outperforms one that treats them as synonyms. D. The remedy sought determines the forum - information denied or delayed goes to the Public Information Officer, then a first appeal, then the Information Commission; a service delayed or refused goes to the department, then a notified service-guarantee route where one exists, then the grievance platform; money misused in a scheme goes to social audit, performance audit and legislative scrutiny; corruption by a public servant goes to vigilance, the corruption ombudsman and investigative agencies; community-level record falsification goes to social audit with a public hearing; a regulatory or sectoral dispute goes to the sector regulator and its appellate tribunal; and a personal-data breach has no operative route until the data-protection Board's members are appointed and the relevant duties commence.

Answer: D. Explanation: The remedy sought determines the forum - information denied or delayed goes to the Public Information Officer, then a first appeal, then the Information Commission; a service delayed or refused goes to the department, then a notified service-guarantee route where one exists, then the grievance platform; money misused in a scheme goes to social audit, performance audit and legislative scrutiny; corruption by a public servant goes to vigilance, the corruption ombudsman and investigative agencies; community-level record falsification goes to social audit with a public hearing; a regulatory or sectoral dispute goes to the sector regulator and its appellate tribunal; and a personal-data breach has no operative route until the data-protection Board's members are appointed and the relevant duties commence. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Four functions that are not interchangeable?

A. Audit examines records and systems after the fact, investigation gathers evidence of a specific wrong, adjudication decides rights between parties with due process, and grievance redress resolves an individual's service complaint administratively, and naming which of the four a question needs is worth more than describing any of them; the same discipline resolves applied problems, since an official who learns of a quality failure owes a duty to report through a channel that creates a record, and confidentiality of a source or of commercially sensitive material does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the authority competent to act. B. The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the 2020 General Studies Paper-II demand on recent amendments to the Right to Information Act and the autonomy of the Information Commission to this owner as a cross-cutting demand shared with the Polity commission and statutory-body owners, and its stem was confirmed word for word in the locally held official paper; the audited 2024-2025 ledger routes the 2024 Citizens' Charter demand to this owner while the charter architecture itself is held by the citizen-centric-administration file, so the two are answered together with the ecosystem context supplied here; and the audited 2026 Prelims ledger routes two applied accountability-routing demands here, on public-service accountability where vaccine distribution quality is compromised and on transparency and integrity in public procurement where adverse information is confidential, for which the locally held 2026 Set-A key is provisional and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred. C. The Whistle Blowers Protection Act, 2014 received assent on 9 May 2014 and has still not been brought into force by notification, and the Whistle Blowers Protection (Amendment) Bill, 2015 was passed by the Lok Sabha and lapsed, so India's statutory whistle-blower protection remains enacted but not commenced and current protection rests on scattered administrative and sectoral arrangements; this matters precisely because the appellant, the social auditor and the reporting official bear cost, delay and retaliation risk at the point where the accountability chain most needs them. D. Accountability is not transparency plus good intentions but a three-part chain - transparency, meaning visibility of records, spending and decisions; answerability, meaning an identifiable authority obliged to explain; and enforceability, meaning correction, remedy or consequence - and India has built the first extensively, the second unevenly and the third rarely, which is why an answer that opens by separating the three immediately outperforms one that treats them as synonyms.

Answer: A. Explanation: Audit examines records and systems after the fact, investigation gathers evidence of a specific wrong, adjudication decides rights between parties with due process, and grievance redress resolves an individual's service complaint administratively, and naming which of the four a question needs is worth more than describing any of them; the same discipline resolves applied problems, since an official who learns of a quality failure owes a duty to report through a channel that creates a record, and confidentiality of

a source or of commercially sensitive material does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the authority competent to act. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under Four functions that are not interchangeable?

A. Accountability is not transparency plus good intentions but a three-part chain - transparency, meaning visibility of records, spending and decisions; answerability, meaning an identifiable authority obliged to explain; and enforceability, meaning correction, remedy or consequence - and India has built the first extensively, the second unevenly and the third rarely, which is why an answer that opens by separating the three immediately outperforms one that treats them as synonyms. B. Audit examines records and systems after the fact, investigation gathers evidence of a specific wrong, adjudication decides rights between parties with due process, and grievance redress resolves an individual's service complaint administratively, and naming which of the four a question needs is worth more than describing any of them; the same discipline resolves applied problems, since an official who learns of a quality failure owes a duty to report through a channel that creates a record, and confidentiality of a source or of commercially sensitive material does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the authority competent to act. C. The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the 2020 General Studies Paper-II demand on recent amendments to the Right to Information Act and the autonomy of the Information Commission to this owner as a cross-cutting demand shared with the Polity commission and statutory-body owners, and its stem was confirmed word for word in the locally held official paper; the audited 2024-2025 ledger routes the 2024 Citizens' Charter demand to this owner while the charter architecture itself is held by the citizen-centric-administration file, so the two are answered together with the ecosystem context supplied here; and the audited 2026 Prelims ledger routes two applied accountability-routing demands here, on public-service accountability where vaccine distribution quality is compromised and on transparency and integrity in public procurement where adverse information is confidential, for which the locally held 2026 Set-A key is provisional and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred. D. Under the Right to Information Act, 2005 a citizen seeks existing information from a public authority within ordinarily 30 days, or 48 hours where the information concerns the life or liberty of a person, with a first appeal ordinarily within 30 days and a second appeal to the Central or State Information Commission within 90 days, and a Public Information Officer penalty of two hundred and fifty rupees per day subject to a maximum of twenty-five thousand rupees after the statutory process; the route obtains information that already exists and does not create information, order a service or punish the underlying wrong.

Answer: B. Explanation: Audit examines records and systems after the fact, investigation gathers evidence of a specific wrong, adjudication decides rights between parties with due process, and grievance redress resolves an individual's service complaint administratively, and naming which of the four a question needs is worth more than describing any of them; the same discipline resolves applied problems, since an official who learns of a quality failure owes a duty to report through a channel that creates a record, and confidentiality of a source or of commercially sensitive material does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the authority competent to act. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Four functions that are not interchangeable?

A. Under the Right to Information Act, 2005 a citizen seeks existing information from a public authority within ordinarily 30 days, or 48 hours where the information concerns the life or liberty of a person, with a first appeal ordinarily within 30 days and a second appeal to the Central or State Information Commission within 90 days, and a Public Information Officer penalty of two hundred and fifty rupees per day subject to a maximum of twenty-five thousand rupees after the statutory process; the route obtains information that already exists and does not create information, order a service or punish the underlying wrong. B. Accountability is not transparency plus good intentions but a three-part chain - transparency, meaning visibility of records, spending and decisions; answerability, meaning an identifiable authority obliged to explain; and enforceability, meaning correction, remedy or consequence - and India has built the first extensively, the second unevenly and the third rarely, which is why an answer that opens by separating the three immediately outperforms one that treats them as synonyms. C. Audit examines records and systems after the fact, investigation gathers evidence of a specific wrong, adjudication decides rights between parties with due process, and grievance redress resolves an individual's service complaint administratively, and naming which of the four a question

needs is worth more than describing any of them; the same discipline resolves applied problems, since an official who learns of a quality failure owes a duty to report through a channel that creates a record, and confidentiality of a source or of commercially sensitive material does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the authority competent to act. D. Section 4 of the Right to Information Act, 2005 requires public authorities to maintain records and publish specified organisational, function, decision, budget, subsidy, concession and Public Information Officer information on their own initiative so that routine facts need not await an application, and it reduces the volume of grievances that arise purely from information asymmetry; compliance is not independently audited, however, and publication is not the same as usability, so a disclosure that is aggregated, technical or stale satisfies the form without serving the purpose.

Answer: C. Explanation: Audit examines records and systems after the fact, investigation gathers evidence of a specific wrong, adjudication decides rights between parties with due process, and grievance redress resolves an individual's service complaint administratively, and naming which of the four a question needs is worth more than describing any of them; the same discipline resolves applied problems, since an official who learns of a quality failure owes a duty to report through a channel that creates a record, and confidentiality of a source or of commercially sensitive material does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the authority competent to act. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Four functions that are not interchangeable?

A. Section 4 of the Right to Information Act, 2005 requires public authorities to maintain records and publish specified organisational, function, decision, budget, subsidy, concession and Public Information Officer information on their own initiative so that routine facts need not await an application, and it reduces the volume of grievances that arise purely from information asymmetry; compliance is not independently audited, however, and publication is not the same as usability, so a disclosure that is aggregated, technical or stale satisfies the form without serving the purpose. B. Section 8 of the Right to Information Act, 2005 contains the exemptions and they operate subject to severability, so a document is not withheld in full because part of it is exempt, and subject to the section 8(2) public-interest override, which permits disclosure where the public interest in disclosure outweighs the harm to the protected interest; section 24 excludes listed intelligence and security organisations from the Act while preserving the provisos relating to allegations of corruption and human-rights violations. C. Under the Right to Information Act, 2005 a citizen seeks existing information from a public authority within ordinarily 30 days, or 48 hours where the information concerns the life or liberty of a person, with a first appeal ordinarily within 30 days and a second appeal to the Central or State Information Commission within 90 days, and a Public Information Officer penalty of two hundred and fifty rupees per day subject to a maximum of twenty-five thousand rupees after the statutory process; the route obtains information that already exists and does not create information, order a service or punish the underlying wrong. D. Audit examines records and systems after the fact, investigation gathers evidence of a specific wrong, adjudication decides rights between parties with due process, and grievance redress resolves an individual's service complaint administratively, and naming which of the four a question needs is worth more than describing any of them; the same discipline resolves applied problems, since an official who learns of a quality failure owes a duty to report through a channel that creates a record, and confidentiality of a source or of commercially sensitive material does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the authority competent to act.

Answer: D. Explanation: Audit examines records and systems after the fact, investigation gathers evidence of a specific wrong, adjudication decides rights between parties with due process, and grievance redress resolves an individual's service complaint administratively, and naming which of the four a question needs is worth more than describing any of them; the same discipline resolves applied problems, since an official who learns of a quality failure owes a duty to report through a channel that creates a record, and confidentiality of a source or of commercially sensitive material does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the authority competent to act. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Whistle-blower protection as an unfilled gap?

A. The Whistle Blowers Protection Act, 2014 received assent on 9 May 2014 and has still not been brought into force by notification, and the Whistle Blowers Protection (Amendment) Bill, 2015 was passed by the Lok Sabha and lapsed, so India's statutory whistle-blower protection remains enacted but not commenced and current protection rests on scattered administrative and sectoral arrangements; this matters precisely because the appellant, the social auditor and the reporting official bear cost, delay and retaliation risk at the point where the accountability chain most needs them. B. Under the Right to Information Act, 2005 a citizen seeks existing information from a public authority within ordinarily 30 days, or 48 hours where the information concerns the life or liberty of a person, with a first appeal ordinarily within 30 days and a second appeal to the Central or State Information Commission within 90 days, and a Public Information Officer penalty of two hundred and fifty rupees per day subject to a maximum of twenty-five thousand rupees after the statutory process; the route obtains information that already exists and does not create information, order a service or punish the underlying wrong. C. The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the 2020 General Studies Paper-II demand on recent amendments to the Right to Information Act and the autonomy of the Information Commission to this owner as a cross-cutting demand shared with the Polity commission and statutory-body owners, and its stem was confirmed word for word in the locally held official paper; the audited 2024-2025 ledger routes the 2024 Citizens' Charter demand to this owner while the charter architecture itself is held by the citizen-centric-administration file, so the two are answered together with the ecosystem context supplied here; and the audited 2026 Prelims ledger routes two applied accountability-routing demands here, on public-service accountability where vaccine distribution quality is compromised and on transparency and integrity in public procurement where adverse information is confidential, for which the locally held 2026 Set-A key is provisional and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred. D. Accountability is not transparency plus good intentions but a three-part chain - transparency, meaning visibility of records, spending and decisions; answerability, meaning an identifiable authority obliged to explain; and enforceability, meaning correction, remedy or consequence - and India has built the first extensively, the second unevenly and the third rarely, which is why an answer that opens by separating the three immediately outperforms one that treats them as synonyms.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Whistle Blowers Protection Act, 2014 received assent on 9 May 2014 and has still not been brought into force by notification, and the Whistle Blowers Protection (Amendment) Bill, 2015 was passed by the Lok Sabha and lapsed, so India's statutory whistle-blower protection remains enacted but not commenced and current protection rests on scattered administrative and sectoral arrangements; this matters precisely because the appellant, the social auditor and the reporting official bear cost, delay and retaliation risk at the point where the accountability chain most needs them. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q74. Which chronology card should be filed under Whistle-blower protection as an unfilled gap?

A. Accountability is not transparency plus good intentions but a three-part chain - transparency, meaning visibility of records, spending and decisions; answerability, meaning an identifiable authority obliged to explain; and enforceability, meaning correction, remedy or consequence - and India has built the first extensively, the second unevenly and the third rarely, which is why an answer that opens by separating the three immediately outperforms one that treats them as synonyms. B. The Whistle Blowers Protection Act, 2014 received assent on 9 May 2014 and has still not been brought into force by notification, and the Whistle Blowers Protection (Amendment) Bill, 2015 was passed by the Lok Sabha and lapsed, so India's statutory whistle-blower protection remains enacted but not commenced and current protection rests on scattered administrative and sectoral arrangements; this matters precisely because the appellant, the social auditor and the reporting official bear cost, delay and retaliation risk at the point where the accountability chain most needs them. C. Section 4 of the Right to Information Act, 2005 requires public authorities to maintain records and publish specified organisational, function, decision, budget, subsidy, concession and Public Information Officer information on their own initiative so that routine facts need not await an application, and it reduces the volume of grievances that arise purely from information asymmetry; compliance is not independently audited, however, and publication is not the same as usability, so a disclosure that is aggregated, technical or stale satisfies the form without serving the purpose. D. Under the Right to Information Act, 2005 a citizen seeks existing information from a public authority within ordinarily 30 days, or 48 hours where the information concerns the life or liberty of a person, with a first appeal ordinarily within 30 days and a second appeal to the Central or State Information Commission within 90 days, and a Public Information Officer penalty of two hundred and fifty rupees per day subject to a maximum of twenty-five thousand rupees after the statutory process; the route obtains

information that already exists and does not create information, order a service or punish the underlying wrong.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Whistle Blowers Protection Act, 2014 received assent on 9 May 2014 and has still not been brought into force by notification, and the Whistle Blowers Protection (Amendment) Bill, 2015 was passed by the Lok Sabha and lapsed, so India's statutory whistle-blower protection remains enacted but not commenced and current protection rests on scattered administrative and sectoral arrangements; this matters precisely because the appellant, the social auditor and the reporting official bear cost, delay and retaliation risk at the point where the accountability chain most needs them. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q75. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Whistle-blower protection as an unfilled gap?

A. Section 4 of the Right to Information Act, 2005 requires public authorities to maintain records and publish specified organisational, function, decision, budget, subsidy, concession and Public Information Officer information on their own initiative so that routine facts need not await an application, and it reduces the volume of grievances that arise purely from information asymmetry; compliance is not independently audited, however, and publication is not the same as usability, so a disclosure that is aggregated, technical or stale satisfies the form without serving the purpose. B. Under the Right to Information Act, 2005 a citizen seeks existing information from a public authority within ordinarily 30 days, or 48 hours where the information concerns the life or liberty of a person, with a first appeal ordinarily within 30 days and a second appeal to the Central or State Information Commission within 90 days, and a Public Information Officer penalty of two hundred and fifty rupees per day subject to a maximum of twenty-five thousand rupees after the statutory process; the route obtains information that already exists and does not create information, order a service or punish the underlying wrong. C. The Whistle Blowers Protection Act, 2014 received assent on 9 May 2014 and has still not been brought into force by notification, and the Whistle Blowers Protection (Amendment) Bill, 2015 was passed by the Lok Sabha and lapsed, so India's statutory whistle-blower protection remains enacted but not commenced and current protection rests on scattered administrative and sectoral arrangements; this matters precisely because the appellant, the social auditor and the reporting official bear cost, delay and retaliation risk at the point where the accountability chain most needs them. D. Section 8 of the Right to Information Act, 2005 contains the exemptions and they operate subject to severability, so a document is not withheld in full because part of it is exempt, and subject to the section 8(2) public-interest override, which permits disclosure where the public interest in disclosure outweighs the harm to the protected interest; section 24 excludes listed intelligence and security organisations from the Act while preserving the provisos relating to allegations of corruption and human-rights violations.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Whistle Blowers Protection Act, 2014 received assent on 9 May 2014 and has still not been brought into force by notification, and the Whistle Blowers Protection (Amendment) Bill, 2015 was passed by the Lok Sabha and lapsed, so India's statutory whistle-blower protection remains enacted but not commenced and current protection rests on scattered administrative and sectoral arrangements; this matters precisely because the appellant, the social auditor and the reporting official bear cost, delay and retaliation risk at the point where the accountability chain most needs them. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q76. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Whistle-blower protection as an unfilled gap?

A. Section 4 of the Right to Information Act, 2005 requires public authorities to maintain records and publish specified organisational, function, decision, budget, subsidy, concession and Public Information Officer information on their own initiative so that routine facts need not await an application, and it reduces the volume of grievances that arise purely from information asymmetry; compliance is not independently audited, however, and publication is not the same as usability, so a disclosure that is aggregated, technical or stale satisfies the form without serving the purpose. B. Section 8 of the Right to Information Act, 2005 contains the exemptions and they operate subject to severability, so a document is not withheld in full because part of it is exempt, and subject to the section 8(2) public-interest override, which permits disclosure where the public interest in disclosure outweighs the harm to the protected interest; section 24 excludes listed intelligence and security organisations from the Act while preserving the provisos relating to allegations of corruption and human-rights violations. C. Section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005 stands substituted by section 44(3) of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, which sits in the already-commenced immediate tranche of that Act, so the substituted personal-information exemption has been operative since 13 and 14

November 2025 and the pre-substitution three-part test must not be described as the current text; the general public-interest override in section 8(2) is unaffected and remains the route by which disclosure can still be directed, and constitutional challenges to the amendment have been filed with no final judgment located as of 13 August 2026, so the challenge is stated as pending and no outcome is asserted. D. The Whistle Blowers Protection Act, 2014 received assent on 9 May 2014 and has still not been brought into force by notification, and the Whistle Blowers Protection (Amendment) Bill, 2015 was passed by the Lok Sabha and lapsed, so India's statutory whistle-blower protection remains enacted but not commenced and current protection rests on scattered administrative and sectoral arrangements; this matters precisely because the appellant, the social auditor and the reporting official bear cost, delay and retaliation risk at the point where the accountability chain most needs them.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Whistle Blowers Protection Act, 2014 received assent on 9 May 2014 and has still not been brought into force by notification, and the Whistle Blowers Protection (Amendment) Bill, 2015 was passed by the Lok Sabha and lapsed, so India's statutory whistle-blower protection remains enacted but not commenced and current protection rests on scattered administrative and sectoral arrangements; this matters precisely because the appellant, the social auditor and the reporting official bear cost, delay and retaliation risk at the point where the accountability chain most needs them. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Verified question ownership and applied routing demands?

A. The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the 2020 General Studies Paper-II demand on recent amendments to the Right to Information Act and the autonomy of the Information Commission to this owner as a cross-cutting demand shared with the Polity commission and statutory-body owners, and its stem was confirmed word for word in the locally held official paper; the audited 2024-2025 ledger routes the 2024 Citizens' Charter demand to this owner while the charter architecture itself is held by the citizen-centric-administration file, so the two are answered together with the ecosystem context supplied here; and the audited 2026 Prelims ledger routes two applied accountability-routing demands here, on public-service accountability where vaccine distribution quality is compromised and on transparency and integrity in public procurement where adverse information is confidential, for which the locally held 2026 Set-A key is provisional and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred. B. Under the Right to Information Act, 2005 a citizen seeks existing information from a public authority within ordinarily 30 days, or 48 hours where the information concerns the life or liberty of a person, with a first appeal ordinarily within 30 days and a second appeal to the Central or State Information Commission within 90 days, and a Public Information Officer penalty of two hundred and fifty rupees per day subject to a maximum of twenty-five thousand rupees after the statutory process; the route obtains information that already exists and does not create information, order a service or punish the underlying wrong. C. Accountability is not transparency plus good intentions but a three-part chain - transparency, meaning visibility of records, spending and decisions; answerability, meaning an identifiable authority obliged to explain; and enforceability, meaning correction, remedy or consequence - and India has built the first extensively, the second unevenly and the third rarely, which is why an answer that opens by separating the three immediately outperforms one that treats them as synonyms. D. Section 4 of the Right to Information Act, 2005 requires public authorities to maintain records and publish specified organisational, function, decision, budget, subsidy, concession and Public Information Officer information on their own initiative so that routine facts need not await an application, and it reduces the volume of grievances that arise purely from information asymmetry; compliance is not independently audited, however, and publication is not the same as usability, so a disclosure that is aggregated, technical or stale satisfies the form without serving the purpose.

Answer: A. Explanation: The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the 2020 General Studies Paper-II demand on recent amendments to the Right to Information Act and the autonomy of the Information Commission to this owner as a cross-cutting demand shared with the Polity commission and statutory-body owners, and its stem was confirmed word for word in the locally held official paper; the audited 2024-2025 ledger routes the 2024 Citizens' Charter demand to this owner while the charter architecture itself is held by the citizen-centric-administration file, so the two are answered together with the ecosystem context supplied here; and the audited 2026 Prelims ledger routes two applied accountability-routing demands here, on public-service accountability where vaccine distribution quality is compromised and on transparency and integrity in public procurement where adverse information is confidential, for which the locally held 2026 Set-A key is provisional and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred. The remaining options belong

Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Verified question ownership and applied routing demands?

A. Under the Right to Information Act, 2005 a citizen seeks existing information from a public authority within ordinarily 30 days, or 48 hours where the information concerns the life or liberty of a person, with a first appeal ordinarily within 30 days and a second appeal to the Central or State Information Commission within 90 days, and a Public Information Officer penalty of two hundred and fifty rupees per day subject to a maximum of twenty-five thousand rupees after the statutory process; the route obtains information that already exists and does not create information, order a service or punish the underlying wrong. B. The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the 2020 General Studies Paper-II demand on recent amendments to the Right to Information Act and the autonomy of the Information Commission to this owner as a cross-cutting demand shared with the Polity commission and statutory-body owners, and its stem was confirmed word for word in the locally held official paper; the audited 2024-2025 ledger routes the 2024 Citizens' Charter demand to this owner while the charter architecture itself is held by the citizen-centric-administration file, so the two are answered together with the ecosystem context supplied here; and the audited 2026 Prelims ledger routes two applied accountability-routing demands here, on public-service accountability where vaccine distribution quality is compromised and on transparency and integrity in public procurement where adverse information is confidential, for which the locally held 2026 Set-A key is provisional and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred. C. Section 8 of the Right to Information Act, 2005 contains the exemptions and they operate subject to severability, so a document is not withheld in full because part of it is exempt, and subject to the section 8(2) public-interest override, which permits disclosure where the public interest in disclosure outweighs the harm to the protected interest; section 24 excludes listed intelligence and security organisations from the Act while preserving the provisos relating to allegations of corruption and human-rights violations. D. Section 4 of the Right to Information Act, 2005 requires public authorities to maintain records and publish specified organisational, function, decision, budget, subsidy, concession and Public Information Officer information on their own initiative so that routine facts need not await an application, and it reduces the volume of grievances that arise purely from information asymmetry; compliance is not independently audited, however, and publication is not the same as usability, so a disclosure that is aggregated, technical or stale satisfies the form without serving the purpose.

Answer: B. Explanation: The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the 2020 General Studies Paper-II demand on recent amendments to the Right to Information Act and the autonomy of the Information Commission to this owner as a cross-cutting demand shared with the Polity commission and statutory-body owners, and its stem was confirmed word for word in the locally held official paper; the audited 2024-2025 ledger routes the 2024 Citizens' Charter demand to this owner while the charter architecture itself is held by the citizen-centric-administration file, so the two are answered together with the ecosystem context supplied here; and the audited 2026 Prelims ledger routes two applied accountability-routing demands here, on public-service accountability where vaccine distribution quality is compromised and on transparency and integrity in public procurement where adverse information is confidential, for which the locally held 2026 Set-A key is provisional and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Verified question ownership and applied routing demands?

A. Section 8 of the Right to Information Act, 2005 contains the exemptions and they operate subject to severability, so a document is not withheld in full because part of it is exempt, and subject to the section 8(2) public-interest override, which permits disclosure where the public interest in disclosure outweighs the harm to the protected interest; section 24 excludes listed intelligence and security organisations from the Act while preserving the provisos relating to allegations of corruption and human-rights violations. B. Section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005 stands substituted by section 44(3) of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, which sits in the already-commenced immediate tranche of that Act, so the substituted personal-information exemption has been operative since 13 and 14 November 2025 and the pre-substitution three-part test must not be described as the current text; the general public-interest override in section 8(2) is unaffected and remains the route by which disclosure can still be directed, and constitutional challenges to the amendment have been filed with no final judgment located as of 13 August 2026, so the challenge is stated as pending and no outcome is asserted. C. The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the

2020 General Studies Paper-II demand on recent amendments to the Right to Information Act and the autonomy of the Information Commission to this owner as a cross-cutting demand shared with the Polity commission and statutory-body owners, and its stem was confirmed word for word in the locally held official paper; the audited 2024-2025 ledger routes the 2024 Citizens' Charter demand to this owner while the charter architecture itself is held by the citizen-centric-administration file, so the two are answered together with the ecosystem context supplied here; and the audited 2026 Prelims ledger routes two applied accountability-routing demands here, on public-service accountability where vaccine distribution quality is compromised and on transparency and integrity in public procurement where adverse information is confidential, for which the locally held 2026 Set-A key is provisional and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred. D. Section 4 of the Right to Information Act, 2005 requires public authorities to maintain records and publish specified organisational, function, decision, budget, subsidy, concession and Public Information Officer information on their own initiative so that routine facts need not await an application, and it reduces the volume of grievances that arise purely from information asymmetry; compliance is not independently audited, however, and publication is not the same as usability, so a disclosure that is aggregated, technical or stale satisfies the form without serving the purpose.

Answer: C. Explanation: The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the 2020 General Studies Paper-II demand on recent amendments to the Right to Information Act and the autonomy of the Information Commission to this owner as a cross-cutting demand shared with the Polity commission and statutory-body owners, and its stem was confirmed word for word in the locally held official paper; the audited 2024-2025 ledger routes the 2024 Citizens' Charter demand to this owner while the charter architecture itself is held by the citizen-centric-administration file, so the two are answered together with the ecosystem context supplied here; and the audited 2026 Prelims ledger routes two applied accountability-routing demands here, on public-service accountability where vaccine distribution quality is compromised and on transparency and integrity in public procurement where adverse information is confidential, for which the locally held 2026 Set-A key is provisional and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Verified question ownership and applied routing demands?

A. Section 8 of the Right to Information Act, 2005 contains the exemptions and they operate subject to severability, so a document is not withheld in full because part of it is exempt, and subject to the section 8(2) public-interest override, which permits disclosure where the public interest in disclosure outweighs the harm to the protected interest; section 24 excludes listed intelligence and security organisations from the Act while preserving the provisos relating to allegations of corruption and human-rights violations. B. Section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005 stands substituted by section 44(3) of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, which sits in the already-commenced immediate tranche of that Act, so the substituted personal-information exemption has been operative since 13 and 14 November 2025 and the pre-substitution three-part test must not be described as the current text; the general public-interest override in section 8(2) is unaffected and remains the route by which disclosure can still be directed, and constitutional challenges to the amendment have been filed with no final judgment located as of 13 August 2026, so the challenge is stated as pending and no outcome is asserted. C. The Central and State Information Commissions are statutory bodies under the Right to Information Act, 2005 that decide complaints and second appeals concerning access to information and can secure the record, compensation and statutory compliance or penalty, but they cannot adjudicate the merits of the underlying pension, licence or service, so a citizen who wants the entitlement rather than the file is in the wrong forum; the composition, appointment and removal of these bodies are owned by the Polity material and are cross-linked rather than restated. D. The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the 2020 General Studies Paper-II demand on recent amendments to the Right to Information Act and the autonomy of the Information Commission to this owner as a cross-cutting demand shared with the Polity commission and statutory-body owners, and its stem was confirmed word for word in the locally held official paper; the audited 2024-2025 ledger routes the 2024 Citizens' Charter demand to this owner while the charter architecture itself is held by the citizen-centric-administration file, so the two are answered together with the ecosystem context supplied here; and the audited 2026 Prelims ledger routes two applied accountability-routing demands here, on public-service accountability where vaccine distribution quality is compromised and on transparency and integrity in public procurement where adverse information is confidential, for which the locally held 2026 Set-A key is provisional and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred.

Answer: D. Explanation: The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the 2020 General Studies Paper-II demand on recent amendments to the Right to Information Act and the autonomy of the Information Commission to this owner as a cross-cutting demand shared with the Polity commission and statutory-body owners, and its stem was confirmed word for word in the locally held official paper; the audited 2024-2025 ledger routes the 2024 Citizens' Charter demand to this owner while the charter architecture itself is held by the citizen-centric-administration file, so the two are answered together with the ecosystem context supplied here; and the audited 2026 Prelims ledger routes two applied accountability-routing demands here, on public-service accountability where vaccine distribution quality is compromised and on transparency and integrity in public procurement where adverse information is confidential, for which the locally held 2026 Set-A key is provisional and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT

One direct General Studies Paper-II Mains demand and two applied objective demands are routed to this topic across the audited ledgers, and every routed Mains stem used below was confirmed word for word in the locally held OCR-searchable official question papers. The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the 2020 demand on recent amendments to the Right to Information Act and their impact on the autonomy and independence of the Information Commission to this owner as a cross-cutting demand shared with the Polity commission owner and the consolidated statutory-body owner, so the Governance half of that demand is answered here and the composition and amendment detail is cross-linked rather than restated. The audited 2024-2025 Mains ledger routes the 2024 demand on the Citizens' Charter as a landmark initiative that is yet to reach its full potential to this owner, while the charter architecture itself is held by the citizen-centric-administration file, so the solved card below answers the routed demand using this owner's accountability-ecosystem context and the other owner's charter structure. The audited 2026 Prelims ledger routes two applied accountability-routing demands here, on public-service accountability where vaccine distribution quality is compromised and on transparency and integrity in public procurement where adverse information is confidential; the 2026 Set-A key held locally is provisional, and no option, answer letter or distractor is recorded or inferred for either. No official answer key or marking scheme is held locally for any routed Mains demand, so every model solution below is an authored answer route rather than an official key.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT”, every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the governance demand in “VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT”.

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** Define the governance concept and separate it from the nearest legal, institutional or measured category. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** Identify the constitutional, statutory, delegated or executive authority and the competent level of government. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
- 3. Claim and named evidence:** Map state, market, civil-society, frontline and citizen stakeholders with power, duty and vulnerability. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness

or residual trade-off.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** Trace finance, information, implementation, monitoring, grievance, appeal and correction through the delivery chain. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Use a named Indian law, institution, scheme, audit, reform or local example with source, date and operative status. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** Test exclusion, digital divide, privacy, capture, capacity, indicator gaming, trade-off and residual-risk limits. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the governance demand in "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT".

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT", replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

9. PYQ application

- ANALYSIS: No GS-II Mains question in the audited 2024-2025 papers names "social audit" or the Meghalaya Act directly, but this file's transparency-answerability-enforceability framework is the necessary background for any question on accountability mechanisms, MGNREGA implementation, or grievance redress that may appear, and directly supports answers on 07's citizen-centric-administration PYQ by supplying the broader accountability-ecosystem context.
- ANALYSIS: Use the three-part transparency/answerability/enforceability framework as the opening analytical move whenever a question asks to "assess" or "strengthen" accountability in any specific scheme or institution.

2026 PYQ Integration

Status: 2026 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2026.md. **Answer-key rule:** The 2026 Prelims and CSAT Set-A keys held locally are **provisional**; no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.

- **Year represented:** 2026
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 2

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2026	Prelims GS-I	51	Public-service accountability when confronting compromised vaccine distribution quality	Objective question; provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally, answer not inferred	Provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally (Ans - 2026 - GS1 - Provisional); key is provisional - no answer letter recorded or inferred here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2026	Prelims GS-I	53	Transparency and integrity in public procurement with confidential adverse information	Objective question; provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally, answer not inferred	Provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally (Ans - 2026 - GS1 - Provisional); key is provisional - no answer letter recorded or inferred here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Public-service accountability when confronting compromised vaccine distribution quality
- Transparency and integrity in public procurement with confidential adverse information

This block integrates the 2026 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 blocks and does not convert a provisionally-keyed, answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

Status: 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: `_PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2024-2025.md`.

- **Years represented:** 2024
- **Paper(s):** GS-II
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2024	GS-II	16	Citizens' Charter and citizen-centric administration	Identify and suggest · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Citizens' Charter and citizen-centric administration

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: `_PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md`.

- **Years represented:** 2020
- **Paper(s):** GS-II
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2020	GS-II	2	Recent RTI amendments and the autonomy of the Information Commission	Discuss · 10 marks · 150 words	Cross-cutting; Information Commission, transparency regime and consolidated statutory-body Core	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Recent RTI amendments and the autonomy of the Information Commission

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- ANALYSIS: Where a question asks to strengthen accountability or evaluate grievance redress in any scheme, use the independence-test and enforceability-test framework (Section 1/3) to structure a precise diagnostic rather than a generic "more transparency needed" answer.
- ANALYSIS: Where a question invites comparison of audit mechanisms, explicitly distinguish social, performance and financial audit (Section 2) to avoid conflating them.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2020 General Studies Paper-II

Demand: "Recent amendments to the Right to Information Act will have profound impact on the autonomy and independence of the Information Commission". Discuss. Answer in 150 words for 10 marks.

Status: Routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to this owner as a cross-cutting demand shared with the Polity commission and consolidated statutory-body owners, and confirmed word for word in the locally held official 2020 General Studies Paper-II. No official answer key is held locally, so the model solution is an authored route and no amendment section number or tenure figure is asserted from this file.

Model solution: Discuss requires both directions, and the Governance half of this demand is to explain why tenure and service conditions are an autonomy question at all rather than to recite amendment clauses. Open with the structural claim: a body that adjudicates disputes against the executive, but whose term and service conditions are determined by that same executive, faces an independence problem irrespective of the integrity of the individual office-holder, because the incentive operates on the office and not on the person. Then apply the general test for institutional independence in four parts and show which limb the change touches. Appointment process - is selection plural and reasoned, or effectively unilateral. Security of tenure - is the term fixed by statute or alterable by executive prescription, since a term that can be shortened is a term that can be used. Financial independence - are salary and conditions insulated from the body being adjudicated against. Finality of decision - is the order binding, and is non-compliance itself actionable. Argue the counter-position honestly, since a discuss directive rewards it: uniformity of service conditions across statutory bodies, flexibility to revise terms as institutions evolve, and the fact that independence is ultimately demonstrated through appointment quality, published reasoned orders and appellate outcomes rather than inferred from nomenclature alone. Add the layer that makes the question current rather than historical, which is where a strong answer separates itself: autonomy of the Commission and breadth of the right are two distinct live questions, because the personal-information exemption in the transparency statute now stands substituted by section 44(3) of the data-protection statute in its already-commenced immediate tranche, operative since 13 and 14 November 2025, while the section 8(2) public-interest override survives as the route by which disclosure can still be directed; constitutional challenges have been filed and no final judgment was located as of 13 August 2026, so the challenge is stated as pending. Conclude that autonomy is assessed by structure rather than by assurance - appointment, tenure, finances and finality - and that a narrower disclosure gateway and a less insulated adjudicator compound each other, because the same body now decides fewer questions with less structural protection. Cross-link composition, appointment and removal to the Polity owner. Assert no pendency, disposal, vacancy or application figure, and state no outcome in the pending challenge.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2020 General Studies Paper-II", every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Discuss requires both directions, and the Governance half of this demand is to explain why tenure and service conditions are an autonomy question at all rather than to recite amendment clauses. Open with the structural claim: a body that adjudicates disputes against the executive, but whose term and service conditions are

determined by that same executive, faces an independence problem irrespective of the integrity of the individual office-holder, because the incentive operates on the office and not on the person. Then apply the general test for institutional independence in four parts and show which limb the change touches. Appointment process - is selection plural and reasoned, or effectively unilateral. Security of tenure - is the term fixed by statute or alterable by executive prescription, since a term that can be shortened is a term that can be used. Financial independence - are salary and conditions insulated from the body being adjudicated against. Finality of decision - is the order binding, and is non-compliance itself actionable. Argue the counter-position honestly, since a discuss directive rewards it: uniformity of service conditions across statutory bodies, flexibility to revise terms as institutions evolve, and the fact that independence is ultimately demonstrated through appointment quality, published reasoned orders and appellate outcomes rather than inferred from nomenclature alone. Add the layer that makes the question current rather than historical, which is where a strong answer separates itself: autonomy of the Commission and breadth of the right are two distinct live questions, because the personal-information exemption in the transparency statute now stands substituted by section 44(3) of the data-protection statute in its already-commenced immediate tranche, operative since 13 and 14 November 2025, while the section 8(2) public-interest override survives as the route by which disclosure can still be directed; constitutional challenges have been filed and no final judgment was located as of 13 August 2026, so the challenge is stated as pending. Conclude that autonomy is assessed by structure rather than by assurance - appointment, tenure, finances and finality - and that a narrower disclosure gateway and a less insulated adjudicator compound each other, because the same body now decides fewer questions with less structural protection. Cross-link composition, appointment and removal to the Polity owner. Assert no pendency, disposal, vacancy or application figure, and state no outcome in the pending challenge.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2020 General Studies Paper-II **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: "Recent amendments to the Right to Information Act will have profound impact on the autonomy and independence of the Information Commission". Discuss. Answer in 150 words for 10 marks. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: Discuss requires both directions, and the Governance half of this demand is to explain why tenure and service conditions are an autonomy question at all rather than to recite amendment clauses. Open with the structural claim: a body that adjudicates disputes against the executive, but whose term and service conditions are determined by that same executive, faces an independence problem irrespective of the integrity of the individual office-holder, because the incentive operates on the office and not on the person. Then apply the general test for institutional independence in four parts and show which limb the change touches. Appointment process - is selection plural and reasoned, or effectively unilateral. Security of tenure - is the term fixed by statute or alterable by executive prescription, since a term that can be shortened is a term that can be used. Financial independence - are salary and conditions insulated from the body being adjudicated against. Finality of decision - is the order binding, and is non-compliance itself actionable. Argue the counter-position honestly, since a discuss directive rewards it: uniformity of service conditions across statutory bodies, flexibility to revise terms as institutions evolve, and the fact that independence is ultimately demonstrated through appointment quality, published reasoned orders and appellate outcomes rather than inferred from nomenclature alone. Add the layer that makes the question current rather than historical, which is where a strong answer separates itself: autonomy of the Commission and breadth of the right are two distinct live questions, because the personal-information exemption in the transparency statute now stands substituted by section 44(3) of the data-protection statute in its already-commenced immediate tranche, operative since 13 and 14 November 2025, while the section 8(2) public-interest override survives as the route by which

disclosure can still be directed; constitutional challenges have been filed and no final judgment was located as of 13 August 2026, so the challenge is stated as pending. Conclude that autonomy is assessed by structure rather than by assurance - appointment, tenure, finances and finality - and that a narrower disclosure gateway and a less insulated adjudicator compound each other, because the same body now decides fewer questions with less structural protection. Cross-link composition, appointment and removal to the Polity owner. Assert no pendency, disposal, vacancy or application figure, and state no outcome in the pending challenge.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2020 General Studies Paper-II", replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2024 General Studies Paper-II

Demand: The Citizens' charter has been a landmark initiative in ensuring citizen-centric administration. But it is yet to reach its full potential. Identify the factors hindering the realisation of its promise and suggest measures to overcome them. Answer in 250 words for 15 marks.

Status: Routed to this owner by the audited 2024-2025 Mains ledger and confirmed word for word in the locally held official 2024 General Studies Paper-II, while the charter architecture itself is owned by the citizen-centric-administration file. The answer therefore combines that owner's structure with this owner's accountability-ecosystem context. No official answer key is held locally.

Model solution: Identify and suggest requires one-to-one mapping, so structure the answer as hindering factors followed by the measure that repairs each, and locate the charter inside the accountability ecosystem rather than treating it as a stand-alone document. Concede the landmark claim precisely: from 1997 the charter established, for the first time in Indian administration, a published statement of what a citizen may expect, by when and with what remedy, and made departmental failure visible against a stated standard. Then identify the hindering factors. The design-stage factor comes first, because the charter was adopted administratively and without statutory backing, so it states a standard without creating an entitlement. Weak grievance follow-through follows, because a platform that registers, routes and tracks a complaint makes the delay visible without being able to compel the service, decide the entitlement or award compensation. Capacity mismatch is third, because a promise made by a department that was not simultaneously resourced documents a capability it does not have. Low awareness is fourth, since charters are rarely displayed or explained at the point of service. Static, non-consultative drafting is fifth, producing standards expressed as administrative acknowledgements rather than as resolved outcomes. Add the ecosystem factor this owner supplies and most answers miss: the charter's grievance pillar is only one instrument among several, and a citizen who takes a service complaint to an information forum, or an information denial to a grievance platform, receives a disposal without a remedy, so mis-routing compounds the charter's own weakness. Now map the measures. Statutory conversion on the service-guarantee model for high-volume services repairs unenforceability by supplying a notified service, a designated officer, a timeline, an appeal and a consequence. Consultative drafting with user panels repairs irrelevance. Outcome-expressed standards with a named officer repair unmeasurability. Integrating charter timelines into the grievance platform so a breach becomes auto-detectable repairs the asymmetry that makes the citizen the enforcer. Independent audit of grievance quality - resolution, reasoned closure, recurrence and appeal outcome rather than disposal rate - repairs closure without resolution. Proactive disclosure of eligibility, entitlement lists and decision reasons repairs the information asymmetry upstream of the complaint. Capability investment as a precondition repairs the empty promise. Include the counterpoint: statutory conversion over an under-capacitated office converts a broken promise into a penalised officer without producing the service, so enforceability and capability must move together. Conclude that the charter's promise fails less from indifference than from a missing enforcement limb and an unrouted remedy. Assert no departmental charter count, State notified-service list, penalty amount or disposal statistic.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2024 General Studies Paper-II”, every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Identify and suggest requires one-to-one mapping, so structure the answer as hindering factors followed by the measure that repairs each, and locate the charter inside the accountability ecosystem rather than treating it as a stand-alone document. Concede the landmark claim precisely: from 1997 the charter established, for the first time in Indian administration, a published statement of what a citizen may expect, by when and with what remedy, and made departmental failure visible against a stated standard. Then identify the hindering factors. The design-stage factor comes first, because the charter was adopted administratively and without statutory backing, so it states a standard without creating an entitlement. Weak grievance follow-through follows, because a platform that registers, routes and tracks a complaint makes the delay visible without being able to compel the service, decide the entitlement or award compensation. Capacity mismatch is third, because a promise made by a department that was not simultaneously resourced documents a capability it does not have. Low awareness is fourth, since charters are rarely displayed or explained at the point of service. Static, non-consultative drafting is fifth, producing standards expressed as administrative acknowledgements rather than as resolved outcomes. Add the ecosystem factor this owner supplies and most answers miss: the charter's grievance pillar is only one instrument among several, and a citizen who takes a service complaint to an information forum, or an information denial to a grievance platform, receives a disposal without a remedy, so mis-routing compounds the charter's own weakness. Now map the measures. Statutory conversion on the service-guarantee model for high-volume services repairs unenforceability by supplying a notified service, a designated officer, a timeline, an appeal and a consequence. Consultative drafting with user panels repairs irrelevance. Outcome-expressed standards with a named officer repair unmeasurability. Integrating charter timelines into the grievance platform so a breach becomes auto-detectable repairs the asymmetry that makes the citizen the enforcer. Independent audit of grievance quality - resolution, reasoned closure, recurrence and appeal outcome rather than disposal rate - repairs closure without resolution. Proactive disclosure of eligibility, entitlement lists and decision reasons repairs the information asymmetry upstream of the complaint. Capability investment as a precondition repairs the empty promise. Include the counterpoint: statutory conversion over an under-capacitated office converts a broken promise into a penalised officer without producing the service, so enforceability and capability must move together. Conclude that the charter's promise fails less from indifference than from a missing enforcement limb and an unrouted remedy. Assert no departmental charter count, State notified-service list, penalty amount or disposal statistic.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2024 General Studies Paper-II **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: Identify and suggest requires one-to-one mapping, so structure the answer as hindering factors followed by the measure that repairs each, and locate the charter inside the accountability ecosystem rather than treating it as a stand-alone document. Concede the landmark claim precisely: from 1997 the charter established, for the first time in Indian administration, a published statement of what a citizen may expect, by when and with what remedy, and made departmental failure visible against a stated standard. Then identify the hindering factors. The design-stage factor comes first, because the charter was adopted administratively and without statutory backing, so it states a standard without creating an entitlement. Weak grievance follow-through follows, because a platform that registers, routes and tracks a complaint makes the delay visible without being able to compel the service, decide the entitlement or award compensation. Capacity mismatch is third, because a promise made by a department that was not simultaneously resourced documents a capability it does not have. Low awareness is fourth, since charters are

rarely displayed or explained at the point of service. Static, non-consultative drafting is fifth, producing standards expressed as administrative acknowledgements rather than as resolved outcomes. Add the ecosystem factor this owner supplies and most answers miss: the charter's grievance pillar is only one instrument among several, and a citizen who takes a service complaint to an information forum, or an information denial to a grievance platform, receives a disposal without a remedy, so mis-routing compounds the charter's own weakness. Now map the measures. Statutory conversion on the service-guarantee model for high-volume services repairs unenforceability by supplying a notified service, a designated officer, a timeline, an appeal and a consequence. Consultative drafting with user panels repairs irrelevance. Outcome-expressed standards with a named officer repair unmeasurability. Integrating charter timelines into the grievance platform so a breach becomes auto-detectable repairs the asymmetry that makes the citizen the enforcer. Independent audit of grievance quality - resolution, reasoned closure, recurrence and appeal outcome rather than disposal rate - repairs closure without resolution. Proactive disclosure of eligibility, entitlement lists and decision reasons repairs the information asymmetry upstream of the complaint. Capability investment as a precondition repairs the empty promise. Include the counterpoint: statutory conversion over an under-capacitated office converts a broken promise into a penalised officer without producing the service, so enforceability and capability must move together. Conclude that the charter's promise fails less from indifference than from a missing enforcement limb and an unrouted remedy. Assert no departmental charter count, State notified-service list, penalty amount or disposal statistic.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2024 General Studies Paper-II", replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper-I

Demand: Public-service accountability when confronting compromised vaccine distribution quality. Objective question routed to this owner.

Status: Routed by the audited 2026 Prelims ledger to this owner. The locally held 2026 Set-A key is provisional, so no option, answer letter or distractor is recorded or inferred; the demand is treated as an applied accountability-routing coverage requirement.

Model solution: The demand is objective and is deliberately not converted into a solved answer. What the owner must supply is the reasoning framework the question family applies. First, the controlling duty: an official who learns that the quality of a distributed public good has been compromised owes a duty to report through a channel that creates a record, because an informal word to a colleague neither triggers a competent authority nor protects the person reporting. Second, the routing discipline: a quality failure engages inspection and regulatory action to stop the immediate harm, the department's own supervisory chain to correct the process, the vigilance route where the failure suggests misconduct rather than error, and public audit and legislative scrutiny where the pattern is systemic rather than isolated. Third, the four-function discipline: audit examines records and systems after the fact, investigation gathers evidence of a specific wrong, adjudication decides rights with due process, and grievance redress resolves an individual complaint, so naming which function the situation needs is the analytical act. Fourth, the sequencing rule: harm containment precedes attribution, so the first action is to prevent further distribution and the second is to place the information on a record that a competent authority must act upon. Fifth, the honest limit that keeps a learning package safe: statutory protection for the person who discloses remains enacted and not commenced, so the reporting duty and the protection available to the reporter are not symmetric. Assert no procurement value, batch figure, inspection statistic or case outcome, and record no answer letter.

Demand decoding: Treat "PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper-I" as an authority, mandate, jurisdiction, process, indicator and source-date-status problem; test each statement.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The demand is objective and is deliberately not converted into a solved answer. What the owner must supply is the reasoning framework the question family applies. First, the controlling duty: an official who learns that the quality of a distributed public good has been compromised owes a duty to report through a channel that creates a record, because an informal word to a colleague neither triggers a competent authority nor protects the person reporting. Second, the routing discipline: a quality failure engages inspection and regulatory action to stop the immediate harm, the department's own supervisory chain to correct the process, the vigilance route where the failure suggests misconduct rather than error, and public audit and legislative scrutiny where the pattern is systemic rather than isolated. Third, the four-function discipline: audit examines records and systems after the fact, investigation gathers evidence of a specific wrong, adjudication decides rights with due process, and grievance redress resolves an individual complaint, so naming which function the situation needs is the analytical act. Fourth, the sequencing rule: harm containment precedes attribution, so the first action is to prevent further distribution and the second is to place the information on a record that a competent authority must act upon. Fifth, the honest limit that keeps a learning package safe: statutory protection for the person who discloses remains enacted and not commenced, so the reporting duty and the protection available to the reporter are not symmetric. Assert no procurement value, batch figure, inspection statistic or case outcome, and record no answer letter.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper-I **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Public-service accountability when confronting compromised vaccine distribution quality. Objective question routed to this owner. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: The demand is objective and is deliberately not converted into a solved answer. What the owner must supply is the reasoning framework the question family applies. First, the controlling duty: an official who learns that the quality of a distributed public good has been compromised owes a duty to report through a channel that creates a record, because an informal word to a colleague neither triggers a competent authority nor protects the person reporting. Second, the routing discipline: a quality failure engages inspection and regulatory action to stop the immediate harm, the department's own supervisory chain to correct the process, the vigilance route where the failure suggests misconduct rather than error, and public audit and legislative scrutiny where the pattern is systemic rather than isolated. Third, the four-function discipline: audit examines records and systems after the fact, investigation gathers evidence of a specific wrong, adjudication decides rights with due process, and grievance redress resolves an individual complaint, so naming which function the situation needs is the analytical act. Fourth, the sequencing rule: harm containment precedes attribution, so the first action is to prevent further distribution and the second is to place the information on a record that a competent authority must act upon. Fifth, the honest limit that keeps a learning package safe: statutory protection for the person who discloses remains enacted and not commenced, so the reporting duty and the protection available to the reporter are not symmetric. Assert no procurement value, batch figure, inspection statistic or case outcome, and record no answer letter.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: Fix the legal or institutional category; map the competent level; separate instrument from outcome; eliminate the nearest mandate, implementation, chronology, privacy or tournament-body distractor.

Why this earns marks: It prevents a familiar scheme, institution or recommendation from being mistaken for implemented law, proven outcome or wider jurisdiction.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper-I", state precisely why the closest distractor fails on authority, level, process stage, indicator, source, date or status.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper-I

Demand: Transparency and integrity in public procurement with confidential adverse information. Objective question routed to this owner.

Status: Routed by the audited 2026 Prelims ledger to this owner. The locally held 2026 Set-A key is provisional, so no option, answer letter or distractor is recorded or inferred; the demand is treated as an applied accountability-routing coverage requirement.

Model solution: The demand is objective and is deliberately not converted into a solved answer. The coverage requirement is the distinction between confidentiality of a source or of commercially sensitive material and the duty to disclose a risk to the authority competent to act, which are different obligations that a close-option stem deliberately places in tension. Retain four controlling propositions. Confidentiality attaches to the material and to the identity of a source, and it does not extinguish the duty to place the substance of the risk before the procuring authority or the competent oversight body. The correct instrument is the procuring authority's own conflict-of-interest, disclosure and debarment machinery together with the general financial and procurement rules, because a procurement-integrity concern is first a procurement question and only afterwards a corruption question. Where corruption is alleged rather than irregularity suspected, the vigilance and investigative route applies, and the corruption ombudsman's jurisdiction is limited to covered public servants rather than being a general grievance channel. Transparency instruments and integrity instruments are complements rather than alternatives, since disclosure of the evaluation record enables scrutiny while debarment and conflict rules impose the consequence that disclosure alone cannot. Add the current-status caution that the reporting individual's statutory protection is enacted and not commenced, so an answer must not assume a protective regime. Assert no contract value, tender statistic, debarment count or case outcome, and record no answer letter.

Demand decoding: Treat "PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper-I" as an authority, mandate, jurisdiction, process, indicator and source-date-status problem; test each statement.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The demand is objective and is deliberately not converted into a solved answer. The coverage requirement is the distinction between confidentiality of a source or of commercially sensitive material and the duty to disclose a risk to the authority competent to act, which are different obligations that a close-option stem deliberately places in tension. Retain four controlling propositions. Confidentiality attaches to the material and to the identity of a source, and it does not extinguish the duty to place the substance of the risk before the procuring authority or the competent oversight body. The correct instrument is the procuring authority's own conflict-of-interest, disclosure and debarment machinery together with the general financial and procurement rules, because a procurement-integrity concern is first a procurement question and only afterwards a corruption question. Where corruption is alleged rather than irregularity suspected, the vigilance and investigative route applies, and the corruption ombudsman's jurisdiction is limited to covered public servants rather than being a general grievance channel. Transparency instruments and integrity instruments are complements rather than alternatives, since disclosure of the evaluation record enables scrutiny while debarment and conflict rules impose the consequence that disclosure alone cannot. Add the current-status caution that the reporting individual's statutory protection is enacted and not commenced, so an answer must not assume a protective regime. Assert no contract value, tender statistic, debarment count or case outcome, and record no answer letter.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper-I **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Transparency and integrity in public procurement with confidential adverse information. Objective question routed to this owner. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: The demand is objective and is deliberately not converted into a solved answer. The coverage requirement is the distinction between confidentiality of a source or of commercially sensitive material and the duty to disclose a risk to the authority competent to act, which are different obligations that a close-option stem deliberately places in tension. Retain four controlling propositions. Confidentiality attaches to the material and to the identity of a source, and it does not extinguish the duty to place the substance of the risk before the procuring authority or the competent oversight body. The correct instrument is the procuring authority's own conflict-of-interest, disclosure and debarment machinery together with the general financial and procurement rules, because a procurement-integrity concern is first a procurement question and only afterwards a corruption question. Where corruption is alleged rather than irregularity suspected, the vigilance and investigative route applies, and the corruption ombudsman's jurisdiction is limited to covered public servants rather than being a general grievance channel. Transparency instruments and integrity instruments are complements rather than alternatives, since disclosure of the evaluation record enables scrutiny while debarment and conflict rules impose the consequence that disclosure alone cannot. Add the current-status caution that the reporting individual's statutory protection is enacted and not commenced, so an answer must not assume a protective regime. Assert no contract value, tender statistic, debarment count or case outcome, and record no answer letter.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: Fix the legal or institutional category; map the competent level; separate instrument from outcome; eliminate the nearest mandate, implementation, chronology, privacy or tournament-body distractor.

Why this earns marks: It prevents a familiar scheme, institution or recommendation from being mistaken for implemented law, proven outcome or wider jurisdiction.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper-I", state precisely why the closest distractor fails on authority, level, process stage, indicator, source, date or status.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 5 - 2018 General Studies Paper-II

Demand: Cross-reference to the service-standard architecture. The routed Citizens' Charter limitations demand is owned by the citizen-centric-administration file.

Status: Cross-reference only. The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the 2018 Citizens' Charter limitations demand to the citizen-centric-administration owner, where it is solved as the same demand family as the 2024 charter demand routed here. No verbatim ownership is claimed by this file.

Model solution: The route this owner supplies is the ecosystem placement rather than the charter structure. A charter's grievance pillar is one instrument inside a wider architecture that also contains information access, proactive disclosure, social audit, vigilance, public audit and adjudication, and the charter's weakness is compounded whenever a citizen carries a complaint to a forum that cannot grant the remedy sought. Retain the two boundary rules. First, the charter states a standard and a service-guarantee statute creates an entitlement, so the limitation is a design-stage one and the repair is statutory conversion coupled with capability investment; that structure belongs to the citizen-centric-administration owner and is cross-referenced rather than restated. Second, an information denial about the service is a different remedy from the service itself and takes the public information officer, first appeal and Information Commission route, while the entitlement is pursued through the department and the notified service-guarantee route. Conclude by naming the coupling that this owner contributes: a charter timeline integrated into the grievance record makes a breach auto-detectable, and independent audit of grievance quality supplies the consequence that a published standard alone never carried. Assert no disposal, pendency or coverage statistic.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 5 - 2018 General Studies Paper-II", every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The route this owner supplies is the ecosystem placement rather than the charter structure. A charter's grievance pillar is one instrument inside a wider architecture that also contains information access, proactive disclosure, social audit, vigilance, public audit and adjudication, and the charter's weakness is compounded whenever a citizen carries a complaint to a forum that cannot grant the remedy sought. Retain the two boundary rules. First, the charter states a standard and a service-guarantee statute creates an entitlement, so the limitation is a design-stage one and the repair is statutory conversion coupled with capability investment; that structure belongs to the citizen-centric-administration owner and is cross-referenced rather than restated. Second, an information denial about the service is a different remedy from the service itself and takes the public information officer, first appeal and Information Commission route, while the entitlement is pursued through the department and the notified service-guarantee route. Conclude by naming the coupling that this owner contributes: a charter timeline integrated into the grievance record makes a breach auto-detectable, and independent audit of grievance quality supplies the consequence that a published standard alone never carried. Assert no disposal, pendency or coverage statistic.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 5 - 2018 General Studies Paper-II **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Cross-reference to the service-standard architecture. The routed Citizens' Charter limitations demand is owned by the citizen-centric-administration file. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: The route this owner supplies is the ecosystem placement rather than the charter structure. A charter's grievance pillar is one instrument inside a wider architecture that also contains information access, proactive disclosure, social audit, vigilance, public audit and adjudication, and the charter's weakness is compounded whenever a citizen carries a complaint to a forum that cannot grant the remedy sought. Retain the two boundary rules. First, the charter states a standard and a service-guarantee statute creates an entitlement, so the limitation is a design-stage one and the repair is statutory conversion coupled with capability investment; that structure belongs to the citizen-centric-administration owner and is cross-referenced rather than restated. Second, an information denial about the service is a different remedy from the service itself and takes the public information officer, first appeal and Information Commission route, while the entitlement is pursued through the department and the notified service-guarantee route. Conclude by naming the coupling that this owner contributes: a charter timeline integrated into the grievance record makes a breach auto-detectable, and independent audit of grievance quality supplies the consequence that a published standard alone never carried. Assert no disposal, pendency or coverage statistic.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 5 - 2018 General Studies Paper-II", replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish social audit from information-request based transparency as accountability mechanisms in Indian governance. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Social audit is collective, scheme-specific and verificatory while an information request is individual, demand-driven and record-seeking, so the two answer different questions and fail in different ways, and naming which mechanism a problem needs is the analytical act the question is testing.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Social audit is the participatory verification of records, expenditure and delivery, facilitated independently of the implementing agency and culminating in a public hearing and a follow-up process, and it is distinct from financial audit which tests expenditure regularity, from compliance audit which tests conformity with rules, from performance audit which tests economy, efficiency and effectiveness, and from individual grievance redress which resolves one person's complaint; it surfaces systemic patterns that no single complaint would reveal.
- Under the Right to Information Act, 2005 a citizen seeks existing information from a public authority within ordinarily 30 days, or 48 hours where the information concerns the life or liberty of a person, with a first appeal ordinarily within 30 days and a second appeal to the Central or State Information Commission within 90 days, and a Public Information Officer penalty of two hundred and fifty rupees per day subject to a maximum of twenty-five thousand rupees after the statutory process; the route obtains information that already exists and does not create information, order a service or punish the underlying wrong.
- Audit examines records and systems after the fact, investigation gathers evidence of a specific wrong, adjudication decides rights between parties with due process, and grievance redress resolves an individual's service complaint administratively, and naming which of the four a question needs is worth more than describing any of them; the same discipline resolves applied problems, since an official who learns of a quality failure owes a duty to report through a channel that creates a record, and confidentiality of a source or of commercially sensitive material does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the authority competent to act.

Qualified conclusion: Social audit is collective, scheme-specific and verificatory while an information request is individual, demand-driven and record-seeking, so the two answer different questions and fail in different ways, and naming which mechanism a problem needs is the analytical act the question is testing.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Distinguish social audit from information-request based transparency as accountability...", every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Social audit is collective, scheme-specific and verificatory while an information request is individual, demand-driven and record-seeking, so the two answer different questions and fail in different ways, and naming which mechanism a problem needs is the analytical act the question is testing.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Social audit is the participatory verification of records, expenditure and delivery, facilitated independently of the implementing agency and culminating in a public hearing and a follow-up process, and it is distinct from financial audit which tests expenditure regularity, from compliance audit which tests conformity with rules, from performance audit which tests economy, efficiency and effectiveness, and from individual grievance redress which resolves one person's complaint; it surfaces systemic patterns that no single complaint would reveal. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Under the Right to Information Act, 2005 a citizen seeks existing information from a public authority within ordinarily 30 days, or 48 hours where the information concerns the life or liberty of a person, with a first appeal ordinarily within 30 days and a second appeal to the Central or State Information Commission within 90 days, and a Public Information Officer penalty of two hundred and fifty rupees per day subject to a maximum of twenty-five thousand rupees after the statutory process; the route obtains information that already

exists and does not create information, order a service or punish the underlying wrong. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** Audit examines records and systems after the fact, investigation gathers evidence of a specific wrong, adjudication decides rights between parties with due process, and grievance redress resolves an individual's service complaint administratively, and naming which of the four a question needs is worth more than describing any of them; the same discipline resolves applied problems, since an official who learns of a quality failure owes a duty to report through a channel that creates a record, and confidentiality of a source or of commercially sensitive material does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the authority competent to act. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: Social audit is collective, scheme-specific and verificatory while an information request is individual, demand-driven and record-seeking, so the two answer different questions and fail in different ways, and naming which mechanism a problem needs is the analytical act the question is testing.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Distinguish social audit from information-request based transparency as accountability...", replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Discuss why recent amendments affecting the transparency regime raise a question about the autonomy of the Information Commission. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Autonomy and scope are two separate live questions: a body whose tenure and service conditions are fixed by the executive it adjudicates against faces a structural independence problem irrespective of the holder's integrity, while a substituted exemption changes the breadth of the right the same body enforces.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The Central and State Information Commissions are statutory bodies under the Right to Information Act, 2005 that decide complaints and second appeals concerning access to information and can secure the record, compensation and statutory compliance or penalty, but they cannot adjudicate the merits of the underlying pension, licence or service, so a citizen who wants the entitlement rather than the file is in the wrong forum; the composition, appointment and removal of these bodies are owned by the Polity material and are cross-linked rather than restated.
- Section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005 stands substituted by section 44(3) of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, which sits in the already-commenced immediate tranche of that Act, so the substituted personal-information exemption has been operative since 13 and 14 November 2025 and the pre-substitution three-part test must not be described as the current text; the general public-interest override in section 8(2) is unaffected and remains the route by which disclosure can still be directed, and constitutional challenges to the amendment have been filed with no final judgment located as of 13 August 2026, so the challenge is stated as

pending and no outcome is asserted.

- Accountability is not transparency plus good intentions but a three-part chain - transparency, meaning visibility of records, spending and decisions; answerability, meaning an identifiable authority obliged to explain; and enforceability, meaning correction, remedy or consequence - and India has built the first extensively, the second unevenly and the third rarely, which is why an answer that opens by separating the three immediately outperforms one that treats them as synonyms.

Qualified conclusion: Autonomy and scope are two separate live questions: a body whose tenure and service conditions are fixed by the executive it adjudicates against faces a structural independence problem irrespective of the holder's integrity, while a substituted exemption changes the breadth of the right the same body enforces.

Demand decoding: The directive **discuss** requires a direct position on "Discuss why recent amendments affecting the transparency regime raise a question about the...", every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Autonomy and scope are two separate live questions: a body whose tenure and service conditions are fixed by the executive it adjudicates against faces a structural independence problem irrespective of the holder's integrity, while a substituted exemption changes the breadth of the right the same body enforces.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The Central and State Information Commissions are statutory bodies under the Right to Information Act, 2005 that decide complaints and second appeals concerning access to information and can secure the record, compensation and statutory compliance or penalty, but they cannot adjudicate the merits of the underlying pension, licence or service, so a citizen who wants the entitlement rather than the file is in the wrong forum; the composition, appointment and removal of these bodies are owned by the Polity material and are cross-linked rather than restated. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005 stands substituted by section 44(3) of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, which sits in the already-commenced immediate tranche of that Act, so the substituted personal-information exemption has been operative since 13 and 14 November 2025 and the pre-substitution three-part test must not be described as the current text; the general public-interest override in section 8(2) is unaffected and remains the route by which disclosure can still be directed, and constitutional challenges to the amendment have been filed with no final judgment located as of 13 August 2026, so the challenge is stated as pending and no outcome is asserted. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Accountability is not transparency plus good intentions but a three-part chain - transparency, meaning visibility of records, spending and decisions; answerability, meaning an identifiable authority obliged to explain; and enforceability, meaning correction, remedy or consequence - and India has built the first extensively, the second unevenly and the third rarely, which is why an answer that opens by separating the three immediately outperforms one that treats them as synonyms. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: Autonomy and scope are two separate live questions: a body whose tenure and service conditions are fixed by the executive it adjudicates against faces a structural independence problem irrespective of the holder's integrity, while a substituted exemption changes the breadth of the right the same body enforces.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Discuss why recent amendments affecting the transparency regime raise a question about the...", replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Examine the significance of statutory social-audit legislation in strengthening governance accountability. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Statutory backing is what converts community monitoring into a compliance obligation with a recurring cycle, an independent facilitator and a mandated follow-up, so the significance lies in the obligation and the independence rather than in the fact that a community looks at records.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The Meghalaya Community Participation and Public Services Social Audit Act, 2017 gives statutory backing to social audits of public programmes and services more broadly rather than for a single scheme, establishing Social Audit Units, providing for independent social auditors, securing community participation including access to relevant records, and mandating consideration of and follow-up action on audit findings; it is one of very few such State laws and must not be presented as a national model in force.
- Section 17 of the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, 2005 gives the Gram Sabha the monitoring and social-audit function for works in its area, and the Audit of Schemes Rules, 2011 require an independent State Social Audit Unit to facilitate the audit in every Gram Panchayat at least once every six months, so social audit here is a recurring statutory obligation on the implementing agency rather than an optional civil-society initiative.
- Two questions decide social-audit quality - whether the facilitating unit is structurally separate from the department whose work is audited, and whether a finding triggers timed recovery, disciplinary, criminal or process-correction action - and applying these two tests converts a generic call for more transparency into a precise diagnosis; mandating follow-up strengthens deterrence and can also produce defensive behaviour such as under-reporting and resistance to audit access unless honest officials are protected.
- At a public hearing the audit findings are presented in an open forum in which officials must respond in front of the affected community, which creates a direct, on-the-record answerability event that a written information reply cannot produce; a hearing that surfaces a discrepancy without a mandated corrective timeline nevertheless achieves answerability without enforceability, which is the distinction that decides whether social audit produces deterrence or symbolic transparency.

Qualified conclusion: Statutory backing is what converts community monitoring into a compliance obligation with a recurring cycle, an independent facilitator and a mandated follow-up, so the significance lies in the obligation and the independence rather than in the fact that a community looks at records.

Demand decoding: The directive **examine** requires a direct position on "Examine the significance of statutory social-audit legislation in strengthening governance...", every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Statutory backing is what converts community monitoring into a compliance obligation with a recurring cycle, an independent facilitator and a mandated follow-up, so the significance lies in the obligation and the independence rather than in the fact that a community looks at records.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The Meghalaya Community Participation and Public Services Social Audit Act, 2017 gives statutory backing to social audits of public programmes and services more broadly rather than for a single scheme, establishing Social Audit Units, providing for independent social auditors, securing community participation including access to relevant records, and mandating consideration of and follow-up action on audit findings; it is one of very few such State laws and must not be presented as a national model in force. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Section 17 of the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, 2005 gives the Gram Sabha the monitoring and social-audit function for works in its area, and the Audit of Schemes Rules, 2011 require an independent State Social Audit Unit to facilitate the audit in every Gram Panchayat at least once every six months, so social audit here is a recurring statutory obligation on the implementing agency rather than an optional civil-society initiative. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Two questions decide social-audit quality - whether the facilitating unit is structurally separate from the department whose work is audited, and whether a finding triggers timed recovery, disciplinary, criminal or process-correction action - and applying these two tests converts a generic call for more transparency into a precise diagnosis; mandating follow-up strengthens deterrence and can also produce defensive behaviour such as under-reporting and resistance to audit access unless honest officials are protected. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** At a public hearing the audit findings are presented in an open forum in which officials must respond in front of the affected community, which creates a direct, on-the-record answerability event that a written information reply cannot produce; a hearing that surfaces a discrepancy without a mandated corrective timeline nevertheless achieves answerability without enforceability, which is the distinction that decides whether social audit produces deterrence or symbolic transparency. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: Statutory backing is what converts community monitoring into a compliance obligation with a recurring cycle, an independent facilitator and a mandated follow-up, so the significance lies in the obligation and the independence rather than in the fact that a community looks at records.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Examine the significance of statutory social-audit legislation in strengthening governance...”, replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Examine the claim that a social audit produces answerability but not necessarily enforceability. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: The claim holds because the public hearing compels a public explanation while imposing no sanction of its own, so social audit reliably produces answerability and produces enforceability only where a mandated action-taken process couples it to an instrument that can recover, discipline or prosecute.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- At a public hearing the audit findings are presented in an open forum in which officials must respond in front of the affected community, which creates a direct, on-the-record answerability event that a written information reply cannot produce; a hearing that surfaces a discrepancy without a mandated corrective timeline nevertheless achieves answerability without enforceability, which is the distinction that decides whether social audit produces deterrence or symbolic transparency.
- Two questions decide social-audit quality - whether the facilitating unit is structurally separate from the department whose work is audited, and whether a finding triggers timed recovery, disciplinary, criminal or process-correction action - and applying these two tests converts a generic call for more transparency into a precise diagnosis; mandating follow-up strengthens deterrence and can also produce defensive behaviour such as under-reporting and resistance to audit access unless honest officials are protected.
- The chain runs from disclosure through comprehension, verification, answerability, follow-up and consequence to design feedback, and each stage has its own failure mode - published but unusable, unintelligible to the affected person, an auditor who is not independent of the implementer, officials absent from the hearing, findings recorded with no action-taken process, and the same finding recurring next cycle - and in India the chain typically breaks between verification and follow-up, so any strengthen-accountability answer that ignores the action-taken stage has missed the binding constraint.
- Social instruments generate answerability powerfully and enforceability weakly because they usually carry no sanction, so they work best when coupled to a horizontal instrument that can impose a consequence, as when audit findings feed an action-taken report and, where warranted, a vigilance or public-audit follow-up; a dashboard that shows failure without naming who must correct it produces informed helplessness rather than accountability.

Qualified conclusion: The claim holds because the public hearing compels a public explanation while imposing no sanction of its own, so social audit reliably produces answerability and produces enforceability only where a mandated action-taken process couples it to an instrument that can recover, discipline or prosecute.

Demand decoding: The directive **examine** requires a direct position on “Examine the claim that a social audit produces answerability but not necessarily...”, every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The claim holds because the public hearing compels a public explanation while imposing no sanction of its own, so social audit reliably produces answerability and produces enforceability only where a mandated action-taken process couples it to an instrument that can recover, discipline or prosecute.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** At a public hearing the audit findings are presented in an open forum in which officials must respond in front of the affected community, which creates a direct, on-the-record answerability event that a written information reply cannot produce; a hearing that surfaces a discrepancy without a mandated corrective timeline nevertheless achieves answerability without enforceability, which is the distinction that decides whether social audit produces deterrence or symbolic transparency. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary,

inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

2. **Claim and named evidence:** Two questions decide social-audit quality - whether the facilitating unit is structurally separate from the department whose work is audited, and whether a finding triggers timed recovery, disciplinary, criminal or process-correction action - and applying these two tests converts a generic call for more transparency into a precise diagnosis; mandating follow-up strengthens deterrence and can also produce defensive behaviour such as under-reporting and resistance to audit access unless honest officials are protected. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The chain runs from disclosure through comprehension, verification, answerability, follow-up and consequence to design feedback, and each stage has its own failure mode - published but unusable, unintelligible to the affected person, an auditor who is not independent of the implementer, officials absent from the hearing, findings recorded with no action-taken process, and the same finding recurring next cycle - and in India the chain typically breaks between verification and follow-up, so any strengthen-accountability answer that ignores the action-taken stage has missed the binding constraint. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Social instruments generate answerability powerfully and enforceability weakly because they usually carry no sanction, so they work best when coupled to a horizontal instrument that can impose a consequence, as when audit findings feed an action-taken report and, where warranted, a vigilance or public-audit follow-up; a dashboard that shows failure without naming who must correct it produces informed helplessness rather than accountability. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: The claim holds because the public hearing compels a public explanation while imposing no sanction of its own, so social audit reliably produces answerability and produces enforceability only where a mandated action-taken process couples it to an instrument that can recover, discipline or prosecute.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Examine the claim that a social audit produces answerability but not necessarily...", replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Assess how a citizen should be routed to the correct accountability forum and why routing decides the remedy. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Most accountability failures in India are failures of routing rather than of will, because a citizen who approaches a forum that cannot grant the remedy sought receives a disposal recorded as redress, so the first analytical act is to name the remedy and only then the instrument.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The remedy sought determines the forum - information denied or delayed goes to the Public Information Officer, then a first appeal, then the Information Commission; a service delayed or refused goes to the department, then a notified service-guarantee route where one exists, then the grievance platform; money misused in a scheme goes to social audit, performance audit and legislative scrutiny; corruption by a public servant goes to vigilance, the corruption ombudsman and investigative agencies; community-level record falsification goes to social audit with a public hearing; a regulatory or sectoral dispute goes to the sector regulator and its appellate tribunal; and a personal-data breach has no operative route until the data-protection Board's members are appointed and the relevant duties commence.
- Audit examines records and systems after the fact, investigation gathers evidence of a specific wrong, adjudication decides rights between parties with due process, and grievance redress resolves an individual's service complaint administratively, and naming which of the four a question needs is worth more than describing any of them; the same discipline resolves applied problems, since an official who learns of a quality failure owes a duty to report through a channel that creates a record, and confidentiality of a source or of commercially sensitive material does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the authority competent to act.
- The Comptroller and Auditor-General is the constitutional public auditor under Articles 148 to 151 conducting financial, compliance and performance audit that feeds legislative scrutiny and is not an investigator, prosecutor or grievance forum; the Central Vigilance Commission under the Central Vigilance Commission Act, 2003 exercises superintendence and advice on vigilance in central organisations and does not convict; the Lokpal under the Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013 inquires into corruption complaints against covered public servants and is not a general grievance portal; and the Union grievance platform registers, routes, tracks and escalates administrative grievances against a 21-day benchmark with 30 days for appeals under the August 2024 comprehensive guidelines without being adjudicatory.
- The Central and State Information Commissions are statutory bodies under the Right to Information Act, 2005 that decide complaints and second appeals concerning access to information and can secure the record, compensation and statutory compliance or penalty, but they cannot adjudicate the merits of the underlying pension, licence or service, so a citizen who wants the entitlement rather than the file is in the wrong forum; the composition, appointment and removal of these bodies are owned by the Polity material and are cross-linked rather than restated.

Qualified conclusion: Most accountability failures in India are failures of routing rather than of will, because a citizen who approaches a forum that cannot grant the remedy sought receives a disposal recorded as redress, so the first analytical act is to name the remedy and only then the instrument.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on "Assess how a citizen should be routed to the correct accountability forum and why routing...", every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Most accountability failures in India are failures of routing rather than of will, because a citizen who approaches a forum that cannot grant the remedy sought receives a disposal recorded as redress, so the first analytical act is to name the remedy and only then the instrument.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The remedy sought determines the forum - information denied or delayed goes to the Public Information Officer, then a first appeal, then the Information Commission; a service delayed or refused goes to the department, then a notified service-guarantee route where one exists, then the grievance platform;

money misused in a scheme goes to social audit, performance audit and legislative scrutiny; corruption by a public servant goes to vigilance, the corruption ombudsman and investigative agencies; community-level record falsification goes to social audit with a public hearing; a regulatory or sectoral dispute goes to the sector regulator and its appellate tribunal; and a personal-data breach has no operative route until the data-protection Board's members are appointed and the relevant duties commence. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

2. **Claim and named evidence:** Audit examines records and systems after the fact, investigation gathers evidence of a specific wrong, adjudication decides rights between parties with due process, and grievance redress resolves an individual's service complaint administratively, and naming which of the four a question needs is worth more than describing any of them; the same discipline resolves applied problems, since an official who learns of a quality failure owes a duty to report through a channel that creates a record, and confidentiality of a source or of commercially sensitive material does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the authority competent to act. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The Comptroller and Auditor-General is the constitutional public auditor under Articles 148 to 151 conducting financial, compliance and performance audit that feeds legislative scrutiny and is not an investigator, prosecutor or grievance forum; the Central Vigilance Commission under the Central Vigilance Commission Act, 2003 exercises superintendence and advice on vigilance in central organisations and does not convict; the Lokpal under the Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013 inquires into corruption complaints against covered public servants and is not a general grievance portal; and the Union grievance platform registers, routes, tracks and escalates administrative grievances against a 21-day benchmark with 30 days for appeals under the August 2024 comprehensive guidelines without being adjudicatory. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The Central and State Information Commissions are statutory bodies under the Right to Information Act, 2005 that decide complaints and second appeals concerning access to information and can secure the record, compensation and statutory compliance or penalty, but they cannot adjudicate the merits of the underlying pension, licence or service, so a citizen who wants the entitlement rather than the file is in the wrong forum; the composition, appointment and removal of these bodies are owned by the Polity material and are cross-linked rather than restated. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: Most accountability failures in India are failures of routing rather than of will, because a citizen who approaches a forum that cannot grant the remedy sought receives a disposal recorded as redress, so the first analytical act is to name the remedy and only then the instrument.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Assess how a citizen should be routed to the correct accountability forum and why routing...”, replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Assess the proposition that India's transparency regime has been its most successful accountability reform and its most over-claimed one. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: The proposition is defensible in both limbs: the regime reliably produces visibility, unreliably produces answerability and only through coupling with audit or vigilance produces consequence, and the uncommenced protection for those who disclose is the clearest evidence that the third limb was never completed.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Accountability is not transparency plus good intentions but a three-part chain - transparency, meaning visibility of records, spending and decisions; answerability, meaning an identifiable authority obliged to explain; and enforceability, meaning correction, remedy or consequence - and India has built the first extensively, the second unevenly and the third rarely, which is why an answer that opens by separating the three immediately outperforms one that treats them as synonyms.
- Section 4 of the Right to Information Act, 2005 requires public authorities to maintain records and publish specified organisational, function, decision, budget, subsidy, concession and Public Information Officer information on their own initiative so that routine facts need not await an application, and it reduces the volume of grievances that arise purely from information asymmetry; compliance is not independently audited, however, and publication is not the same as usability, so a disclosure that is aggregated, technical or stale satisfies the form without serving the purpose.
- Accountability operates in three directions - horizontal, where one state institution checks another through public audit, legislative committees, vigilance, the corruption ombudsman, courts and regulators; vertical, where citizens check the state through elections, legislative questioning and political competition; and social, where citizens check the state directly between elections through information requests, social audit, public hearings, citizen report cards, community monitoring and the media - and the social layer is the one this subject owns and the one in which India innovated.
- The Whistle Blowers Protection Act, 2014 received assent on 9 May 2014 and has still not been brought into force by notification, and the Whistle Blowers Protection (Amendment) Bill, 2015 was passed by the Lok Sabha and lapsed, so India's statutory whistle-blower protection remains enacted but not commenced and current protection rests on scattered administrative and sectoral arrangements; this matters precisely because the appellant, the social auditor and the reporting official bear cost, delay and retaliation risk at the point where the accountability chain most needs them.

Qualified conclusion: The proposition is defensible in both limbs: the regime reliably produces visibility, unreliably produces answerability and only through coupling with audit or vigilance produces consequence, and the uncommenced protection for those who disclose is the clearest evidence that the third limb was never completed.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on “Assess the proposition that India's transparency regime has been its most successful...”, every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The proposition is defensible in both limbs: the regime reliably produces visibility, unreliably produces answerability and only through coupling with audit or vigilance produces consequence, and the uncommenced protection for those who disclose is the clearest evidence that the third limb was never completed.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Accountability is not transparency plus good intentions but a three-part chain - transparency, meaning visibility of records, spending and decisions; answerability, meaning an identifiable authority obliged to explain; and enforceability, meaning correction, remedy or consequence - and India has built the first extensively, the second unevenly and the third rarely, which is why an answer that opens by separating

the three immediately outperforms one that treats them as synonyms. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

2. **Claim and named evidence:** Section 4 of the Right to Information Act, 2005 requires public authorities to maintain records and publish specified organisational, function, decision, budget, subsidy, concession and Public Information Officer information on their own initiative so that routine facts need not await an application, and it reduces the volume of grievances that arise purely from information asymmetry; compliance is not independently audited, however, and publication is not the same as usability, so a disclosure that is aggregated, technical or stale satisfies the form without serving the purpose. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Accountability operates in three directions - horizontal, where one state institution checks another through public audit, legislative committees, vigilance, the corruption ombudsman, courts and regulators; vertical, where citizens check the state through elections, legislative questioning and political competition; and social, where citizens check the state directly between elections through information requests, social audit, public hearings, citizen report cards, community monitoring and the media - and the social layer is the one this subject owns and the one in which India innovated. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The Whistle Blowers Protection Act, 2014 received assent on 9 May 2014 and has still not been brought into force by notification, and the Whistle Blowers Protection (Amendment) Bill, 2015 was passed by the Lok Sabha and lapsed, so India's statutory whistle-blower protection remains enacted but not commenced and current protection rests on scattered administrative and sectoral arrangements; this matters precisely because the appellant, the social auditor and the reporting official bear cost, delay and retaliation risk at the point where the accountability chain most needs them. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: The proposition is defensible in both limbs: the regime reliably produces visibility, unreliably produces answerability and only through coupling with audit or vigilance produces consequence, and the uncommenced protection for those who disclose is the clearest evidence that the third limb was never completed.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Assess the proposition that India's transparency regime has been its most successful...", replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.